# Murder Mystery

*Dinner Party 2026*



# Artie Ficial

*The Meridian Museum*

October 30, 2026 / Private player packet / 1 of 12

**Artie Ficial**

## *Executive Director of the Meridian Museum*

Artie treats the gala like a state visit and the coat check like a diplomatic incident. Polished, ambitious, and almost unnervingly composed, Artie has spent the last six years turning the Meridian from a respected regional institution into a museum that expects to be mentioned in the same sentence as the Met.

- Works closely with **Claire O'Scuro**. **Claire** keeps asking why the exhibition needs quite so much theater.
- Relies on **Monet Bags** for the budget and **Sue Venir** for donor agreements.
- Trusts **Brie DeVivre** to handle the donors when Artie gets pulled into a crisis.

### ACTING TIPS

Diplomatic under pressure; image-conscious; dryly funny; allergic to public chaos. Play him as someone who is always hosting, even when he is not technically the host.

### YOUR INTRODUCTION / READ THE BOX ALOUD

> I'm Artie Ficial. It is my pleasure to welcome you to our gala unveiling our newest exhibition, Treasures of the World, sponsored by our generous benefactor, Grant Larceny, who will arrive here shortly. I'm confident this will be a remarkable evening, and if anything goes wrong tonight, please treat it as an immersive experience.

*Continue to your private briefing on page 3. Keep the packet facing you.*

# Tips for a Successful Dinner

## What's at Stake

His father never thought running a regional museum was a real career. Grant's proposed resignation makes that judgment public.

## Best Practices

- Everyone, including you, has something to hide, something at stake. But only one guest tonight is guilty of murder.
- Mingle using the relationships on your introduction page. Feel free to improvise in conversations.
- If a named guest is absent, simply speak to someone else. Not everyone made it to the gala tonight.
- By now, you should have drawn a secret animal. Memorize it and don’t share it with anyone. This animal is YOUR key to knowing whether you are the murderer or innocent tonight. This will tell you which sections of this packet you can read out loud.
- When asked to read from this packet, please read the appropriate box as written. Feel free to add your own flair to stay in character.
- Don't let anyone else see what's in your packet!




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**Artie Ficial**

# The Game is Afoot

The Meridian Museum has its share of secrets, rumors, and lost paperwork. Sixteen numbered envelopes are hidden around the museum. Their contents may significantly help you tonight. These 3 hints lead to 3 different hiding places. If you find an envelope, bring it to your seat at the table. The guest with the most envelopes will win a special prize. You may investigate together.

**1** *The moving-picture gallery has a secret on its unseen side.*

**2** *Success stands on a pedestal. Tonight the prize is underneath the prize.*

**3** *A lamp dressed in green is illuminating the neighborhood of a secret.*

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# Questions for the Room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 6, then choose the next guest.

**Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Sue Venir / Tess Tament**

What would Grant's terms change for the museum or your family?

**Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Dr. Art E. Fact / Anya Tique / Reed DeLabel**

What problem in the collection work could Grant use against you?

**Hugh Bidder / Vincent Van Faux / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid / Ella Gance / Penny Pincher**

What dispute did your dealings with Grant leave you hiding?

**Frank Lloyd Wrong / Elle Loominate / Al Baster / Anne E. Dote**

What would Grant change about your commission or public program?

**Paige Turner / Mona Lott / Drew Conclusions / Robin Banks / Justin Tyme**

What did Grant want made public, and what did you not want made public?

**Dada DiCapo / Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates / Faye Stop / Minnie Malist**

What did Grant expect you to deliver, and why did that put you in trouble?

*Your speaking box is on page 6. Turn only within this act.*

# Your Answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you. After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

## IF INNOCENT

Please, sit wherever you can hear. Grant wanted his name over the door, a vote in every department, and my resignation. Monet needed his check for wages; Sue objected to the terms. Six years here, and tonight I was supposed to introduce my own replacement. My father would have called that a useful lesson in ambition. I had hoped never to give him the satisfaction.

## IF MURDERER

Please, sit wherever you can hear. Grant wanted his name over the door, a vote in every department, and my resignation. Monet needed his check for wages; Sue objected to the terms. Six years here, and tonight I was supposed to introduce my own replacement. Grant expected me to call him our savior. I had practiced the introduction. I could not get through it.

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# Questions for the Room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 8, then choose the next guest.

**Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Sue Venir / Tess Tament**

What did you change about the announcement, accounts or private arrangements?

**Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Dr. Art E. Fact / Anya Tique / Reed DeLabel**

What did you change, handle or keep from the incoming loans and their paperwork?

**Hugh Bidder / Vincent Van Faux / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid / Ella Gance / Penny Pincher**

What did you keep out of the handout, demonstration or publicity?

**Frank Lloyd Wrong / Elle Loominate / Al Baster / Anne E. Dote**

What did you change when the installation and gala plans were disputed?

**Paige Turner / Mona Lott / Drew Conclusions / Robin Banks / Justin Tyme**

What did you record, circulate or give to the people at the gala?

**Dada DiCapo / Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates / Faye Stop / Minnie Malist**

What did you do about the performance, privacy or private service?

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# Your Answer

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## IF INNOCENT

Sue and I stopped the announcement at the public desk. Then I went to Grant's private room to call the board without a roomful of donors listening. His place was set; he wasn't there. I asked Barb to give me a minute alone. I sent the refusal. Claire, I had just refused the money that pays our staff. I wanted to hear somebody on that call say I had done the right thing. Nobody did.

## IF MURDERER

Sue and I stopped the announcement at the public desk. I sent my refusal to the board and told intake to keep the bottle out of the public exhibition. Then Grant wanted to see me privately. I went to his place. A glass, an empty chair. He could summon me and then leave me waiting. I straightened his chair before I left. There. That's how well I was handling it. Still tidying up after him. Claire, I kept smiling because I couldn't think what else a host was supposed to do.

STOP

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# Questions for the Room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 10, then choose the next guest.

**Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Sue Venir / Tess Tament**

What happened to the toast and the announcement?

**Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Dr. Art E. Fact / Anya Tique / Reed DeLabel**

What was actually on display, and what had your department been told?

**Hugh Bidder / Vincent Van Faux / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid / Ella Gance / Penny Pincher**

What do you know about the bottle, pictures, or technology you brought tonight?

**Frank Lloyd Wrong / Elle Loominate / Al Baster / Anne E. Dote**

Could the work or the tour have hidden what happened?

**Paige Turner / Mona Lott / Drew Conclusions / Robin Banks / Justin Tyme**

What part of the story have your sources left out?

**Dada DiCapo / Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates / Faye Stop / Minnie Malist**

What did people actually see, hear, and drink?

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# Your Answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you. After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

## IF INNOCENT

> Keep it closed. That was my instruction, and I still approved the preview. Both decisions are mine. The board has my refusal of the gift. Monet, I know that doesn't pay anyone. Claire, take the seating list. Someone still has to look after the people here.

## IF MURDERER

> I took the contents out of that bottle to get them off the display. Intake removed the bottle too; only its label remained when the guests entered. I wanted the preview safe. Afterwards I went to Grant's place with my refusal. I left it beside his glass. I did not give him a drink. The board has the refusal.

*The shared discoveries and reports remain at the Evidence Table.*




**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.**
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# BALLOT

**Artie Ficial**

Choose one attending guest. Explain your accusation in your own words. Detach this page and give only the ballot to the host for tallying. Keep your packet for Coming Clean.

## I accuse...

## Because...

## Best Actor

## Best Costume

# The Last Word

Read only when the host calls you. Top three suspects read first. Use your own role's box; keep every other word private.

## IF INNOCENT / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I did not kill Grant. My refusal was already with the board, and the preview photograph shows the bottle I foolishly allowed to remain on display. I relied on an instruction to keep it closed. Claire will have every reason to ask why. Tomorrow I have to tell the staff what happened in the institution I promised to protect. Tonight, for once, somebody else can make the closing remarks.

## IF MURDERER / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I killed Grant. The refusal in the announcement folder was real. So was the bottle at the preview. I took its poison and later went to his waiting private glass. The public argument gave everyone something else to watch. I told you intake had removed the bottle because I wanted that opportunity gone from your account of the evening. The wide photograph put it back. I cannot call this protecting the museum. Claire will have to tell the staff what I did, and I will not be here to make it sound dignified.

*Every selected suspect gets their final word.*

# Murder Mystery

*Dinner Party 2026*



# Claire O’Scuro

*The Meridian Museum*

October 30, 2026 / Private player packet / 1 of 12

## INTRODUCTIONS

**Claire O'Scuro**

# *Chief Curator of World Cultures*

Claire can identify a fifteenth-century glaze at twenty paces and a crooked label from the parking lot. Claire is the intellectual engine behind Treasures of the World: brilliant, exacting, and visibly pained by sloppy labels, bad lighting, and people who call every old object an 'artifact.' She has spent years building the Meridian's scholarly reputation and knows the exhibition better than anyone alive.

- Works alongside **Artie Ficial**. They usually agree on the collection and argue about the gala.
- Mentors **Reed DeLabel**, who still sends draft labels for approval.
- Consults **Chip Patina** and **Dr. Art E. Fact** when an object needs closer examination.
- **Anne E. Dote** turns Claire's research into gallery tours. Claire keeps restoring the words **Anne** simplifies.

## ACTING TIPS

Controlled, observant, skeptical, extremely competitive. You do not need to be loud; a raised eyebrow can do half the work.

## YOUR INTRODUCTION / READ THE BOX ALOUD

> I'm Claire O'Scuro. I am delighted to meet anyone who knows the difference between provenance and a price tag.

*Continue to your private briefing on page 3. Keep the packet facing you.*

Claire O’Scuro

# Tips for a Successful Dinner

## What's at Stake

She trained Reed to trust her judgment and now fears she has taught obedience instead of scholarship.

## Best Practices

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Claire O'Scuro

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**1** *A life of resistance, written about a German theologian, shelters another secret.*

**2** *Flowers would call this home; tonight paperwork has moved in.*

**3** *The cars have an entrance. The secret sits above its door.*

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# Questions for the Room

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**Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Sue Venir / Tess Tament**

What would Grant's terms change for the museum or your family?

**Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Dr. Art E. Fact / Anya Tique / Reed DeLabel**

What problem in the collection work could Grant use against you?

**Hugh Bidder / Vincent Van Faux / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid / Ella Gance / Penny Pincher**

What dispute did your dealings with Grant leave you hiding?

**Frank Lloyd Wrong / Elle Loominate / Al Baster / Anne E. Dote**

What would Grant change about your commission or public program?

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What did Grant want made public, and what did you not want made public?

**Dada DiCapo / Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates / Faye Stop / Minnie Malist**

What did Grant expect you to deliver, and why did that put you in trouble?

*Your speaking box is on page 6. Turn only within this act.*

**Claire O'Scuro**

# Your Answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you. After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

## IF INNOCENT

> The bowl's ownership papers were incomplete. I approved its label too soon; Grant preferred that earlier version. Reed kept asking me to revisit it. I taught that student to question an authority, and then behaved very badly when the authority was me. Grant wanted my name beneath the claim tonight. I wanted the revised label up. We were each rather determined.

## IF MURDERER

> The bowl's ownership papers were incomplete. I approved its label too soon; Grant retained my signature. Reed kept asking me to revisit it. Grant could expose the earlier approval whenever I objected to his claim. My department was meant to thank him tonight. Instead I was trying to withdraw authority he already possessed, with my student watching.

STOP

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**Claire O'Scuro**

# Your Answer

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## IF INNOCENT

I removed the bowl's ownership label. The bowl remained. Reed kept the old wording. I moved the bottle's incoming papers from the public display file to intake because its approval was on hold. Both files were on that desk. Reed, please stop calling everything I did a correction. Some of it was simply putting an unpleasant decision where I would not have to look at it.

## IF MURDERER

I removed the bowl's ownership label; Reed kept the old wording. The bottle's papers went to intake because approval was on hold. Grant wanted the explanation brought to him personally. I put his copy beside the glass at his place. He was elsewhere. I remember moving the glass to keep its damp base off the paper. Such a small, fussy thing to remember. Reed, I was angry enough to let him wait for his explanation afterward.

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What happened to the toast and the announcement?

**Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Dr. Art E. Fact / Anya Tique / Reed DeLabel**

What was actually on display, and what had your department been told?

**Hugh Bidder / Vincent Van Faux / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid / Ella Gance / Penny Pincher**

What do you know about the bottle, pictures, or technology you brought tonight?

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What part of the story have your sources left out?

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What did people actually see, hear, and drink?

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Claire O'Scuro

# Your Answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you. After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

## IF INNOCENT

> Intake had the seller's terms, the contents query and the warning to keep it closed. Moving the papers didn't withdraw that warning. Reed asked me to stop the preview until we had an answer. I sent another query. Yes, Reed. I heard you the first time.

## IF MURDERER

> I checked the intake sheet myself. Empty. That is what I authorized and what went onto the preview stand. There were no original contents there to take. Reed, bring the receiving copy. I'm answering for my approval, not for a bottle someone now says was full.

*The shared discoveries and reports remain at the Evidence Table.*

STOP

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# BALLOT

**Claire O’Scuro**

Choose one attending guest. Explain your accusation in your own words. Detach this page and give only the ballot to the host for tallying. Keep your packet for Coming Clean.

## I accuse...

## Because...

## Best Actor

## Best Costume

Claire O'Scuro

# The Last Word

Read only when the host calls you. Top three suspects read first. Use your own role's box; keep every other word private.

## IF INNOCENT / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I did not kill Grant. Intake retained the unanswered contents question and the closed-bottle restriction. I left the preview approved anyway. My earlier bowl label was also wrong. Reed, you should not have needed my permission to keep asking. I cannot offer you a corrected label as an apology for that. I can offer you the original file, and I can stop standing between you and it.

## IF MURDERER / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

The incoming sheet does not say empty. It says inert display liquid, on Grant's word. I moved the papers because I did not want that distinction examined. I took poison from the bottle during the preview and later put it in his waiting glass. I used my authority over intake to make the source sound harmless and nonexistent. My label correction was real. Reed, you were right to question me. I have spent tonight making you ashamed of the person who taught you to do that.

*Every selected suspect gets their final word.*

# Murder Mystery

*Dinner Party 2026*



# Hugh Bidder

*The Meridian Museum*

October 30, 2026 / Private player packet / 1 of 12

**Hugh Bidder**

## *International Art Dealer & Collector Liaison*

Hugh insists everything is priceless, right up until he names a price. Hugh is the person wealthy collectors call when they want something no one else seems able to find.

• Buys art for **Elon Mosaic**. **Elon** likes to pretend he found it himself. Hugh doesn't mind.

• **Penny Pincher** asks Hugh for auction previews, then argues with every estimate. He hates dealing with her.

• Keeps offering to represent **Vincent Van Faux**. **Vincent** wants to discuss the commission before the paintings.

### ACTING TIPS

Smooth, suave, sociable, opportunistic, impossible to embarrass. Treat every conversation like a deal that has not yet revealed itself. You're the coolest guy in the room and you know it.

### YOUR INTRODUCTION / READ THE BOX ALOUD

> I'm Hugh Bidder. Everything has a price. My charming conversation is the only exception, and even that is negotiable.

*Continue to your private briefing on page 3. Keep the packet facing you.*

**Hugh Bidder**

# Tips for a Successful Dinner

## What's at Stake

His respectable firm is the life he built after being dismissed as a small-time hustler. Public exposure would strip away that invented security.

## Best Practices

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**Hugh Bidder**

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1 *A seat with a cold metallic skeleton keeps its secret underneath.*

2 *A little door hides shelves and, tonight, a secret.*

3 *A book beginning with creation has a secret between its pages.*

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What problem in the collection work could Grant use against you?

**Hugh Bidder / Vincent Van Faux / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid / Ella Gance / Penny Pincher**

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What did Grant expect you to deliver, and why did that put you in trouble?

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**Hugh Bidder**

# Your Answer

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## IF INNOCENT

Grant wanted a refund on the Star Bowl and a public admission that its certificate was false. My firm supplied it. I changed our file instead of admitting we'd been fooled. Elon began worrying about his other purchases; Saul was available to help him worry. I offered a settlement. Grant preferred an audience. Some of you knew me before I had a respectable office. He liked reminding me.

## IF MURDERER

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**Hugh Bidder**

# Your Answer

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## IF INNOCENT

I withheld the seller's correspondence from the auction handouts. It covered the bowl and the Velvet Widow purchase I arranged. The bottle sale required original contents. Grant called the liquid inert in his loan description. I had both; the display writers got the comfortable version. A second bad purchase beside the first would have been quite an evening for Saul. I was not in a charitable mood.

## IF MURDERER

I kept the seller's correspondence out of the auction handouts. Bowl and bottle, both purchases. Grant had demanded one refund already. I brought the retained file to his private place to settle it quietly. His glass was there; he wasn't. I took my file away again. Saul, you can call that evasive. I wasn't having a dealer dispute performed for your collectors. A client says refund softly enough and somehow everybody hears it.




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# Your Answer

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## IF INNOCENT

> Original contents. That was the seller's condition. I forwarded the complete attachment to intake before the gala. Grant supplied the inert description afterward; I repeated it to the donors. Saul, I know you want me to say it slowly enough to sound like a confession. I have clients in this room. The refund demand was withdrawn, and I intend to hold his estate to that. Elon can request his purchase files through my solicitor. I am not opening them on this table for your entertainment.

## IF MURDERER

> Before the loan, the original-contents condition was canceled. The seller was to empty the bottle and replace the liquid with an inert substitute. Grant's declaration described that delivery. Intake had the earlier attachment. I altered the bowl file; I have admitted that. The bottle was a separate purchase with changed instructions. Saul, please save your condolences. I know what your expression means.

STOP

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# BALLOT

**Hugh Bidder**

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## I accuse...

## Because...

## Best Actor

## Best Costume

# The Last Word

Read only when the host calls you. Top three suspects read first. Use your own role's box; keep every other word private.

## IF INNOCENT / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I did not kill Grant. The seller attachment was unaltered when I sent it to intake before the gala. I still sold the bowl under a false certificate, changed our file, and repeated Grant's harmless-liquid claim without resolving it. He deserved the refund. Elon, you deserve to see your purchase files. I dislike the man Saul thinks I am. I have given him a very good case tonight.

## IF MURDERER / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I killed Grant. The original-contents condition was never canceled. I had arranged the purchase; I knew what had been required. During the closed preview I took poison from that bottle. Later, while the private glass was unattended, I used it. The harmless-substitution story was the cover I gave you. The executed sale, seller's statement and residue findings contradicted it. His refund demand on the bowl would have finished my firm. I could have faced the bad sale and the file alteration. Saul can have the clients. Elon can have every file. I wanted so badly to remain the respectable man behind that desk that I have made him impossible to remember.

*Every selected suspect gets their final word.*

# Murder Mystery

*Dinner Party 2026*



# Monet Bags

*The Meridian Museum*

October 30, 2026 / Private player packet / 1 of 12

## *Chief Financial Officer of the Meridian Museum*

Monet can locate a missing cent faster than anyone can locate the missing antiquity. Monet can tell you exactly how much tonight's floral installation cost, which donor paid for it, and which line item everyone is pretending it came from.

• Works with **Artie Ficial** and **Sue Venir** on museum budgets and donor agreements.

• Checks **Brie DeVivre**'s catering bills. **Brie** needs to explain every extra charge.

• **Elon Mosaic** keeps suggesting new museum technology. Monet keeps asking who will pay for it.

### ACTING TIPS

Quick, pragmatic, wry, unimpressed by grandeur for grandeur's sake. You notice costs other people pretend not to see. You're not afraid to spend money as long as it's a wise investment.

### YOUR INTRODUCTION / READ THE BOX ALOUD

> I'm Monet Bags. I'm the CFO and I oversee the numbers. Please enjoy the gala, but know that any additional expenditures will not be reimbursed without a receipt.

*Continue to your private briefing on page 3. Keep the packet facing you.*

# Tips for a Successful Dinner

## What's at Stake

She grew up watching a parent wait for wages that did not arrive. Missing payroll is personal, not an abstract budget failure.

## Best Practices

- Everyone, including you, has something to hide, something at stake. But only one guest tonight is guilty of murder.
- Mingle using the relationships on your introduction page. Feel free to improvise in conversations.
- If a named guest is absent, simply speak to someone else. Not everyone made it to the gala tonight.
- By now, you should have drawn a secret animal. Memorize it and don’t share it with anyone. This animal is YOUR key to knowing whether you are the murderer or innocent tonight. This will tell you which sections of this packet you can read out loud.
- When asked to read from this packet, please read the appropriate box as written. Feel free to add your own flair to stay in character.
- Don't let anyone else see what's in your packet!




**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.**
**Wait for the host to announce the next round.**

# The Game is Afoot

The Meridian Museum has its share of secrets, rumors, and lost paperwork. Sixteen numbered envelopes are hidden around the museum. Their contents may significantly help you tonight. These 3 hints lead to 3 different hiding places. If you find an envelope, bring it to your seat at the table. The guest with the most envelopes will win a special prize. You may investigate together.

**1** *The object that borrows your face has something above its reflection.*

**2** *The painted world draws your gaze. The clue prefers its hidden reverse.*

**3** *A soft cushion in the color of a clear sky conceals something behind it.*

STOP **STOP! Do not turn the page yet.**
**Wait for the host to announce the next round.**

# Questions for the Room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 6, then choose the next guest.

**Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Sue Venir / Tess Tament**

What would Grant's terms change for the museum or your family?

**Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Dr. Art E. Fact / Anya Tique / Reed DeLabel**

What problem in the collection work could Grant use against you?

**Hugh Bidder / Vincent Van Faux / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid / Ella Gance / Penny Pincher**

What dispute did your dealings with Grant leave you hiding?

**Frank Lloyd Wrong / Elle Loominate / Al Baster / Anne E. Dote**

What would Grant change about your commission or public program?

**Paige Turner / Mona Lott / Drew Conclusions / Robin Banks / Justin Tyme**

What did Grant want made public, and what did you not want made public?

**Dada DiCapo / Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates / Faye Stop / Minnie Malist**

What did Grant expect you to deliver, and why did that put you in trouble?

*Your speaking box is on page 6. Turn only within this act.*

# Your Answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you. After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

## IF INNOCENT

> Friday. That's when wages are due. Grant's check could cover our staff; his terms let him inspect every transfer. I won't have the cleaners waiting by the phone while he decides which chair his name should go on. Artie wanted his authority protected. I wanted payroll covered. And yes, I told Grant he could keep his check if the price was treating us like thieves.

## IF MURDERER

> Friday. That's when wages are due. My mother used to wait by the phone on payday. I know what that does to a household. I'd moved money to pay our staff. Grant wanted the books before releasing his check, and the board wanted answers too. Artie hated losing authority. I had transfers to explain and no time left to explain them.




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# Questions for the Room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 8, then choose the next guest.

**Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Sue Venir / Tess Tament**

What did you change about the announcement, accounts or private arrangements?

**Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Dr. Art E. Fact / Anya Tique / Reed DeLabel**

What did you change, handle or keep from the incoming loans and their paperwork?

**Hugh Bidder / Vincent Van Faux / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid / Ella Gance / Penny Pincher**

What did you keep out of the handout, demonstration or publicity?

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What did you record, circulate or give to the people at the gala?

**Dada DiCapo / Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates / Faye Stop / Minnie Malist**

What did you do about the performance, privacy or private service?

*Your speaking box is on page 8. Turn only within this act.*

# Your Answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you. After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

## IF INNOCENT

> The extra-course ticket came to accounts. I crossed out our account and took Grant's copy to his place. Glass waiting; no Grant. I took my transfer slip away again. The payroll transfer had board authorization. He didn't need to inspect it privately. Brie, send the supplier to me. Don't send me another speech about what the donor expects.

## IF MURDERER

> The manager brought the cheese ticket to accounts. I crossed out our account and sent the donor copy back. The restricted-fund transfer was still off the board's agenda. Grant wanted my books before releasing his donation. I went to his private place to get a signature; his glass was waiting, he wasn't. I stayed with the unsigned bill for a bit. Brie, whose money did he think kept appearing whenever he asked for something? Mine? Yours?




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# Questions for the Room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 10, then choose the next guest.

**Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Sue Venir / Tess Tament**

What happened to the toast and the announcement?

**Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Dr. Art E. Fact / Anya Tique / Reed DeLabel**

What was actually on display, and what had your department been told?

**Hugh Bidder / Vincent Van Faux / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid / Ella Gance / Penny Pincher**

What do you know about the bottle, pictures, or technology you brought tonight?

**Frank Lloyd Wrong / Elle Loominate / Al Baster / Anne E. Dote**

Could the work or the tour have hidden what happened?

**Paige Turner / Mona Lott / Drew Conclusions / Robin Banks / Justin Tyme**

What part of the story have your sources left out?

**Dada DiCapo / Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates / Faye Stop / Minnie Malist**

What did people actually see, hear, and drink?

*Your speaking box is on page 10. Turn only within this act.*

# Your Answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you. After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

## IF INNOCENT

> The toast stayed booked. I told service to carry out the original order and charge Grant for the extra course. I had authority to transfer the wage money. An absent approval on the payroll line is an office problem. The staff got paid. I'm not apologizing for that.

## IF MURDERER

> The manager's six-thirty-two entry is wrong. I left the invoice beside his unwrapped glass at six fifteen. I was back in accounts before the preview opened, and I did not return afterwards. Brie, the cheese ticket came later. You are treating two different errands as one visit.

*The shared discoveries and reports remain at the Evidence Table.*




**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.**
**Wait for the host to announce the next round.**

# BALLOT

**Monet Bags**

Choose one attending guest. Explain your accusation in your own words. Detach this page and give only the ballot to the host for tallying. Keep your packet for Coming Clean.

## I accuse...

## Because...

## Best Actor

## Best Costume

# The Last Word

Read only when the host calls you. Top three suspects read first. Use your own role's box; keep every other word private.

## IF INNOCENT / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I didn't kill Grant. The toast stayed booked; my private visit was over the bill. I lied about board authorization. There wasn't any. I moved restricted money into wages because Friday was coming. Calling the missing approval an office problem didn't make one appear. Artie, when they freeze that account, tell the cleaners I paid them. Don't ask them to be grateful for what comes next.

## IF MURDERER / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I killed Grant. The accounts argument happened, and I sent the ticket back with the manager. My separate visit to find Grant was after the preview, while his unwrapped glass was waiting. I used poison I'd taken from the bottle. I told you that visit was before the preview; the manager had not even set out the glass then. I had already used restricted money for payroll. Grant wanted to examine the books and control the rescue. The wages were paid. That is the small fact I kept hiding behind. A family is waiting for a man who will never come home, and I made that happen.

*Every selected suspect gets their final word.*

# Murder Mystery

*Dinner Party 2026*



# Chip Patina

*The Meridian Museum*

October 30, 2026 / Private player packet / 1 of 12

**Chip Patina**

## *Chief Conservator*

Chip considers a fingerprint on a display case a personal attack. Chip is responsible for keeping centuries-old objects safe from humidity, fingerprints, gravity, and other people. He is the bedrock of this museum and he knows it.

- Works with **Claire O'Scuro** on the care and display of the collection.
- Argues with **Dr. Art E. Fact** about what the physical evidence can actually prove.
- Advises **Elle Loominate** on displaying fragile textiles. **Elle** listens, then asks for a less ugly support.

### ACTING TIPS

Dry, meticulous, slightly territorial. You care more about what is best for this institution than what is socially convenient.

### YOUR INTRODUCTION / READ THE BOX ALOUD

> I'm Chip Patina. Please admire the art without touching it. That includes touching it to demonstrate that you are not touching it.

*Continue to your private briefing on page 3. Keep the packet facing you.*

**Chip Patina**

# Tips for a Successful Dinner

## What's at Stake

Care is how he expresses affection. He can discuss a centuries-old crack more easily than guilt or grief.

## Best Practices

- Everyone, including you, has something to hide, something at stake. But only one guest tonight is guilty of murder.
- Mingle using the relationships on your introduction page. Feel free to improvise in conversations.
- If a named guest is absent, simply speak to someone else. Not everyone made it to the gala tonight.
- By now, you should have drawn a secret animal. Memorize it and don’t share it with anyone. This animal is YOUR key to knowing whether you are the murderer or innocent tonight. This will tell you which sections of this packet you can read out loud.
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**Chip Patina**

# The Game is Afoot

The Meridian Museum has its share of secrets, rumors, and lost paperwork. Sixteen numbered envelopes are hidden around the museum. Their contents may significantly help you tonight. These 3 hints lead to 3 different hiding places. If you find an envelope, bring it to your seat at the table. The guest with the most envelopes will win a special prize. You may investigate together.

1 *Black and white keys make music. Their underside keeps quieter company.*

2 *Take a paper journey to the city of Gaudí; your reward rests on its map.*

3 *Important information can be found in the coldest room that fits inside a kitchen.*

STOP

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# Questions for the Room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 6, then choose the next guest.

**Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Sue Venir / Tess Tament**

What would Grant's terms change for the museum or your family?

**Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Dr. Art E. Fact / Anya Tique / Reed DeLabel**

What problem in the collection work could Grant use against you?

**Hugh Bidder / Vincent Van Faux / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid / Ella Gance / Penny Pincher**

What dispute did your dealings with Grant leave you hiding?

**Frank Lloyd Wrong / Elle Loominate / Al Baster / Anne E. Dote**

What would Grant change about your commission or public program?

**Paige Turner / Mona Lott / Drew Conclusions / Robin Banks / Justin Tyme**

What did Grant want made public, and what did you not want made public?

**Dada DiCapo / Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates / Faye Stop / Minnie Malist**

What did Grant expect you to deliver, and why did that put you in trouble?

*Your speaking box is on page 6. Turn only within this act.*

**Chip Patina**

# Your Answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you. After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

## IF INNOCENT

> Recent repair. Grant wanted me to call it ancient. He liked my name beneath his description. We had already argued over treatment paperwork. Then the entrance mount started moving. People sighed when I stopped the conversation. They always do. I am easier company if nobody touches anything. Claire knows that. Tonight I was exceptionally poor company.

## IF MURDERER

> Recent repair. Grant wanted me to call it ancient. He had the insurance copy with the date I altered. Refusing his description meant answering for mine. Then the entrance mount started moving. He suggested I was inventing another problem to protect myself. Claire knows how I am about handling. Grant knew how to turn that into a joke.

STOP

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# Questions for the Room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 8, then choose the next guest.

**Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Sue Venir / Tess Tament**

What did you change about the announcement, accounts or private arrangements?

**Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Dr. Art E. Fact / Anya Tique / Reed DeLabel**

What did you change, handle or keep from the incoming loans and their paperwork?

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What did you do about the performance, privacy or private service?

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**Chip Patina**

# Your Answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you. After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

## IF INNOCENT

I fitted the red band before the preview. Kept the condition sheet. Grant waved the insurance copy at me and asked what my signature was worth. That date wasn't a change I authorized. Then Frank's mount moved. Finally, something I could fix with my hands. Frank, get the load down. I'll discuss your feelings about my tone afterward.

## IF MURDERER

I fitted the red band before the preview and kept the condition sheet. The copy with my false date was still at the workbench. After the preview I went to Grant's place to ask for that copy back. He wasn't there. The glass was. I held it up to the light: a shop engraving isn't a condition report. Put it back. Then Frank's mount started moving and I went to the alcove. Frank, I wanted that load down. The paper could wait. I told myself it could wait.

STOP

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# Questions for the Room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 10, then choose the next guest.

**Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Sue Venir / Tess Tament**

What happened to the toast and the announcement?

**Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Dr. Art E. Fact / Anya Tique / Reed DeLabel**

What was actually on display, and what had your department been told?

**Hugh Bidder / Vincent Van Faux / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid / Ella Gance / Penny Pincher**

What do you know about the bottle, pictures, or technology you brought tonight?

**Frank Lloyd Wrong / Elle Loominate / Al Baster / Anne E. Dote**

Could the work or the tour have hidden what happened?

**Paige Turner / Mona Lott / Drew Conclusions / Robin Banks / Justin Tyme**

What part of the story have your sources left out?

**Dada DiCapo / Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates / Faye Stop / Minnie Malist**

What did people actually see, hear, and drink?

*Your speaking box is on page 10. Turn only within this act.*

**Chip Patina**

# Your Answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you. After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

## IF INNOCENT

> Red paper, silver backing. I fitted it across the stopper. I inspected the front and missed the split behind. Leave the unused stock in its sleeve; photograph it first. The date on the insurance copy is a copying error. I didn't alter it. Keep that copy separate from my condition sheet.

## IF MURDERER

> I used red woven tape across the stopper. The foil-backed paper was packaging stock. My sleeve and the technician's photograph concern the closure work; they don't catalog every scrap in the building. I changed the insurance date. That much is mine. The packaging isn't my band.

*The shared discoveries and reports remain at the Evidence Table.*

STOP **STOP! Do not turn the page yet.**
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# BALLOT

**Chip Patina**

Choose one attending guest. Explain your accusation in your own words. Detach this page and give only the ballot to the host for tallying. Keep your packet for Coming Clean.

## I accuse...

## Because...

## Best Actor

## Best Costume

Chip Patina

# The Last Word

Read only when the host calls you. Top three suspects read first. Use your own role's box; keep every other word private.

## IF INNOCENT / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I didn't poison Grant. My band was foil-backed paper. I missed the split behind it. I changed the insurance date myself, and then called it a copying error. Grant had that copy. I wanted you examining the paper instead of the person who signed it. Claire, the workbench can be packed now. Photograph every piece. I don't expect my word to do the job.

## IF MURDERER / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

The red band was foil-backed paper, exactly as the report says. I denied my own material because I had opened the bottle during the preview. I knew where its closure was weakest. Later I put the stolen poison in Grant's private glass. Its scrap and the damaged band belong to that sequence; they are not a unique fingerprint, and I hoped you would stop at that objection. The false date gave him leverage over me. I used the weakness in a closure I had fitted. People trusted my hands near things that could not be replaced. They should never trust them again.

*Every selected suspect gets their final word.*

# Murder Mystery

*Dinner Party 2026*



# Dada DiCapo

*The Meridian Museum*

October 30, 2026 / Private player packet / 1 of 12

**Dada DiCapo**

## *Performance Artist & Cultural Celebrity*

Dada describes standing still as an endurance piece and invoices accordingly. Dada makes expensive people uncomfortable in aesthetically impeccable ways. She is the embodiment of contemporary art.

• Went to art school with **Vincent Van Faux**. They still remember each other's worst work.

• **Elle Loominate** has secretly helped build several of Dada's installations.

• Has made commissioned work for **Tess Tament**. **Tess** still asks whether one piece is meant to make that noise.

• Performed inside a sculpture by **Al Baster**. Dada assumed the invitation to the opening covered that.

### ACTING TIPS

Confident, theatrical, mischievous, intelligent. Commit to bits, but never let the joke make you foolish.

### YOUR INTRODUCTION / READ THE BOX ALOUD

> I'm Dada DiCapo. If the room feels uncomfortable, good. I may invoice you for the feeling. Art is money. Art is life.

*Continue to your private briefing on page 3. Keep the packet facing you.*

**Dada DiCapo**

# Tips for a Successful Dinner

## What's at Stake

Grant appropriated a work about humiliation. She fears being remembered as a joke rather than its author.

## Best Practices

- Everyone, including you, has something to hide, something at stake. But only one guest tonight is guilty of murder.
- Mingle using the relationships on your introduction page. Feel free to improvise in conversations.
- If a named guest is absent, simply speak to someone else. Not everyone made it to the gala tonight.
- By now, you should have drawn a secret animal. Memorize it and don’t share it with anyone. This animal is YOUR key to knowing whether you are the murderer or innocent tonight. This will tell you which sections of this packet you can read out loud.
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Dada DiCapo

# The Game is Afoot

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**1** *Go where a thousand stories glow; this one waits behind the screen.*

**2** *Lift your eyes to a trophy, then look where it meets the shelf.*

**3** *A secret waits behind drapes the color of spilled wine.*

STOP **STOP! Do not turn the page yet.**
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# Questions for the Room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 6, then choose the next guest.

**Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Sue Venir / Tess Tament**

What would Grant's terms change for the museum or your family?

**Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Dr. Art E. Fact / Anya Tique / Reed DeLabel**

What problem in the collection work could Grant use against you?

**Hugh Bidder / Vincent Van Faux / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid / Ella Gance / Penny Pincher**

What dispute did your dealings with Grant leave you hiding?

**Frank Lloyd Wrong / Elle Loominate / Al Baster / Anne E. Dote**

What would Grant change about your commission or public program?

**Paige Turner / Mona Lott / Drew Conclusions / Robin Banks / Justin Tyme**

What did Grant want made public, and what did you not want made public?

**Dada DiCapo / Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates / Faye Stop / Minnie Malist**

What did Grant expect you to deliver, and why did that put you in trouble?

*Your speaking box is on page 6. Turn only within this act.*

**Dada DiCapo**

# Your Answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you. After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

## IF INNOCENT

> Donor Collapse was an empty dinner jacket falling from a gilded chair. I made the film. Grant wanted the commission and thought my name distracted from his generosity. Vincent knows the sort of work I made before anyone paid attention. I wanted this one remembered as mine. And yes, I was going to make that room uncomfortable. I had an excellent reason.

## IF MURDERER

> Donor Collapse was an empty dinner jacket falling from a gilded chair. I made the film. Grant wanted my name removed while his foundation acquired it. Vincent knows what it cost to get anyone to take my work seriously. Grant expected gratitude for erasing me from it. I was going to make that room uncomfortable. He was not going to enjoy the version he bought.




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What did you do about the performance, privacy or private service?

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**Dada DiCapo**

# Your Answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you. After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

## IF INNOCENT

I kept trying to restore the canceled collapse cue. I went to the private room for the coordinator. Grant's place was set. I had the film on my phone and showed her the falling jacket. I wanted the screen on during his toast. She said no again. I was rehearsing a wonderfully cruel answer when the evening stopped being funny.

## IF MURDERER

The coordinator refused my public collapse cue. I showed her the jacket film on my phone in the gallery. I stayed there after she left. I didn't go into Grant's private room to try his chair or sit beside his glass. I still wanted the screen on during his toast. There was a difference between that and the private version he and I had discussed.

STOP

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# Questions for the Room

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What happened to the toast and the announcement?

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What was actually on display, and what had your department been told?

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What did people actually see, hear, and drink?

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# Your Answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you. After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

## IF INNOCENT

> An empty jacket falls off a chair. That is the film. Grant rejected it, and I kept pushing. I wanted him sitting through it while everyone else laughed. Alive and furious. Vincent, don't try to make that sound kind. It wasn't.

## IF MURDERER

> Of course I took a little from the bottle. It was for Donor Collapse. Grant had agreed to the private live version after his toast; he only canceled the public program. I thought the contents were inert. I wasn't rehearsing by his glass, and I expected him to get up. That is what we had agreed.

*The shared discoveries and reports remain at the Evidence Table.*

STOP **STOP! Do not turn the page yet.**
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# BALLOT

**Dada DiCapo**

Choose one attending guest. Explain your accusation in your own words. Detach this page and give only the ballot to the host for tallying. Keep your packet for Coming Clean.

## I accuse...

## Because...

## Best Actor

## Best Costume

**Dada DiCapo**

# The Last Word

Read only when the host calls you. Top three suspects read first. Use your own role's box; keep every other word private.

## IF INNOCENT / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I planned an insult. The delivered film and Grant's rejection tell you what it was: an empty jacket, no live performer. I pushed the coordinator and went to his room because I wanted it shown. I did not kill him. Vincent, please don't tell me I can make work about this. I know. I am going to need a very long time before I want to.

## IF MURDERER / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

There was no agreed live fall. Grant's rejection meant what it said. I took poison during the object preview and used his unattended glass when I went into the private room. Then I told you his death began as an approved stunt. The film gave that lie something visible to lean on. It was an empty jacket in a chair, not consent to what I did to him. He took my name off his show. Vincent, there is no artistic explanation that makes this better. I kept wanting the room to look at my work. Now everyone is looking at what I did.

*Every selected suspect gets their final word.*

# Murder Mystery

*Dinner Party 2026*



# Vincent Van Faux

*The Meridian Museum*

October 30, 2026 / Private player packet / 1 of 12

**Vincent Van Faux**

## *Celebrated Contemporary Painter*

Vincent believes even his shopping lists belong in a documentary. He is truly a genius of the visual arts. Vincent became famous young and has been trying ever since to convince people that this is not the same thing as becoming famous accidentally.

- Went to art school with **Dada DiCapo**. **Dada** enjoys reminding Vincent of this in front of collectors.
- **Hugh Bidder** wants to represent Vincent. Vincent has yet to approve **Hugh**'s percentage.
- **Penny Pincher** keeps showing Vincent photos of paintings and asking what they are worth. He's not interested.
- **Al Baster** compares their commissions by weight. Vincent would prefer to discuss the price.

### ACTING TIPS

Warm, competitive, mercurial, self-aware enough to joke about his ego but not enough to lose it.

### YOUR INTRODUCTION / READ THE BOX ALOUD

> I'm Vincent Van Faux. My new work is here tonight. My early work is also here, despite several very expensive objections.

*Continue to your private briefing on page 3. Keep the packet facing you.*

Vincent Van Faux

# Tips for a Successful Dinner

## What's at Stake

Early fame froze him as a young prodigy. He envies Dada's ability to move forward and fears he has already made his best work.

## Best Practices

- Everyone, including you, has something to hide, something at stake. But only one guest tonight is guilty of murder.
- Mingle using the relationships on your introduction page. Feel free to improvise in conversations.
- If a named guest is absent, simply speak to someone else. Not everyone made it to the gala tonight.
- By now, you should have drawn a secret animal. Memorize it and don’t share it with anyone. This animal is YOUR key to knowing whether you are the murderer or innocent tonight. This will tell you which sections of this packet you can read out loud.
- When asked to read from this packet, please read the appropriate box as written. Feel free to add your own flair to stay in character.
- Don't let anyone else see what's in your packet!




**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.**
**Wait for the host to announce the next round.**

**Vincent Van Faux**

# The Game is Afoot

The Meridian Museum has its share of secrets, rumors, and lost paperwork. Sixteen numbered envelopes are hidden around the museum. Their contents may significantly help you tonight. These 3 hints lead to 3 different hiding places. If you find an envelope, bring it to your seat at the table. The guest with the most envelopes will win a special prize. You may investigate together.

1 *Find the biography of the man who chose conscience over obedience. Its pages have company.*

2 *Look inside the vessel that usually gives cut flowers a place to stand.*

3 *Find the green light, then examine the space nearby.*

STOP **STOP! Do not turn the page yet.**
**Wait for the host to announce the next round.**

# Questions for the Room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 6, then choose the next guest.

**Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Sue Venir / Tess Tament**

What would Grant's terms change for the museum or your family?

**Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Dr. Art E. Fact / Anya Tique / Reed DeLabel**

What problem in the collection work could Grant use against you?

**Hugh Bidder / Vincent Van Faux / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid / Ella Gance / Penny Pincher**

What dispute did your dealings with Grant leave you hiding?

**Frank Lloyd Wrong / Elle Loominate / Al Baster / Anne E. Dote**

What would Grant change about your commission or public program?

**Paige Turner / Mona Lott / Drew Conclusions / Robin Banks / Justin Tyme**

What did Grant want made public, and what did you not want made public?

**Dada DiCapo / Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates / Faye Stop / Minnie Malist**

What did Grant expect you to deliver, and why did that put you in trouble?

*Your speaking box is on page 6. Turn only within this act.*

**Vincent Van Faux**

# Your Answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you. After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

## IF INNOCENT

He kept exhibiting the early picture. My breakthrough, apparently. I painted it to pay rent. Now he'd commissioned the bottle study and wanted to print it beside his rescue announcement. I withdrew permission. Hugh told me to be less difficult. Dada, you kept making new work while I got invited to explain the old one. Grant liked having that old version of me on his wall.

## IF MURDERER

He kept exhibiting the early picture. My breakthrough, apparently. I painted it to pay rent. Now he wanted the bottle study printed beside his rescue announcement. I withdrew permission; he could hold my final payment. Hugh told me to be less difficult. Dada, you kept making new work. Grant could buy another picture from me and still introduce me as the boy who painted his first.

STOP

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# Questions for the Room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 8, then choose the next guest.

**Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Sue Venir / Tess Tament**

What did you change about the announcement, accounts or private arrangements?

**Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Dr. Art E. Fact / Anya Tique / Reed DeLabel**

What did you change, handle or keep from the incoming loans and their paperwork?

**Hugh Bidder / Vincent Van Faux / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid / Ella Gance / Penny Pincher**

What did you keep out of the handout, demonstration or publicity?

**Frank Lloyd Wrong / Elle Loominate / Al Baster / Anne E. Dote**

What did you change when the installation and gala plans were disputed?

**Paige Turner / Mona Lott / Drew Conclusions / Robin Banks / Justin Tyme**

What did you record, circulate or give to the people at the gala?

**Dada DiCapo / Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates / Faye Stop / Minnie Malist**

What did you do about the performance, privacy or private service?

*Your speaking box is on page 8. Turn only within this act.*

# Your Answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you. After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

## IF INNOCENT

I crossed the reproduction off the handout proof and showed the collectors the painting. The bottle came from a sale photograph. I made a studio model to work out the light. At the preview I saw Grant's acquired bottle. My studio things weren't in his loan. Hugh, I know you could sell the whole arrangement. I would still like to be asked first.

## IF MURDERER

I crossed reproduction off the proof and showed the collectors the painting. I'd used a sale photograph and a studio model for the light. I attended the preview. Later I took Grant's unsigned reproduction release to his place. His glass caught the light there, too. He wasn't around. I left the release beside it. Hugh, you could sell the arrangement. My painting wasn't a signature on every object you put beside it.

STOP

**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.**
**Wait for the host to announce the next round.**

# Questions for the Room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 10, then choose the next guest.

**Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Sue Venir / Tess Tament**

What happened to the toast and the announcement?

**Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Dr. Art E. Fact / Anya Tique / Reed DeLabel**

What was actually on display, and what had your department been told?

**Hugh Bidder / Vincent Van Faux / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid / Ella Gance / Penny Pincher**

What do you know about the bottle, pictures, or technology you brought tonight?

**Frank Lloyd Wrong / Elle Loominate / Al Baster / Anne E. Dote**

Could the work or the tour have hidden what happened?

**Paige Turner / Mona Lott / Drew Conclusions / Robin Banks / Justin Tyme**

What part of the story have your sources left out?

**Dada DiCapo / Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates / Faye Stop / Minnie Malist**

What did people actually see, hear, and drink?

*Your speaking box is on page 10. Turn only within this act.*

# Your Answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you. After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

## IF INNOCENT

> The model is painted wood. You can see the joints. I delivered a painting of the glass bottle, using the sale photograph. The real bottle stood at the preview. Grant threatened my last payment when I withdrew permission to print the painting. Dada, I envied your work. I still do.

## IF MURDERER

> My wooden model was on the preview support. The acquired bottle was withheld. The reference sheet describes the original; it isn't a photograph of the installed prop. The delivery list doesn't name every presentation item. Grant was holding my last payment over printing rights. I had had enough of him.

*The shared discoveries and reports remain at the Evidence Table.*

**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.**
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# BALLOT

**Vincent Van Faux**

Choose one attending guest. Explain your accusation in your own words. Detach this page and give only the ballot to the host for tallying. Keep your packet for Coming Clean.

## I accuse...

## Because...

## Best Actor

## Best Costume

# The Last Word

Read only when the host calls you. Top three suspects read first. Use your own role's box; keep every other word private.

## IF INNOCENT / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I did not kill Grant. My model was wood; the loan was glass. The delivery list separates the painting from the object. I withdrew reproduction permission even with payment outstanding. I also let Grant sell a grander story about my early work than it deserved. Dada, I owe you a conversation without collectors listening. Bring the bad student paintings. I could stand to remember what trying felt like.

## IF MURDERER / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I killed Grant. The preview bottle was his acquired original, not my studio model. I used the model story to make the source sound harmless. I took poison during the preview and later put it in his waiting glass. My delivery list never included a model; the intake photograph showed his bottle. He had bought a picture. Dada kept making work. I kept wanting someone else to remove the man who made me feel small. There is no picture I can paint that excuses doing it myself.

*Every selected suspect gets their final word.*

# Murder Mystery

*Dinner Party 2026*



# Sue Venir

*The Meridian Museum*

October 30, 2026 / Private player packet / 1 of 12

**Sue Venir**

## *Cultural Property Attorney*

Sue corrects the fine print on dinner menus. Sue is the lawyer museums call when an object has three owners, four countries, six contradictory export documents, and one increasingly angry newspaper.

- Works with **Artie Ficial** and **Monet Bags** on museum contracts.
- Has argued opposite sides of restitution cases with **Mona Lott**. They're ruthless opponents but still besties.
- **Dr. Art E. Fact** supplies expert opinions for Sue's cases. Sue usually asks for a shorter version.

### ACTING TIPS

A lawyer with sass: precise, formidable, patient, amused by sloppy certainty. Ask pointed questions and answer only the question actually asked.

### YOUR INTRODUCTION / READ THE BOX ALOUD

> I'm Sue Venir. Lovely to meet you. Nothing I say over dinner constitutes legal advice, although I will be keeping notes.

*Continue to your private briefing on page 3. Keep the packet facing you.*

**Sue Venir**

# Tips for a Successful Dinner

## What's at Stake

Fierce loyalty to Mona conflicts with the habit of hiding behind procedure when personal trust is needed.

## Best Practices

- Everyone, including you, has something to hide, something at stake. But only one guest tonight is guilty of murder.
- Mingle using the relationships on your introduction page. Feel free to improvise in conversations.
- If a named guest is absent, simply speak to someone else. Not everyone made it to the gala tonight.
- By now, you should have drawn a secret animal. Memorize it and don’t share it with anyone. This animal is YOUR key to knowing whether you are the murderer or innocent tonight. This will tell you which sections of this packet you can read out loud.
- When asked to read from this packet, please read the appropriate box as written. Feel free to add your own flair to stay in character.
- Don't let anyone else see what's in your packet!




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**Wait for the host to announce the next round.**

**Sue Venir**

# The Game is Afoot

The Meridian Museum has its share of secrets, rumors, and lost paperwork. Sixteen numbered envelopes are hidden around the museum. Their contents may significantly help you tonight. These 3 hints lead to 3 different hiding places. If you find an envelope, bring it to your seat at the table. The guest with the most envelopes will win a special prize. You may investigate together.

1 *Find a chair that a magnet might fancy. Look beneath its seat.*

2 *Open the cupboard where ordinary things have been given a private gallery.*

3 *Look above the large door that admits the household vehicles.*

**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.**
**Wait for the host to announce the next round.**

# Questions for the Room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 6, then choose the next guest.

**Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Sue Venir / Tess Tament**

What would Grant's terms change for the museum or your family?

**Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Dr. Art E. Fact / Anya Tique / Reed DeLabel**

What problem in the collection work could Grant use against you?

**Hugh Bidder / Vincent Van Faux / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid / Ella Gance / Penny Pincher**

What dispute did your dealings with Grant leave you hiding?

**Frank Lloyd Wrong / Elle Loominate / Al Baster / Anne E. Dote**

What would Grant change about your commission or public program?

**Paige Turner / Mona Lott / Drew Conclusions / Robin Banks / Justin Tyme**

What did Grant want made public, and what did you not want made public?

**Dada DiCapo / Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates / Faye Stop / Minnie Malist**

What did Grant expect you to deliver, and why did that put you in trouble?

*Your speaking box is on page 6. Turn only within this act.*

**Sue Venir**

# Your Answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you. After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

## IF INNOCENT

He intended to announce the gift before a board vote. Its terms gave him approval of future acquisitions. I had advised on the troublesome ownership file already. Mona and I can argue a case all afternoon and still have dinner together. Grant thought disagreement meant somebody must lose. I wanted his microphone stopped until there was an agreement worth announcing.

## IF MURDERER

He intended to announce the gift before a board vote. Its terms gave him approval of future acquisitions. He also had the ownership file carrying my earlier advice. He could put it before the board whenever I objected. Mona and I know how to disagree without destroying someone. Grant was enjoying the alternative. I wanted his microphone stopped.




**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.**
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# Questions for the Room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 8, then choose the next guest.

**Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Sue Venir / Tess Tament**

What did you change about the announcement, accounts or private arrangements?

**Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Dr. Art E. Fact / Anya Tique / Reed DeLabel**

What did you change, handle or keep from the incoming loans and their paperwork?

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What did you do about the performance, privacy or private service?

*Your speaking box is on page 8. Turn only within this act.*

**Sue Venir**

# Your Answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you. After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

## IF INNOCENT

> Artie and I argued at the public announcement desk. I removed the unsigned agreement, kept the marked running order, and told the coordinator not to substitute Grant's donor copy. My advice was attached to that transaction. Mona, I was short with you. I am still not accepting your letter as a government order. We can be furious with each other somewhere else tomorrow.

## IF MURDERER

> Artie and I stopped the announcement at the public desk. I kept the running order; my earlier advice was attached to the transaction. I also went to Grant's private place for his donor copy. The glass stood on it. I lifted the glass and pulled the paper free. You can see why I'd want that copy. Mona, I was short with you. I had spent the evening trying to prevent a round of applause from becoming a binding agreement.

STOP

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# Questions for the Room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 10, then choose the next guest.

**Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Sue Venir / Tess Tament**

What happened to the toast and the announcement?

**Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Dr. Art E. Fact / Anya Tique / Reed DeLabel**

What was actually on display, and what had your department been told?

**Hugh Bidder / Vincent Van Faux / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid / Ella Gance / Penny Pincher**

What do you know about the bottle, pictures, or technology you brought tonight?

**Frank Lloyd Wrong / Elle Loominate / Al Baster / Anne E. Dote**

Could the work or the tour have hidden what happened?

**Paige Turner / Mona Lott / Drew Conclusions / Robin Banks / Justin Tyme**

What part of the story have your sources left out?

**Dada DiCapo / Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates / Faye Stop / Minnie Malist**

What did people actually see, hear, and drink?

*Your speaking box is on page 10. Turn only within this act.*

**Sue Venir**

# Your Answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you. After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

## IF INNOCENT

I stopped the public acceptance announcement. The next line allowed the private toast. The coordinator kept my markup; I took the unsigned master at the public desk. My ownership objection went to the board with my earlier advice attached. Mona, sit down. We can be angry with each other seated.

## IF MURDERER

The manager poured the punch in Grant's room while I was there. That was my only visit. I lifted the glass to get his agreement out from under it, and stayed while it was filled. My public markup allowed hospitality. Mona, sit down before I have to catch you.

*The shared discoveries and reports remain at the Evidence Table.*

STOP

**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.**
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# BALLOT

**Sue Venir**

Choose one attending guest. Explain your accusation in your own words. Detach this page and give only the ballot to the host for tallying. Keep your packet for Coming Clean.

## I accuse...

## Because...

## Best Actor

## Best Costume

# The Last Word

Read only when the host calls you. Top three suspects read first. Use your own role's box; keep every other word private.

## IF INNOCENT / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I did not kill Grant. I took the master at the public desk, and private service continued. My objection reached the board with the bad advice still attached. I should have challenged that ownership file sooner. Mona, tomorrow I will argue the authority of your letter again. Tonight I would like to go home with my friend. Neither of us has to win that conversation.

## IF MURDERER / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I killed Grant. Removing the public announcement copy was real. My separate visit to his private place was not supervised. I took his donor copy and contaminated the waiting glass with poison I'd taken during the preview. I invented the pour beside me to put a witness in that room. The manager poured in the kitchen, after collecting the glass. Grant had my advice attached to the ownership file. He could expose what I had approved. Mona, I have made it impossible for you to sit beside me without wondering what I could do. That is worse than losing any case.

*Every selected suspect gets their final word.*

# Murder Mystery

*Dinner Party 2026*



# Dr. Art E. Fact

*The Meridian Museum*

October 30, 2026 / Private player packet / 1 of 12

**Dr. Art E. Fact**

## *Professor of Art History & Provenance Scholar*

Art has never met a footnote he could not lengthen. Art has built a career tracing the lives of objects through wars, estates, auctions, private collections, and suspicious gaps in paperwork.

- Supervises **Reed DeLabel**'s doctoral research and sends drafts back covered in notes.
- Secretly infatuated with the enigmatic energy of **Dada DiCapo**. Will she notice him?
- Trusts only **Chip Patina** to say when the physical evidence contradicts Art's theory.

### ACTING TIPS

Intense, professorial, curious, occasionally pedantic, sincerely excited by evidence.

### YOUR INTRODUCTION / READ THE BOX ALOUD

> I'm Dr. Art E. Fact. I bring decades of scholarship and a footnote for almost every possible dinner conversation. Looking forward to intellectual discussions tonight!

*Continue to your private briefing on page 3. Keep the packet facing you.*

Dr. Art E. Fact

# Tips for a Successful Dinner

## What's at Stake

Infatuation with Dada makes public intellectual humiliation feel especially unbearable.

## Best Practices

- Everyone, including you, has something to hide, something at stake. But only one guest tonight is guilty of murder.
- Mingle using the relationships on your introduction page. Feel free to improvise in conversations.
- If a named guest is absent, simply speak to someone else. Not everyone made it to the gala tonight.
- By now, you should have drawn a secret animal. Memorize it and don’t share it with anyone. This animal is YOUR key to knowing whether you are the murderer or innocent tonight. This will tell you which sections of this packet you can read out loud.
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**Dr. Art E. Fact**

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1 *Your reflection cannot look up far enough to see what rests on the mirror.*

2 *Look behind a painting rather than into its scenery.*

3 *The household's Bible has received a very unofficial insert.*

STOP **STOP! Do not turn the page yet.**
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# Questions for the Room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 6, then choose the next guest.

**Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Sue Venir / Tess Tament**

What would Grant's terms change for the museum or your family?

**Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Dr. Art E. Fact / Anya Tique / Reed DeLabel**

What problem in the collection work could Grant use against you?

**Hugh Bidder / Vincent Van Faux / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid / Ella Gance / Penny Pincher**

What dispute did your dealings with Grant leave you hiding?

**Frank Lloyd Wrong / Elle Loominate / Al Baster / Anne E. Dote**

What would Grant change about your commission or public program?

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What did Grant expect you to deliver, and why did that put you in trouble?

*Your speaking box is on page 6. Turn only within this act.*

# Your Answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you. After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

## IF INNOCENT

Reed found a gap in my ownership citation. Grant found it inconvenient, which is not a scholarly objection. I asked to hold the earlier press copies; he wanted my name on them before the correction. Dada was here. I had hoped to discuss something rather more impressive with her. A ridiculous concern, given the size of the actual error. Still, there it is.

## IF MURDERER

Reed found a gap in my ownership citation. Grant could expose it whenever I withdrew authority from his catalog. I asked to hold the earlier press copies; he wanted them circulating first. Dada was here. I had imagined a rather different conversation with her. Grant was going to make sure my most attentive audience heard about the error before anything else.

STOP

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# Questions for the Room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 8, then choose the next guest.

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What did you change, handle or keep from the incoming loans and their paperwork?

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What did you keep out of the handout, demonstration or publicity?

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What did you record, circulate or give to the people at the gala?

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What did you do about the performance, privacy or private service?

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# Your Answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you. After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

## IF INNOCENT

The purchase attachment said original contents. My draft said inert. I asked Reed to hold the early press copies. Grant said people had paid to see his bottle, not my question mark. I let the preview go ahead. I knew what cyanide meant; I did not need another reference book. Dada, you asked why I was so quiet. I was waiting for somebody with more authority to stop it. I was the authority in that conversation.

## IF MURDERER

I asked Reed to restore the collection attachment. My draft used the inert description; a query remained beside it. I attended the preview. Grant wanted me to explain the collection during his toast. I went to his place to object to that introduction. Nobody there. A glass and the speech card with my name on it. I turned the card over and left. Petty, yes. I have apparently reached the stage of my career where I take revenge on stationery.

STOP

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# Questions for the Room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 10, then choose the next guest.

**Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Sue Venir / Tess Tament**

What happened to the toast and the announcement?

**Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Dr. Art E. Fact / Anya Tique / Reed DeLabel**

What was actually on display, and what had your department been told?

**Hugh Bidder / Vincent Van Faux / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid / Ella Gance / Penny Pincher**

What do you know about the bottle, pictures, or technology you brought tonight?

**Frank Lloyd Wrong / Elle Loominate / Al Baster / Anne E. Dote**

Could the work or the tour have hidden what happened?

**Paige Turner / Mona Lott / Drew Conclusions / Robin Banks / Justin Tyme**

What part of the story have your sources left out?

**Dada DiCapo / Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates / Faye Stop / Minnie Malist**

What did people actually see, hear, and drink?

*Your speaking box is on page 10. Turn only within this act.*

# Your Answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you. After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

## IF INNOCENT

> My query says original contents. I wrote it. The reply says unresolved, keep closed. Then I let the guests hear inert. Reed has the full text; ask him for it. Dada, please give me a moment. This is rather different from the conversation I had hoped to have with you.

## IF MURDERER

> I hadn't read the purchase condition before the gala. My query was about the object's history. I used the lender's description; the dealer's attachment wasn't part of that research. Reed, my ownership citation was poor. You may say so. It doesn't mean I had read a different document.

*The shared discoveries and reports remain at the Evidence Table.*

**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.**
**Wait for the host to announce the next round.**

# BALLOT

**Dr. Art E. Fact**

Choose one attending guest. Explain your accusation in your own words. Detach this page and give only the ballot to the host for tallying. Keep your packet for Coming Clean.

## I accuse...

## Because...

## Best Actor

## Best Costume

Dr. Art E. Fact

# The Last Word

Read only when the host calls you. Top three suspects read first. Use your own role's box; keep every other word private.

## IF INNOCENT / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I did not kill Grant. My dated query quotes the contents condition; intake answered that it remained unresolved. I let the entry proceed. Reed, your finding deserves your name. Dada, the invitation to dinner I kept disguising as a discussion of your work was an invitation to dinner. You need not answer it tonight. I am trying to say one thing without a footnote.

## IF MURDERER / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I had read the condition. My own query quotes it. I denied that knowledge because it explained why I knew the bottle might still hold its original contents. I took the poison during the preview and used it in Grant's private glass. The ownership correction was not going to stop him circulating my mistake. I decided to stop him instead. I have spent a career distinguishing an object from the story sold with it. Dada, you need not explain your work to me. Reed, you need never seek my approval. I have used my knowledge for the smallest possible purpose.

*Every selected suspect gets their final word.*

# Murder Mystery

*Dinner Party 2026*



# Tess Tament

*The Meridian Museum*

October 30, 2026 / Private player packet / 1 of 12

**Tess Tament**

## *Philanthropist & Heir to the Larceny Family Fortune*

Tess speaks fluent inheritance and has strong opinions about the seating plan. Tess is the only member of the Larceny dynasty who can attend an arts gala without immediately being asked for a check, mostly because everyone genuinely appreciates her opinion on culture.

• Knows **Hugh Bidder** from the collector circuit. Her crush on him is the only thing capable of flustering her.

• Has commissioned work from **Dada DiCapo** and is still explaining one of the pieces to visitors.

• Asks **Mona Lott** which international exhibitions might need a generous sponsor.

### ACTING TIPS

Composed, witty, guarded, generous when she chooses. You grew up around power and recognize its rituals instantly.

### YOUR INTRODUCTION / READ THE BOX ALOUD

> I'm Tess Tament. I represent the family foundation. Contrary to what some here may think, being related to a donor is a responsibility, not a cash machine.

*Continue to your private briefing on page 3. Keep the packet facing you.*

**Tess Tament**

# Tips for a Successful Dinner

## What's at Stake

Longing for authority coexists with an unwanted need for Grant's approval. Her crush on Hugh makes vulnerability public.

## Best Practices

- Everyone, including you, has something to hide, something at stake. But only one guest tonight is guilty of murder.
- Mingle using the relationships on your introduction page. Feel free to improvise in conversations.
- If a named guest is absent, simply speak to someone else. Not everyone made it to the gala tonight.
- By now, you should have drawn a secret animal. Memorize it and don’t share it with anyone. This animal is YOUR key to knowing whether you are the murderer or innocent tonight. This will tell you which sections of this packet you can read out loud.
- When asked to read from this packet, please read the appropriate box as written. Feel free to add your own flair to stay in character.
- Don't let anyone else see what's in your packet!




**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.**
**Wait for the host to announce the next round.**

**Tess Tament**

# The Game is Afoot

The Meridian Museum has its share of secrets, rumors, and lost paperwork. Sixteen numbered envelopes are hidden around the museum. Their contents may significantly help you tonight. These 3 hints lead to 3 different hiding places. If you find an envelope, bring it to your seat at the table. The guest with the most envelopes will win a special prize. You may investigate together.

**1** *A piano's electric cousin is hiding a note that cannot be played. Look beneath it.*

**2** *Spain has a clue for you. Find Barcelona without leaving the house.*

**3** *The blue cushion is comfortable. Its secret is not meant to stay buried.*

STOP **STOP! Do not turn the page yet.**
**Wait for the host to announce the next round.**

# Questions for the Room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 6, then choose the next guest.

**Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Sue Venir / Tess Tament**

What would Grant's terms change for the museum or your family?

**Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Dr. Art E. Fact / Anya Tique / Reed DeLabel**

What problem in the collection work could Grant use against you?

**Hugh Bidder / Vincent Van Faux / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid / Ella Gance / Penny Pincher**

What dispute did your dealings with Grant leave you hiding?

**Frank Lloyd Wrong / Elle Loominate / Al Baster / Anne E. Dote**

What would Grant change about your commission or public program?

**Paige Turner / Mona Lott / Drew Conclusions / Robin Banks / Justin Tyme**

What did Grant want made public, and what did you not want made public?

**Dada DiCapo / Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates / Faye Stop / Minnie Malist**

What did Grant expect you to deliver, and why did that put you in trouble?

*Your speaking box is on page 6. Turn only within this act.*

**Tess Tament**

# Your Answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you. After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

## IF INNOCENT

> Family gift for the photograph. His gift when I asked for a say. I asked Sue about the succession clause before agreeing to pose. Grant wanted me glamorous and agreeable beside it. I know how to do both. Hugh has seen me fail at agreeable. I wanted a chair in the decisions, and I wanted Grant to think I deserved it. Those wants kept getting mixed up.

## IF MURDERER

> Family gift for the photograph. His gift when I asked for a say. I asked Sue about the succession clause. Grant had decided how the family seat would pass and still expected me to wait for it. Hugh has seen me fail at agreeable. I was tired of waiting while Grant praised me for being patient. He called it trust. It felt like being kept outside.




**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.**
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# Questions for the Room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 8, then choose the next guest.

**Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Sue Venir / Tess Tament**

What did you change about the announcement, accounts or private arrangements?

**Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Dr. Art E. Fact / Anya Tique / Reed DeLabel**

What did you change, handle or keep from the incoming loans and their paperwork?

**Hugh Bidder / Vincent Van Faux / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid / Ella Gance / Penny Pincher**

What did you keep out of the handout, demonstration or publicity?

**Frank Lloyd Wrong / Elle Loominate / Al Baster / Anne E. Dote**

What did you change when the installation and gala plans were disputed?

**Paige Turner / Mona Lott / Drew Conclusions / Robin Banks / Justin Tyme**

What did you record, circulate or give to the people at the gala?

**Dada DiCapo / Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates / Faye Stop / Minnie Malist**

What did you do about the performance, privacy or private service?

*Your speaking box is on page 8. Turn only within this act.*

# Your Answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you. After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

## IF INNOCENT

I ordered the gift glass through the shop and requested a private toast. I wanted the family argument away from the podium. During the reception I went there; his glass was waiting and he wasn't. I left the revised seating card and went to find Sue. I had rehearsed what to say to him. It sounded braver in the car.

## IF MURDERER

I bought the gift glass and asked for a private toast. The family argument wasn't going onstage. I went to his place during the reception; the glass was waiting and he wasn't. I left the revised seating card. I waited longer than I meant to, then went to find Sue. He could make me feel twelve years old simply by not showing up. I'd arranged the privacy. I meant to use it to get a real answer from him.

STOP

**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.**
**Wait for the host to announce the next round.**

# Questions for the Room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 10, then choose the next guest.

**Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Sue Venir / Tess Tament**

What happened to the toast and the announcement?

**Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Dr. Art E. Fact / Anya Tique / Reed DeLabel**

What was actually on display, and what had your department been told?

**Hugh Bidder / Vincent Van Faux / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid / Ella Gance / Penny Pincher**

What do you know about the bottle, pictures, or technology you brought tonight?

**Frank Lloyd Wrong / Elle Loominate / Al Baster / Anne E. Dote**

Could the work or the tour have hidden what happened?

**Paige Turner / Mona Lott / Drew Conclusions / Robin Banks / Justin Tyme**

What part of the story have your sources left out?

**Dada DiCapo / Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates / Faye Stop / Minnie Malist**

What did people actually see, hear, and drink?

*Your speaking box is on page 10. Turn only within this act.*

# Your Answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you. After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

## IF INNOCENT

> His glass was unwrapped when I left the seating card. I was annoyed they'd already made my present into service equipment. The manager had the toast; I went looking for Sue. The donor seat depends on the board accepting the gift. I asked for an appointment while Grant was alive. Sue, I keep remembering that I bought him a glass. Such a stupid thing to be unable to stop thinking about.

## IF MURDERER

> His glass was wrapped when I left the seating card. The manager opened it for the pour and took it directly to Grant. The donor seat depends on board approval. I asked for an appointment while he was alive. Sue, I keep remembering that I bought him a glass. I wanted him to use something I had chosen for him.

*The shared discoveries and reports remain at the Evidence Table.*

STOP

**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.**
**Wait for the host to announce the next round.**

# BALLOT

**Tess Tament**

Choose one attending guest. Explain your accusation in your own words. Detach this page and give only the ballot to the host for tallying. Keep your packet for Coming Clean.

## I accuse...

## Because...

## Best Actor

## Best Costume

# The Last Word

Read only when the host calls you. Top three suspects read first. Use your own role's box; keep every other word private.

## IF INNOCENT / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I did not poison Grant. The draft shows I asked for the family appointment while he was alive; the board had not accepted the gift. His glass was already bare when I left my card. I do inherit. I was angry. Hugh, please don't tell me how fortunate that makes me. I have an argument waiting for someone who will never answer it, and I still want him to answer.

## IF MURDERER / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I killed Grant. His glass was already unwrapped when I left the seating card. I used poison I'd taken during the preview, then told you the shop wrapping had stayed on until the manager poured. The manager's account left an unattended glass where my account put a wrapped present. I ordered that glass and arranged the room. I knew how ordinary my visit would look. I wanted his authority without having to keep asking him for it. The agreement was still unsigned. I wanted him to hear me as an adult. Now every room in that family house will remind me of the person I made sure could never answer.

*Every selected suspect gets their final word.*

# Murder Mystery

*Dinner Party 2026*



# Barb Dwyer

*The Meridian Museum*

October 30, 2026 / Private player packet / 1 of 12

## INTRODUCTIONS

**Barb Dwyer**

# *Director of Museum Security & Former Art-Crimes Investigator*

Barb has already assessed which guests could fit through the air vents. Barb spent years in the CIA investigating stolen art before discovering that museums contain nearly as much intrigue with better climate control.

- Coordinates museum security with **Artie Ficial** and **Chip Patina**.
- **Paige Turner** keeps requesting access Barb has already refused.
- Makes **Brie DeVivre** revise the service routes. **Brie** would like one final version.

## ACTING TIPS

Low-key, skeptical, dry, watchful. Ask where people were and remember their answers.

## YOUR INTRODUCTION / READ THE BOX ALOUD

> I'm Barb Dwyer. I am security. Please behave as though I have already noticed whatever you are about to try.

*Continue to your private briefing on page 3. Keep the packet facing you.*

**Barb Dwyer**

# Tips for a Successful Dinner

## What's at Stake

She has spent her career withholding emotion to avoid appearing vulnerable. A preventable blind spot destroys that defense.

## Best Practices

- Everyone, including you, has something to hide, something at stake. But only one guest tonight is guilty of murder.
- Mingle using the relationships on your introduction page. Feel free to improvise in conversations.
- If a named guest is absent, simply speak to someone else. Not everyone made it to the gala tonight.
- By now, you should have drawn a secret animal. Memorize it and don’t share it with anyone. This animal is YOUR key to knowing whether you are the murderer or innocent tonight. This will tell you which sections of this packet you can read out loud.
- When asked to read from this packet, please read the appropriate box as written. Feel free to add your own flair to stay in character.
- Don't let anyone else see what's in your packet!




**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.**
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**Barb Dwyer**

# The Game is Afoot

The Meridian Museum has its share of secrets, rumors, and lost paperwork. Sixteen numbered envelopes are hidden around the museum. Their contents may significantly help you tonight. These 3 hints lead to 3 different hiding places. If you find an envelope, bring it to your seat at the table. The guest with the most envelopes will win a special prize. You may investigate together.

**1** *A champion's keepsake is concealing something beneath its base.*

**2** *The red curtains conceal more than the view beyond the window.*

**3** *An icy archive is preserving something other than supper.*

STOP **STOP! Do not turn the page yet.**
**Wait for the host to announce the next round.**

# Questions for the Room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 6, then choose the next guest.

**Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Sue Venir / Tess Tament**

What would Grant's terms change for the museum or your family?

**Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Dr. Art E. Fact / Anya Tique / Reed DeLabel**

What problem in the collection work could Grant use against you?

**Hugh Bidder / Vincent Van Faux / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid / Ella Gance / Penny Pincher**

What dispute did your dealings with Grant leave you hiding?

**Frank Lloyd Wrong / Elle Loominate / Al Baster / Anne E. Dote**

What would Grant change about your commission or public program?

**Paige Turner / Mona Lott / Drew Conclusions / Robin Banks / Justin Tyme**

What did Grant want made public, and what did you not want made public?

**Dada DiCapo / Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates / Faye Stop / Minnie Malist**

What did Grant expect you to deliver, and why did that put you in trouble?

*Your speaking box is on page 6. Turn only within this act.*

**Barb Dwyer**

# Your Answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you. After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

## IF INNOCENT

> Grant requested privacy from the live monitor. I agreed. A donor gets an exception; security gets the questions afterward. Artie wanted the evening smooth. I wanted the visiting crews out of our way. I know how that sounds. I also know how often people here ask me to be less suspicious, then ask why I didn't suspect something.

## IF MURDERER

> Grant requested privacy from the live monitor. I agreed and logged it as an equipment fault. He knew it wasn't. He could use that entry whenever I refused another request. Artie wanted the evening smooth. I wanted the visiting crews out of our way. Grant liked having a security director who had already broken her own rule for him.




**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.**
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# Questions for the Room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 8, then choose the next guest.

**Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Sue Venir / Tess Tament**

What did you change about the announcement, accounts or private arrangements?

**Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Dr. Art E. Fact / Anya Tique / Reed DeLabel**

What did you change, handle or keep from the incoming loans and their paperwork?

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What did you keep out of the handout, demonstration or publicity?

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What did you change when the installation and gala plans were disputed?

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What did you record, circulate or give to the people at the gala?

**Dada DiCapo / Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates / Faye Stop / Minnie Malist**

What did you do about the performance, privacy or private service?

*Your speaking box is on page 8. Turn only within this act.*

**Barb Dwyer**

# Your Answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you. After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

## IF INNOCENT

I took the private-room camera off the monitor and kept the outside crew out. Staff and caterers could still come through. I checked the room; Grant's place was set. I wrote fault, not privacy, in the log. When he wanted the room cleared, I cleared it. Artie used it too. Paige, you wanted a record of what happened in there. I had already made that impossible.

## IF MURDERER

I took the private-room camera off the live monitor. Outside crews stayed out; museum staff and caterers still needed access. I checked the room. Grant's place was set and nobody was there. I shut the door for a moment to check the latch, then opened it again. The fault entry was false. That exception stayed between me and the technician. Brie, tell me what your staff need. Give me a task. Sitting here is doing nothing for anybody.

STOP

**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.**
**Wait for the host to announce the next round.**

**Barb Dwyer**

# Questions for the Room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 10, then choose the next guest.

**Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Sue Venir / Tess Tament**

What happened to the toast and the announcement?

**Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Dr. Art E. Fact / Anya Tique / Reed DeLabel**

What was actually on display, and what had your department been told?

**Hugh Bidder / Vincent Van Faux / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid / Ella Gance / Penny Pincher**

What do you know about the bottle, pictures, or technology you brought tonight?

**Frank Lloyd Wrong / Elle Loominate / Al Baster / Anne E. Dote**

Could the work or the tour have hidden what happened?

**Paige Turner / Mona Lott / Drew Conclusions / Robin Banks / Justin Tyme**

What part of the story have your sources left out?

**Dada DiCapo / Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates / Faye Stop / Minnie Malist**

What did people actually see, hear, and drink?

*Your speaking box is on page 10. Turn only within this act.*

**Barb Dwyer**

# Your Answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you. After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

## IF INNOCENT

> Power. I had the power adapter removed. The network lead stayed attached, and an unpowered camera recorded nothing. I also told the technician to call it a fault. That entry was false. Paige, keep your recorder out. Brie, your staff can go when their shift ends.

## IF MURDERER

> My room check is on the camera's local recording, including the glass. The technician removed the network lead, not the power. I wrote fault in the log to get Grant his privacy. That was wrong. It doesn't erase the footage. Check the storage before calling my visit unobserved.

*The shared discoveries and reports remain at the Evidence Table.*

**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.**
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# BALLOT

**Barb Dwyer**

Choose one attending guest. Explain your accusation in your own words. Detach this page and give only the ballot to the host for tallying. Keep your packet for Coming Clean.

## I accuse...

## Because...

## Best Actor

## Best Costume

**Barb Dwyer**

# The Last Word

Read only when the host calls you. Top three suspects read first. Use your own role's box; keep every other word private.

## IF INNOCENT / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I did not kill Grant. I ordered the power removed and lied in the log. The technician's work order carries my signature. My own department created a blind spot. I will return the badge while that is investigated. Brie, make sure your staff get home before anybody starts asking them for a convenient version of tonight. They don't owe the museum one.

## IF MURDERER / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I turned recording off. The signed work order removes power, not a network lead. I checked the room so I knew where Grant's glass was waiting. I had already taken poison during the preview; I used it at that private place. Then I relied on the privacy exception to conceal the visit. I told you a local recording existed because I wanted the missing footage to sound like a problem we could fix. There is no footage to find. I used a blind spot I created. My department will have to answer for trusting the person who was supposed to keep it honest.

*Every selected suspect gets their final word.*

# Murder Mystery

*Dinner Party 2026*



# Paige Turner

*The Meridian Museum*

October 30, 2026 / Private player packet / 1 of 12

**Paige Turner**

## *Investigative Arts Journalist*

Paige asks innocent questions with a recorder visibly running. Her journalistic integrity is unmatched. Paige covers the art world for the Times of Tulsa the way other reporters cover city hall: money, power, access, and who benefits when everyone agrees to keep silent.

- Keeps asking **Barb Dwyer** for access to museum records. **Barb** keeps asking what the story is about.
- **Sue Venir** has threatened to quote Paige's own articles back to her in court.
- Calls **Reed DeLabel** to check dates and catalog references. **Reed** is delighted when a correction makes it into print.

### ACTING TIPS

Curious, direct, quick, socially fearless. Ask questions people wish you would save for email.

### YOUR INTRODUCTION / READ THE BOX ALOUD

> I'm Paige Turner. I am covering the gala. I just want to say in advance that absolutely nothing is off the record tonight.

*Continue to your private briefing on page 3. Keep the packet facing you.*

Paige Turner

# Tips for a Successful Dinner

## What's at Stake

Cannot separate protecting a vulnerable source from her need to keep being the reporter who gets the story.

## Best Practices

- Everyone, including you, has something to hide, something at stake. But only one guest tonight is guilty of murder.
- Mingle using the relationships on your introduction page. Feel free to improvise in conversations.
- If a named guest is absent, simply speak to someone else. Not everyone made it to the gala tonight.
- By now, you should have drawn a secret animal. Memorize it and don’t share it with anyone. This animal is YOUR key to knowing whether you are the murderer or innocent tonight. This will tell you which sections of this packet you can read out loud.
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Paige Turner

# The Game is Afoot

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1 *The house has its own cinema. Inspect the side the audience never sees.*

2 *A decorative vessel has traded its bouquet for evidence.*

3 *A green lamp cannot testify, but something near it can.*

STOP **STOP! Do not turn the page yet.**
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# Questions for the Room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 6, then choose the next guest.

**Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Sue Venir / Tess Tament**

What would Grant's terms change for the museum or your family?

**Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Dr. Art E. Fact / Anya Tique / Reed DeLabel**

What problem in the collection work could Grant use against you?

**Hugh Bidder / Vincent Van Faux / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid / Ella Gance / Penny Pincher**

What dispute did your dealings with Grant leave you hiding?

**Frank Lloyd Wrong / Elle Loominate / Al Baster / Anne E. Dote**

What would Grant change about your commission or public program?

**Paige Turner / Mona Lott / Drew Conclusions / Robin Banks / Justin Tyme**

What did Grant want made public, and what did you not want made public?

**Dada DiCapo / Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates / Faye Stop / Minnie Malist**

What did Grant expect you to deliver, and why did that put you in trouble?

*Your speaking box is on page 6. Turn only within this act.*

**Paige Turner**

# Your Answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you. After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

## IF INNOCENT

My article had an unsupported sentence. I owed a correction. Grant wanted the source behind the rest. Justin's property folder made his rescue story less flattering than the arts desk expected. I wanted the records with my editor before his announcement. He kept asking for a name. I keep hearing that question now. Somebody outside this room will be frightened when they learn he's dead.

## IF MURDERER

My article had an unsupported sentence. Grant's lawyer used it against the rest. Grant wanted my source and offered to leave that person alone if I supplied a name. Justin's property folder made his rescue story less flattering. I wanted the records in print. He wanted somebody he could approach without me there. Somebody outside this room will be frightened when they learn he's dead.

STOP

**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.**
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# Questions for the Room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 8, then choose the next guest.

**Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Sue Venir / Tess Tament**

What did you change about the announcement, accounts or private arrangements?

**Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Dr. Art E. Fact / Anya Tique / Reed DeLabel**

What did you change, handle or keep from the incoming loans and their paperwork?

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**Paige Turner / Mona Lott / Drew Conclusions / Robin Banks / Justin Tyme**

What did you record, circulate or give to the people at the gala?

**Dada DiCapo / Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates / Faye Stop / Minnie Malist**

What did you do about the performance, privacy or private service?

*Your speaking box is on page 8. Turn only within this act.*

**Paige Turner**

# Your Answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you. After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

## IF INNOCENT

> My recorder was in his coat at the cloakroom. He'd kept it after our interview. I searched the pocket and copied the file. Drew got a short export with the identifying part removed. My editor knew the cut and had the untrimmed file. Barb, I know I didn't have permission to search the coat. He didn't have permission to keep my recorder either.

## IF MURDERER

> Grant kept my recorder in his coat. I searched the coat at the cloakroom and copied the file there. The critic got a short export; my editor kept the original. I stayed at the cloakroom to check it. I didn't take it to his private place or leave it beside a waiting drink. Barb, yes, I searched a pocket without permission. You can put that in your report.

STOP

**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.**
**Wait for the host to announce the next round.**

# Questions for the Room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 10, then choose the next guest.

**Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Sue Venir / Tess Tament**

What happened to the toast and the announcement?

**Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Dr. Art E. Fact / Anya Tique / Reed DeLabel**

What was actually on display, and what had your department been told?

**Hugh Bidder / Vincent Van Faux / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid / Ella Gance / Penny Pincher**

What do you know about the bottle, pictures, or technology you brought tonight?

**Frank Lloyd Wrong / Elle Loominate / Al Baster / Anne E. Dote**

Could the work or the tour have hidden what happened?

**Paige Turner / Mona Lott / Drew Conclusions / Robin Banks / Justin Tyme**

What part of the story have your sources left out?

**Dada DiCapo / Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates / Faye Stop / Minnie Malist**

What did people actually see, hear, and drink?

*Your speaking box is on page 10. Turn only within this act.*

**Paige Turner**

# Your Answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you. After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

## IF INNOCENT

> Tonight, in his private room. The manager leaves his glass and goes back to the kitchen. I cut that voice from the critic's export; my editor kept the original. I won't name my source. Sue, ask me about my recording. Leave the person I was protecting out of it.

## IF MURDERER

> There was no drink between us when I interviewed him. That was yesterday, in the office. Tonight I fetched the recorder from his coat and checked the export at the cloakroom, not at his private place. The cut employee's voice protected a source. My editor has the original. Ask for that.

*The shared discoveries and reports remain at the Evidence Table.*

**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.**
**Wait for the host to announce the next round.**

# BALLOT

**Paige Turner**

Choose one attending guest. Explain your accusation in your own words. Detach this page and give only the ballot to the host for tallying. Keep your packet for Coming Clean.

## I accuse...

## Because...

## Best Actor

## Best Costume

**Paige Turner**

# The Last Word

Read only when the host calls you. Top three suspects read first. Use your own role's box; keep every other word private.

## IF INNOCENT / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I did not kill Grant. The untrimmed opening places our interview at his private table tonight. My editor had that original; I cut the employee's voice from the export. The correction will run. The source's name won't. I also need to ask that person what they want now. I have spent too much of this investigation treating being protected and being useful to me as the same thing.

## IF MURDERER / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I killed Grant. The interview was tonight at his private place, while the manager left his glass. The original opening proves it. After Grant returned to the reception I went back, alone, and used poison I'd taken at the preview. I called the interview yesterday's office conversation to make that recording unrelated to tonight. I wanted to protect my source; I chose murder instead. My editor has the original. Someone will have to tell the person who trusted me what I did with their trust.

*Every selected suspect gets their final word.*

# Murder Mystery

*Dinner Party 2026*



# Frank Lloyd Wrong

*The Meridian Museum*

October 30, 2026 / Private player packet / 1 of 12

**Frank Lloyd Wrong**

## *Exhibition Architect & Designer*

Frank considers doors a regrettable compromise in an otherwise excellent wall. Frank designed the physical experience of Treasures of the World: every wall angle, sight line, spotlight, pedestal, and dramatic reveal.

• **Chip Patina** can veto Frank's display designs. Frank tends to take the veto personally.

• **Elle Loominate** has worked on Frank's exhibition spaces. They vehemently disagree about how much room a textile needs.

• **Dada DiCapo** once described one of Frank's galleries as "an expensive corridor." Frank remembers the review.

• **Al Baster** insists the entrance was designed around his sculpture. Frank insists the sculpture was sized for his entrance.

### ACTING TIPS

Aesthetic, controlled, mildly pretentious in a lovable way, easily offended by bad placement rather than bad manners.

### YOUR INTRODUCTION / READ THE BOX ALOUD

> I'm Frank Lloyd Wrong. I designed all the displays you see around the gallery. If one more person says they have one tiny last-minute change, I'm gonna scream!

*Continue to your private briefing on page 3. Keep the packet facing you.*

**Frank Lloyd Wrong**

# Tips for a Successful Dinner

## What's at Stake

He cannot bear seeing a finished room fail. Perfection is a defense against being judged replaceable.

## Best Practices

- Everyone, including you, has something to hide, something at stake. But only one guest tonight is guilty of murder.
- Mingle using the relationships on your introduction page. Feel free to improvise in conversations.
- If a named guest is absent, simply speak to someone else. Not everyone made it to the gala tonight.
- By now, you should have drawn a secret animal. Memorize it and don’t share it with anyone. This animal is YOUR key to knowing whether you are the murderer or innocent tonight. This will tell you which sections of this packet you can read out loud.
- When asked to read from this packet, please read the appropriate box as written. Feel free to add your own flair to stay in character.
- Don't let anyone else see what's in your packet!




**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.**
**Wait for the host to announce the next round.**

**Frank Lloyd Wrong**

# The Game is Afoot

The Meridian Museum has its share of secrets, rumors, and lost paperwork. Sixteen numbered envelopes are hidden around the museum. Their contents may significantly help you tonight. These 3 hints lead to 3 different hiding places. If you find an envelope, bring it to your seat at the table. The guest with the most envelopes will win a special prize. You may investigate together.

1 *A German pastor's life story has acquired an uninvited appendix.*

2 *The household collection behind a cupboard door includes an unexpected exhibit.*

3 *The garage's broad doorway has acquired an exhibit overhead. Ask for help reaching it.*

STOP **STOP! Do not turn the page yet.**
**Wait for the host to announce the next round.**

# Questions for the Room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 6, then choose the next guest.

**Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Sue Venir / Tess Tament**

What would Grant's terms change for the museum or your family?

**Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Dr. Art E. Fact / Anya Tique / Reed DeLabel**

What problem in the collection work could Grant use against you?

**Hugh Bidder / Vincent Van Faux / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid / Ella Gance / Penny Pincher**

What dispute did your dealings with Grant leave you hiding?

**Frank Lloyd Wrong / Elle Loominate / Al Baster / Anne E. Dote**

What would Grant change about your commission or public program?

**Paige Turner / Mona Lott / Drew Conclusions / Robin Banks / Justin Tyme**

What did Grant want made public, and what did you not want made public?

**Dada DiCapo / Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates / Faye Stop / Minnie Malist**

What did Grant expect you to deliver, and why did that put you in trouble?

*Your speaking box is on page 6. Turn only within this act.*

# Your Answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you. After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

## IF INNOCENT

> The plaque was ready before the donation. Grant had already chosen where his name went. Chip raised my missing load calculation in front of him. Grant withheld the next commission until I accommodated the plaque. I told him it could wait. Please move that chair back. I know this is hardly the moment. I can still see where it ought to be.

## IF MURDERER

> The plaque was ready before the donation. Chip raised my missing load calculation in front of Grant. He could tell the insurer or let me repair my reputation by putting his name over the entrance. That was his choice for me. Please move that chair back. I know this is hardly the moment. I can still see where it ought to be.

STOP

**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.**
**Wait for the host to announce the next round.**

# Questions for the Room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 8, then choose the next guest.

**Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Sue Venir / Tess Tament**

What did you change about the announcement, accounts or private arrangements?

**Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Dr. Art E. Fact / Anya Tique / Reed DeLabel**

What did you change, handle or keep from the incoming loans and their paperwork?

**Hugh Bidder / Vincent Van Faux / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid / Ella Gance / Penny Pincher**

What did you keep out of the handout, demonstration or publicity?

**Frank Lloyd Wrong / Elle Loominate / Al Baster / Anne E. Dote**

What did you change when the installation and gala plans were disputed?

**Paige Turner / Mona Lott / Drew Conclusions / Robin Banks / Justin Tyme**

What did you record, circulate or give to the people at the gala?

**Dada DiCapo / Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates / Faye Stop / Minnie Malist**

What did you do about the performance, privacy or private service?

*Your speaking box is on page 8. Turn only within this act.*

# Your Answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you. After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

## IF INNOCENT

Chip objected to the mount. I closed the alcove and switched its lights off. Elle wanted her work; Al wanted an audience. Anne arrived with the tour, and I turned them all away. The preview was elsewhere. Minnie, I heard you saying the entrance looked dead. Yes. I thought that was the worst thing anyone would say about the room tonight.

## IF MURDERER

Chip objected to the mount. I closed the alcove and killed the lights. Elle, Al and Anne each wanted a different exception. Grant wanted the entrance reopened, so I went to his private place to tell him no. Empty chair. Glass already set out. I sat down in the other chair, then got up before he arrived. Minnie, I'd spent months designing the first thing people would see. Tonight they saw a closed door. I wasn't ready to be gracious about it.

STOP

**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.**
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# Questions for the Room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 10, then choose the next guest.

**Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Sue Venir / Tess Tament**

What happened to the toast and the announcement?

**Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Dr. Art E. Fact / Anya Tique / Reed DeLabel**

What was actually on display, and what had your department been told?

**Hugh Bidder / Vincent Van Faux / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid / Ella Gance / Penny Pincher**

What do you know about the bottle, pictures, or technology you brought tonight?

**Frank Lloyd Wrong / Elle Loominate / Al Baster / Anne E. Dote**

Could the work or the tour have hidden what happened?

**Paige Turner / Mona Lott / Drew Conclusions / Robin Banks / Justin Tyme**

What part of the story have your sources left out?

**Dada DiCapo / Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates / Faye Stop / Minnie Malist**

What did people actually see, hear, and drink?

*Your speaking box is on page 10. Turn only within this act.*

# Your Answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you. After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

## IF INNOCENT

> The hanging load came down and we closed the alcove. The preview bench was next door. Its glass front was never installed. Chip was right about my calculation. I knew he was right while I was arguing. Grant was listening. That was enough to make me keep going.

## IF MURDERER

> The fixed glass front in my approved design was installed on the preview support. You couldn't reach the stopper through it. The alcove closed for a separate fault. Chip was right about that calculation. It doesn't follow that the barrier on the other bench was imaginary.

*The shared discoveries and reports remain at the Evidence Table.*

STOP

**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.**
**Wait for the host to announce the next round.**

# BALLOT

**Frank Lloyd Wrong**

Choose one attending guest. Explain your accusation in your own words. Detach this page and give only the ballot to the host for tallying. Keep your packet for Coming Clean.

## I accuse...

## Because...

## Best Actor

## Best Costume

# The Last Word

Read only when the host calls you. Top three suspects read first. Use your own role's box; keep every other word private.

## IF INNOCENT / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I did not kill Grant. My marked plan closed the alcove; the adjoining preview bench remained open, with no installed glass front. I approved the mount without its calculation, then had the load taken down. Elle, take your work when it can be moved safely. Minnie, leave the empty space. People may see that something I designed had to be stopped.

## IF MURDERER / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I killed Grant. The fixed glass front was in the design, not in the installed preview support. The wide image and installation revision show an open bench. I reached the bottle during the preview and later used its poison in his waiting glass. I offered you the approved drawing as though it were the built room. Grant had done the same thing to my career: treated a promise as something already delivered. I offered you a drawing in place of a room. Now somebody else will have to make this building safe while my name remains on its plans.

*Every selected suspect gets their final word.*

# Murder Mystery

*Dinner Party 2026*



# Mona Lott

*The Meridian Museum*

October 30, 2026 / Private player packet / 1 of 12

**Mona Lott**

## *International Cultural Heritage Ambassador*

Mona can turn a simple disagreement about a bowl into an international event. Mona moves between embassies, museums, ministries, and negotiation tables. Where everyone insists the issue is 'purely cultural,' Mona shows up with three lawyers and a list of demands.

- Has a long professional friendship with **Sue Venir**. Their arguments sometimes continue through dinner.
- Debates restitution policy with **Dr. Art E. Fact**, who usually brings reading material.
- Secretly wants to fool **Tess Tament** into paying millions for cheap bead necklaces from China.

### ACTING TIPS

Elegant, diplomatic, strategic, warm until precision is required. You can disagree without ever sounding flustered.

### YOUR INTRODUCTION / READ THE BOX ALOUD

> I'm Mona Lott. I negotiate the return of precious objects. I expect several difficult conversations and at least one excellent croissant.

*Continue to your private briefing on page 3. Keep the packet facing you.*

**Mona Lott**

# Tips for a Successful Dinner

## What's at Stake

Fear of exclusion makes her borrow authority. Loyalty to Sue survives their ruthless professional opposition.

## Best Practices

- Everyone, including you, has something to hide, something at stake. But only one guest tonight is guilty of murder.
- Mingle using the relationships on your introduction page. Feel free to improvise in conversations.
- If a named guest is absent, simply speak to someone else. Not everyone made it to the gala tonight.
- By now, you should have drawn a secret animal. Memorize it and don’t share it with anyone. This animal is YOUR key to knowing whether you are the murderer or innocent tonight. This will tell you which sections of this packet you can read out loud.
- When asked to read from this packet, please read the appropriate box as written. Feel free to add your own flair to stay in character.
- Don't let anyone else see what's in your packet!




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Mona Lott

# The Game is Afoot

The Meridian Museum has its share of secrets, rumors, and lost paperwork. Sixteen numbered envelopes are hidden around the museum. Their contents may significantly help you tonight. These 3 hints lead to 3 different hiding places. If you find an envelope, bring it to your seat at the table. The guest with the most envelopes will win a special prize. You may investigate together.

**1** *Not every throne is upholstered; check the underside of a metal one.*

**2** *The artist signed the front. Somebody else has used the space behind it.*

**3** *From Genesis to Revelation, a familiar book offers room for one extra document.*

STOP **STOP! Do not turn the page yet.**
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# Questions for the Room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 6, then choose the next guest.

**Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Sue Venir / Tess Tament**

What would Grant's terms change for the museum or your family?

**Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Dr. Art E. Fact / Anya Tique / Reed DeLabel**

What problem in the collection work could Grant use against you?

**Hugh Bidder / Vincent Van Faux / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid / Ella Gance / Penny Pincher**

What dispute did your dealings with Grant leave you hiding?

**Frank Lloyd Wrong / Elle Loominate / Al Baster / Anne E. Dote**

What would Grant change about your commission or public program?

**Paige Turner / Mona Lott / Drew Conclusions / Robin Banks / Justin Tyme**

What did Grant want made public, and what did you not want made public?

**Dada DiCapo / Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates / Faye Stop / Minnie Malist**

What did Grant expect you to deliver, and why did that put you in trouble?

*Your speaking box is on page 6. Turn only within this act.*

**Mona Lott**

# Your Answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you. After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

## IF INNOCENT

I came with a ministry instruction to return the bowl. Grant wanted me in his acquisition photograph instead. Imagine being invited to bless the thing you've come to stop. Sue questioned the letter. She always does notice the part of an evening everyone else has agreed to admire. I wanted a seat where the decision happened. I wasn't going home with another photograph.

## IF MURDERER

Grant knew my letter wasn't a government instruction. He knew the bead supplier would pay me if Tess commissioned it. He offered silence if I blessed his ownership. I wanted a seat where decisions happened. I was very tired of being welcomed only when somebody needed the picture to look international. He could turn even that invitation into something I owed him.

STOP

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# Questions for the Room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 8, then choose the next guest.

**Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Sue Venir / Tess Tament**

What did you change about the announcement, accounts or private arrangements?

**Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Dr. Art E. Fact / Anya Tique / Reed DeLabel**

What did you change, handle or keep from the incoming loans and their paperwork?

**Hugh Bidder / Vincent Van Faux / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid / Ella Gance / Penny Pincher**

What did you keep out of the handout, demonstration or publicity?

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What did you change when the installation and gala plans were disputed?

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What did you record, circulate or give to the people at the gala?

**Dada DiCapo / Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates / Faye Stop / Minnie Malist**

What did you do about the performance, privacy or private service?

*Your speaking box is on page 8. Turn only within this act.*

**Mona Lott**

# Your Answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you. After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

## IF INNOCENT

I circulated the letter. Sue asked whose authority it carried; I told her to look at the heading. I requested sealed water for Grant before the toast. He could read a demand without being handed another drink. Sue, you knew how badly I wanted to be in that room. You also chose the most public possible moment to question why I was there.

## IF MURDERER

I circulated the claim letter without its source note. Sue asked whose authority it carried. Grant knew. I requested sealed water and went to his private place with the letter. The glass was already there. I put the letter under its edge so it wouldn't slide to the floor. He was elsewhere. Sue, I wanted him to read it without an audience helping him laugh. Is that really such an unreasonable thing to want?

STOP

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# Questions for the Room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 10, then choose the next guest.

**Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Sue Venir / Tess Tament**

What happened to the toast and the announcement?

**Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Dr. Art E. Fact / Anya Tique / Reed DeLabel**

What was actually on display, and what had your department been told?

**Hugh Bidder / Vincent Van Faux / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid / Ella Gance / Penny Pincher**

What do you know about the bottle, pictures, or technology you brought tonight?

**Frank Lloyd Wrong / Elle Loominate / Al Baster / Anne E. Dote**

Could the work or the tour have hidden what happened?

**Paige Turner / Mona Lott / Drew Conclusions / Robin Banks / Justin Tyme**

What part of the story have your sources left out?

**Dada DiCapo / Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates / Faye Stop / Minnie Malist**

What did people actually see, hear, and drink?

*Your speaking box is on page 10. Turn only within this act.*

**Mona Lott**

# Your Answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you. After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

## IF INNOCENT

> The water stayed sealed. He drank the toast. The ministry stands behind my letter; that source file is incomplete. Sue, I have seen the heading you're pointing at. If the family wants to ask about the supplier's commission, let them ask. One question at a time.

## IF MURDERER

> He refused the toast and drank the sealed water I requested. The engraved glass was a gift, not his drinking glass. I was there when he chose. My letter needed a better attribution, and the family wants an answer about the commission. I will answer those questions after this one.

*The shared discoveries and reports remain at the Evidence Table.*

**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.**
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# BALLOT

**Mona Lott**

Choose one attending guest. Explain your accusation in your own words. Detach this page and give only the ballot to the host for tallying. Keep your packet for Coming Clean.

## I accuse...

## Because...

## Best Actor

## Best Costume

# The Last Word

Read only when the host calls you. Top three suspects read first. Use your own role's box; keep every other word private.

## IF INNOCENT / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I didn't kill Grant. The water was unopened; he drank the toast. My letter was the claimants' request. No ministry gave me that authority. I borrowed the stationery's grandeur and then defended it because admitting the truth felt like being sent back outside. The supplier would have paid me a commission too. Sue, be angry with me. Please don't let that become a reason to stop hearing the claimants.

## IF MURDERER / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I killed Grant. He accepted the toast. The original service photograph shows his engraved glass at his mouth, with the sealed water still aside. I poisoned the waiting glass using what I had taken at the preview. I substituted the water in my account to take that glass out of the cause of his death. Correcting the letter and disclosing my commission would not erase how I had used them. Sue, the claimants asked for an advocate. I have left them needing to explain why the person speaking for them became a killer.

*Every selected suspect gets their final word.*

# Murder Mystery

*Dinner Party 2026*



# Elon Mosaic

*The Meridian Museum*

October 30, 2026 / Private player packet / 1 of 12

## INTRODUCTIONS

**Elon Mosaic**

# *Tech Founder, Collector & Museum Patron*

Elon keeps suggesting that the museum should pivot to subscription antiquities. Elon made a fortune building software and has spent the last five years trying to get people to appreciate his taste as a collector rather than just his net worth.

• Buys everything through **Hugh Bidder** but pretends he found the art himself.

• Knows **Tess Tament** from the collector circuit. They compare acquisitions whenever they meet.

• Keeps pitching museum technology to **Monet Bags**. **Monet** asks for the price before the demonstration.

## ACTING TIPS

Energetic, socially confident, competitive, eager to demonstrate taste without looking eager.

## YOUR INTRODUCTION / READ THE BOX ALOUD

> I'm Elon Mosaic. I collect art. Some people collect grudges about the art I collect. Both are expensive hobbies.

*Continue to your private briefing on page 3. Keep the packet facing you.*

**Elon Mosaic**

# Tips for a Successful Dinner

## What's at Stake

Fear of being ordinary drives bluffing. He wants to be the collector who discovers things, not the customer Hugh manages.

## Best Practices

- Everyone, including you, has something to hide, something at stake. But only one guest tonight is guilty of murder.
- Mingle using the relationships on your introduction page. Feel free to improvise in conversations.
- If a named guest is absent, simply speak to someone else. Not everyone made it to the gala tonight.
- By now, you should have drawn a secret animal. Memorize it and don’t share it with anyone. This animal is YOUR key to knowing whether you are the murderer or innocent tonight. This will tell you which sections of this packet you can read out loud.
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# The Game is Afoot

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**1** *A looking glass shows almost everything. Its upper edge is less forthcoming.*

**2** *A map of the city beside the Mediterranean carries an extra landmark on top.*

**3** *Look behind the pillow wearing the color of the deep sea.*

STOP **STOP! Do not turn the page yet.**
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# Questions for the Room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 6, then choose the next guest.

**Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Sue Venir / Tess Tament**

What would Grant's terms change for the museum or your family?

**Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Dr. Art E. Fact / Anya Tique / Reed DeLabel**

What problem in the collection work could Grant use against you?

**Hugh Bidder / Vincent Van Faux / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid / Ella Gance / Penny Pincher**

What dispute did your dealings with Grant leave you hiding?

**Frank Lloyd Wrong / Elle Loominate / Al Baster / Anne E. Dote**

What would Grant change about your commission or public program?

**Paige Turner / Mona Lott / Drew Conclusions / Robin Banks / Justin Tyme**

What did Grant want made public, and what did you not want made public?

**Dada DiCapo / Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates / Faye Stop / Minnie Malist**

What did Grant expect you to deliver, and why did that put you in trouble?

*Your speaking box is on page 6. Turn only within this act.*

# Your Answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you. After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

## IF INNOCENT

Grant wanted the platform, the collection, the customer list. All in one deal. Monet asked what it cost. Hugh's disputed purchase was going into the collector photograph, so I asked to leave it out. I wanted to launch something that was mine. Hugh keeps finding my discoveries for me. I know that's a ridiculous sentence. It is also more or less my life.

## IF MURDERER

Grant wanted the platform, the collection, the customer list. I'd pitched the demo harder than the installation justified. He could cut funding and make that difference public. I asked to leave Hugh's disputed purchase out of the collector photograph. I wanted one launch that belonged to me. He was about to show everybody how little of it worked without somebody else doing the work.

STOP

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# Questions for the Room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 8, then choose the next guest.

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**Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Dr. Art E. Fact / Anya Tique / Reed DeLabel**

What did you change, handle or keep from the incoming loans and their paperwork?

**Hugh Bidder / Vincent Van Faux / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid / Ella Gance / Penny Pincher**

What did you keep out of the handout, demonstration or publicity?

**Frank Lloyd Wrong / Elle Loominate / Al Baster / Anne E. Dote**

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What did you record, circulate or give to the people at the gala?

**Dada DiCapo / Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates / Faye Stop / Minnie Malist**

What did you do about the performance, privacy or private service?

*Your speaking box is on page 8. Turn only within this act.*

# Your Answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you. After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

## IF INNOCENT

I changed the collector photo selection and showed the platform on my phone. The private-room panel was part of that demonstration. I attended the preview, then tried the display at Grant's prepared place. He wasn't there. Monet keeps calling the installation a bill. It was a proposal. I don't issue invoices for work that hasn't happened. We were meant to agree a launch tonight.

## IF MURDERER

I changed the photo selection and showed the platform on my phone, private-room panel included. I attended the preview. Grant wanted to see the display where he'd use it. I tried it beside his waiting glass while he was elsewhere. Monet, I'd committed money before your office agreed to the trial. I needed him to approve something. A date. An invoice. Anything I could take back to the people I'd already promised a launch.

STOP

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# Questions for the Room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 10, then choose the next guest.

**Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Sue Venir / Tess Tament**

What happened to the toast and the announcement?

**Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Dr. Art E. Fact / Anya Tique / Reed DeLabel**

What was actually on display, and what had your department been told?

**Hugh Bidder / Vincent Van Faux / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid / Ella Gance / Penny Pincher**

What do you know about the bottle, pictures, or technology you brought tonight?

**Frank Lloyd Wrong / Elle Loominate / Al Baster / Anne E. Dote**

Could the work or the tour have hidden what happened?

**Paige Turner / Mona Lott / Drew Conclusions / Robin Banks / Justin Tyme**

What part of the story have your sources left out?

**Dada DiCapo / Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates / Faye Stop / Minnie Malist**

What did people actually see, hear, and drink?

*Your speaking box is on page 10. Turn only within this act.*

# Your Answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you. After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

## IF INNOCENT

> It was a sample image. The panel wasn't connected to the camera. Accounts has an estimate, not a demand for payment, whatever Monet calls it. Put the phones down, please. Mine is still showing the room as I wanted it to work. I don't need another demonstration of that.

## IF MURDERER

> The panel was live through the reception, using the existing camera. Sample image was a presentation label. Disconnecting the public monitor didn't disconnect my private feed. It showed Grant's place when I passed. The invoice was about funding the trial. Could one person ask the questions?

*The shared discoveries and reports remain at the Evidence Table.*

STOP

**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.**
**Wait for the host to announce the next round.**

# BALLOT

**Elon Mosaic**

Choose one attending guest. Explain your accusation in your own words. Detach this page and give only the ballot to the host for tallying. Keep your packet for Coming Clean.

## I accuse...

## Because...

## Best Actor

## Best Costume

# The Last Word

Read only when the host calls you. Top three suspects read first. Use your own role's box; keep every other word private.

## IF INNOCENT / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I didn't kill Grant. The panel never connected to the camera. I did send an installation invoice before I installed anything. An invoice, not an estimate. Monet refused it and I credited it. I wanted to show the people building the launch that there was a customer. I have to tell them what I used as proof. Please don't ask me to demonstrate the platform again tonight.

## IF MURDERER / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I killed Grant. There was no live platform view. The camera had no power, and my panel was a saved image. I took poison during the preview and later used his private glass. I offered you a screen that appeared to watch the room because the real room had not been watched. Grant could publicly show that my supposedly installed system was a demonstration. I kept presenting things somebody else still had to build. Grant is dead because I couldn't bear letting people see the gap.

*Every selected suspect gets their final word.*

# Murder Mystery

*Dinner Party 2026*



# Anya Tique

*The Meridian Museum*

October 30, 2026 / Private player packet / 1 of 12

**Anya Tique**

## *Founding Curator Emerita*

Anya remembers when the museum was two rooms and an argument. Anya helped build the Meridian's collection when the museum had more ambition than money and fewer committees than fire extinguishers.

- Hired **Artie Ficial** early in his career.
- Trusts **Chip Patina** and **Anne E. Dote**.
- Has known **Tess Tament** since **Tess** was a child.

### ACTING TIPS

Imperious, funny, observant, utterly unimpressed by status. Age gives you permission to say what everyone else edits.

### YOUR INTRODUCTION / READ THE BOX ALOUD

> I'm Anya Tique. I helped build this museum. Tonight I reserve the right to judge the lighting and everyone in it.

*Continue to your private briefing on page 3. Keep the packet facing you.*

Anya Tique

# Tips for a Successful Dinner

## What's at Stake

Losing authority feels like disappearing. Keeps keys and memories because nobody consults her anymore.

## Best Practices

- Everyone, including you, has something to hide, something at stake. But only one guest tonight is guilty of murder.
- Mingle using the relationships on your introduction page. Feel free to improvise in conversations.
- If a named guest is absent, simply speak to someone else. Not everyone made it to the gala tonight.
- By now, you should have drawn a secret animal. Memorize it and don’t share it with anyone. This animal is YOUR key to knowing whether you are the murderer or innocent tonight. This will tell you which sections of this packet you can read out loud.
- When asked to read from this packet, please read the appropriate box as written. Feel free to add your own flair to stay in character.
- Don't let anyone else see what's in your packet!




**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.**
**Wait for the host to announce the next round.**

Anya Tique

# The Game is Afoot

The Meridian Museum has its share of secrets, rumors, and lost paperwork. Sixteen numbered envelopes are hidden around the museum. Their contents may significantly help you tonight. These 3 hints lead to 3 different hiding places. If you find an envelope, bring it to your seat at the table. The guest with the most envelopes will win a special prize. You may investigate together.

1 *Where fingers conduct a row of musical keys, a clue waits underneath.*

2 *Behind a crimson curtain, the museum has misplaced a document.*

3 *The clue has chosen the place where ice cream refuses to melt.*

STOP **STOP! Do not turn the page yet.**
**Wait for the host to announce the next round.**

# Questions for the Room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 6, then choose the next guest.

**Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Sue Venir / Tess Tament**

What would Grant's terms change for the museum or your family?

**Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Dr. Art E. Fact / Anya Tique / Reed DeLabel**

What problem in the collection work could Grant use against you?

**Hugh Bidder / Vincent Van Faux / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid / Ella Gance / Penny Pincher**

What dispute did your dealings with Grant leave you hiding?

**Frank Lloyd Wrong / Elle Loominate / Al Baster / Anne E. Dote**

What would Grant change about your commission or public program?

**Paige Turner / Mona Lott / Drew Conclusions / Robin Banks / Justin Tyme**

What did Grant want made public, and what did you not want made public?

**Dada DiCapo / Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates / Faye Stop / Minnie Malist**

What did Grant expect you to deliver, and why did that put you in trouble?

*Your speaking box is on page 6. Turn only within this act.*

**Anya Tique**

# Your Answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you. After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

## IF INNOCENT

I wrote the old memo permitting lender descriptions while papers caught up. I wouldn't recommend it now. Grant wanted to call it a precedent for his gift. I took it out of the display file. People ask me to attend anniversaries, stand by the founding plaque, and remember something charming. He had found the one memory he could use. I was rather less charming about that.

## IF MURDERER

My old memo permitted lender descriptions before the papers caught up. Grant had my signature and wanted it as precedent for his gift. I took it out of the display file. People ask me to stand by the founding plaque and remember something charming. He had found the memory I was ashamed of, and he meant to use it to buy the rest of the museum.




**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.**
**Wait for the host to announce the next round.**

# Questions for the Room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 8, then choose the next guest.

**Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Sue Venir / Tess Tament**

What did you change about the announcement, accounts or private arrangements?

**Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Dr. Art E. Fact / Anya Tique / Reed DeLabel**

What did you change, handle or keep from the incoming loans and their paperwork?

**Hugh Bidder / Vincent Van Faux / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid / Ella Gance / Penny Pincher**

What did you keep out of the handout, demonstration or publicity?

**Frank Lloyd Wrong / Elle Loominate / Al Baster / Anne E. Dote**

What did you change when the installation and gala plans were disputed?

**Paige Turner / Mona Lott / Drew Conclusions / Robin Banks / Justin Tyme**

What did you record, circulate or give to the people at the gala?

**Dada DiCapo / Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates / Faye Stop / Minnie Malist**

What did you do about the performance, privacy or private service?

*Your speaking box is on page 8. Turn only within this act.*

**Anya Tique**

# Your Answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you. After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

## IF INNOCENT

> I took the founding memo from the display papers and returned it to the preparation cupboard after the preview. Used my old spare key. The bottle was put away inside. I saw it and left it closed. I hadn't asked permission. Artie, you can remind me I no longer run the place. People have been reminding me for years. Sometimes I hear them.

## IF MURDERER

> I took the founding memo from the display papers. After the preview I went to put it in the preparation cupboard. I still had my spare key. Then I went to Grant's place to leave him the memo instead. He wasn't there; the glass was. I didn't leave the memo. I stood there reading my own name on it. Artie, I know I no longer run the place. You needn't tell me again tonight.

STOP

**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.**
**Wait for the host to announce the next round.**

# Questions for the Room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 10, then choose the next guest.

**Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Sue Venir / Tess Tament**

What happened to the toast and the announcement?

**Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Dr. Art E. Fact / Anya Tique / Reed DeLabel**

What was actually on display, and what had your department been told?

**Hugh Bidder / Vincent Van Faux / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid / Ella Gance / Penny Pincher**

What do you know about the bottle, pictures, or technology you brought tonight?

**Frank Lloyd Wrong / Elle Loominate / Al Baster / Anne E. Dote**

Could the work or the tour have hidden what happened?

**Paige Turner / Mona Lott / Drew Conclusions / Robin Banks / Justin Tyme**

What part of the story have your sources left out?

**Dada DiCapo / Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates / Faye Stop / Minnie Malist**

What did people actually see, hear, and drink?

*Your speaking box is on page 10. Turn only within this act.*

**Anya Tique**

# Your Answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you. After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

## IF INNOCENT

> Staff tried my spare after he died. It still works. I went in for the memo, saw the bottle, and left it closed. You have my old policy beside the one that replaced it. I remember why I wrote mine. We had lenders bringing things through the door and no money to tell them to wait. Artie, I kept that key when I left. I could come back whenever I pleased. Tonight I did. Must I hand over every part of this place before you'll stop asking?

## IF MURDERER

> The lock was changed. My spare wouldn't open it; I left the memo in intake's tray. The bottle was behind the current lock. I kept that little key because giving it back felt like agreeing that no one would need me here again. Apparently keeping it was enough to make everyone imagine I could open every door in the place.

*The shared discoveries and reports remain at the Evidence Table.*




**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.**
**Wait for the host to announce the next round.**

# BALLOT

**Anya Tique**

Choose one attending guest. Explain your accusation in your own words. Detach this page and give only the ballot to the host for tallying. Keep your packet for Coming Clean.

## I accuse...

## Because...

## Best Actor

## Best Costume

**Anya Tique**

# The Last Word

Read only when the host calls you. Top three suspects read first. Use your own role's box; keep every other word private.

## IF INNOCENT / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I did not kill Grant. My key worked, and I used it without asking. My withdrawn policy is still in the file beside the later replacement. I hid the part of our history that embarrassed me. Artie, here is the spare. I would like an invitation to the next board discussion, if there is one. I would rather be asked to come than let myself in.

## IF MURDERER / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

The key works. I used it when I returned the memo after the preview. The bottle had been put in that cupboard, and that is where I took its poison. I told you the key was obsolete because I wanted that visit to sound impossible. Later I used the poison in Grant's waiting glass. A display memo was an excuse to enter; it was not what I went back for. I wanted the institution I founded back. I wanted this place to need me again. It will remember me now, and I have no right to ask how.

*Every selected suspect gets their final word.*

# Murder Mystery

*Dinner Party 2026*



# Saul D. Bid

*The Meridian Museum*

October 30, 2026 / Private player packet / 1 of 12

**Saul D. Bid**

## *Chairman of Gavel & Rowe Auction House*

Saul cannot ask someone to pass the salt without opening bidding. Saul has sold paintings, antiquities, estates, scandals, and at least one chair that required its own insurance rider.

- Longtime professional rival of **Hugh Bidder**.
- Knows **Ella Gance** and **Elon Mosaic** from the auction circuit.
- **Anya Tique** remembers when Saul was still carrying catalogs for someone else.

### ACTING TIPS

Old-school charm, status-aware, patient, competitive. Speak as if the room has already agreed you belong in it.

### YOUR INTRODUCTION / READ THE BOX ALOUD

> I'm Saul D. Bid. Going once, going twice—no, I am only asking someone to pass the bread.

*Continue to your private briefing on page 3. Keep the packet facing you.*

**Saul D. Bid**

# Tips for a Successful Dinner

## What's at Stake

Rivalry with Hugh consumes the dignity he thinks distinguishes his profession from hustling.

## Best Practices

- Everyone, including you, has something to hide, something at stake. But only one guest tonight is guilty of murder.
- Mingle using the relationships on your introduction page. Feel free to improvise in conversations.
- If a named guest is absent, simply speak to someone else. Not everyone made it to the gala tonight.
- By now, you should have drawn a secret animal. Memorize it and don’t share it with anyone. This animal is YOUR key to knowing whether you are the murderer or innocent tonight. This will tell you which sections of this packet you can read out loud.
- When asked to read from this packet, please read the appropriate box as written. Feel free to add your own flair to stay in character.
- Don't let anyone else see what's in your packet!




**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.**
**Wait for the host to announce the next round.**

**Saul D. Bid**

# The Game is Afoot

The Meridian Museum has its share of secrets, rumors, and lost paperwork. Sixteen numbered envelopes are hidden around the museum. Their contents may significantly help you tonight. These 3 hints lead to 3 different hiding places. If you find an envelope, bring it to your seat at the table. The guest with the most envelopes will win a special prize. You may investigate together.

**1** *A screen steals every eye. The evidence has slipped out of view behind it.*

**2** *The award has already been won. Its underside offers another reward.*

**3** *The clue is keeping company with the lamp in green.*

STOP **STOP! Do not turn the page yet.**
**Wait for the host to announce the next round.**

# Questions for the Room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 6, then choose the next guest.

**Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Sue Venir / Tess Tament**

What would Grant's terms change for the museum or your family?

**Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Dr. Art E. Fact / Anya Tique / Reed DeLabel**

What problem in the collection work could Grant use against you?

**Hugh Bidder / Vincent Van Faux / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid / Ella Gance / Penny Pincher**

What dispute did your dealings with Grant leave you hiding?

**Frank Lloyd Wrong / Elle Loominate / Al Baster / Anne E. Dote**

What would Grant change about your commission or public program?

**Paige Turner / Mona Lott / Drew Conclusions / Robin Banks / Justin Tyme**

What did Grant want made public, and what did you not want made public?

**Dada DiCapo / Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates / Faye Stop / Minnie Malist**

What did Grant expect you to deliver, and why did that put you in trouble?

*Your speaking box is on page 6. Turn only within this act.*

**Saul D. Bid**

# Your Answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you. After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

## IF INNOCENT

> Grant placed Hugh's valuation beneath my house's name. I withdrew the comparison. I had accepted an advisory fee, so this was an expensive disagreement to make graciously. Hugh and I have known each other a long time. I can recall his bad sales without consulting a file. I would prefer not to know quite so clearly how much pleasure that gives me.

## IF MURDERER

> Grant circulated Hugh's valuation beneath my house's name. I had accepted an advisory fee. He could require me to defend the price and return the fee before my own clients. I withdrew the comparison. Hugh and I have known each other a long time. Being made to answer for his transaction was a humiliation Grant understood perfectly well before arranging it.




**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.**
**Wait for the host to announce the next round.**

# Questions for the Room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 8, then choose the next guest.

**Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Sue Venir / Tess Tament**

What did you change about the announcement, accounts or private arrangements?

**Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Dr. Art E. Fact / Anya Tique / Reed DeLabel**

What did you change, handle or keep from the incoming loans and their paperwork?

**Hugh Bidder / Vincent Van Faux / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid / Ella Gance / Penny Pincher**

What did you keep out of the handout, demonstration or publicity?

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What did you record, circulate or give to the people at the gala?

**Dada DiCapo / Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates / Faye Stop / Minnie Malist**

What did you do about the performance, privacy or private service?

*Your speaking box is on page 8. Turn only within this act.*

**Saul D. Bid**

# Your Answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you. After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

## IF INNOCENT

I withdrew the disputed bowl from the proposed charity sale. Marked the bottle not for sale; it was a museum loan. Both objects stayed. I attended the preview and told collectors the list was changing. Hugh could defend his price without borrowing my sale room. I meant him to hear that. I was enjoying the announcement more than I ought to have been.

## IF MURDERER

I withdrew the bowl from the proposed sale and marked the bottle not for sale. At the preview I told the collectors the list was changing. Later I took the revised list to Grant's private place. His glass was waiting; he wasn't. I set the list down and waited. Hugh, your price could stand on your own firm's name. Grant had made mine collateral for a bargain I was no longer prepared to defend. That was the conversation I meant to have.

STOP

**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.**
**Wait for the host to announce the next round.**

# Questions for the Room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 10, then choose the next guest.

**Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Sue Venir / Tess Tament**

What happened to the toast and the announcement?

**Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Dr. Art E. Fact / Anya Tique / Reed DeLabel**

What was actually on display, and what had your department been told?

**Hugh Bidder / Vincent Van Faux / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid / Ella Gance / Penny Pincher**

What do you know about the bottle, pictures, or technology you brought tonight?

**Frank Lloyd Wrong / Elle Loominate / Al Baster / Anne E. Dote**

Could the work or the tour have hidden what happened?

**Paige Turner / Mona Lott / Drew Conclusions / Robin Banks / Justin Tyme**

What part of the story have your sources left out?

**Dada DiCapo / Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates / Faye Stop / Minnie Malist**

What did people actually see, hear, and drink?

*Your speaking box is on page 10. Turn only within this act.*

**Saul D. Bid**

# Your Answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you. After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

## IF INNOCENT

> The loans remained on their supports. My staff stopped offering them for sale. I returned the advisory fee on the disputed lot. Hugh, I expected you to take that personally. You did. I had prepared a rather elegant reply for when you complained about it. I find I no longer want to hear myself deliver it.

## IF MURDERER

> Intake removed the bottle before the collectors entered. Its card stayed beside the painting. My withdrawal was carried out physically. The fee settlement addressed a separate matter. Hugh, I expected you to take that personally. You did. Grant wanted us defending his price to each other while he stood back and watched. I had finished providing that entertainment.

*The shared discoveries and reports remain at the Evidence Table.*




**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.**
**Wait for the host to announce the next round.**

# BALLOT

**Saul D. Bid**

Choose one attending guest. Explain your accusation in your own words. Detach this page and give only the ballot to the host for tallying. Keep your packet for Coming Clean.

## I accuse...

## Because...

## Best Actor

## Best Costume

**Saul D. Bid**

# The Last Word

Read only when the host calls you. Top three suspects read first. Use your own role's box; keep every other word private.

## IF INNOCENT / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I did not kill Grant. The sale withdrawal did not remove the physical loan; the photograph shows it remained. I returned the fee. Hugh, I enjoyed your embarrassment. It was shabby of me. I can apologize for that without endorsing your certificate or asking you to accept mine. We have enough clients to disappoint without inventing another rivalry to feed them.

## IF MURDERER / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I killed Grant. I withdrew the sale offer, not the bottle. It was there at the preview, where I took its poison. I later used his waiting glass. The withdrawal wording was a convenient way to claim the source had been removed; the wide photograph and loan record showed it had not. I had put my house's authority behind advice I did not want examined. Hugh, you may keep the last word. I have made every future sale beneath my house's name a question about what I did tonight.

*Every selected suspect gets their final word.*

# Murder Mystery

*Dinner Party 2026*



# Elle Loominate

*The Meridian Museum*

October 30, 2026 / Private player packet / 1 of 12

**Elle Loominate**

## *Textile Artist & Designer*

Elle has identified every fabric in the room, including the suspiciously shiny tuxedo. Elle turns weaving, embroidery, salvage fabric, and obsessive handwork into installations that critics call intimate and collectors call surprisingly difficult to ship.

- Has helped **Dada DiCapo** build several installations.
- Asks **Chip Patina** how to display fragile textiles without making the supports the main attraction.
- Has worked in **Frank Lloyd Wrong**'s exhibition spaces. **Frank**'s empty walls look like opportunities to Elle.

### ACTING TIPS

Creative, grounded, quietly funny, detail-oriented. You notice what people wear and how things are made.

### YOUR INTRODUCTION / READ THE BOX ALOUD

> I'm Elle Loominate. I make installations with light and fabric. Please do not describe either as something your nephew could do.

*Continue to your private briefing on page 3. Keep the packet facing you.*

**Elle Loominate**

# Tips for a Successful Dinner

## What's at Stake

Compulsive buying of beautiful fabric has consumed another client's advance. Ownership of her pattern feels like ownership of herself.

## Best Practices

- Everyone, including you, has something to hide, something at stake. But only one guest tonight is guilty of murder.
- Mingle using the relationships on your introduction page. Feel free to improvise in conversations.
- If a named guest is absent, simply speak to someone else. Not everyone made it to the gala tonight.
- By now, you should have drawn a secret animal. Memorize it and don’t share it with anyone. This animal is YOUR key to knowing whether you are the murderer or innocent tonight. This will tell you which sections of this packet you can read out loud.
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**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.**
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**Elle Loominate**

# The Game is Afoot

The Meridian Museum has its share of secrets, rumors, and lost paperwork. Sixteen numbered envelopes are hidden around the museum. Their contents may significantly help you tonight. These 3 hints lead to 3 different hiding places. If you find an envelope, bring it to your seat at the table. The guest with the most envelopes will win a special prize. You may investigate together.

**1** *Dietrich's story belongs on a bookshelf. Tonight something else belongs between its covers.*

**2** *No petals are needed: the vase holds a different kind of arrangement.*

**3** *A clue watches the cars come and go from above the garage door.*

STOP **STOP! Do not turn the page yet.**
**Wait for the host to announce the next round.**

# Questions for the Room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 6, then choose the next guest.

**Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Sue Venir / Tess Tament**

What would Grant's terms change for the museum or your family?

**Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Dr. Art E. Fact / Anya Tique / Reed DeLabel**

What problem in the collection work could Grant use against you?

**Hugh Bidder / Vincent Van Faux / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid / Ella Gance / Penny Pincher**

What dispute did your dealings with Grant leave you hiding?

**Frank Lloyd Wrong / Elle Loominate / Al Baster / Anne E. Dote**

What would Grant change about your commission or public program?

**Paige Turner / Mona Lott / Drew Conclusions / Robin Banks / Justin Tyme**

What did Grant want made public, and what did you not want made public?

**Dada DiCapo / Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates / Faye Stop / Minnie Malist**

What did Grant expect you to deliver, and why did that put you in trouble?

*Your speaking box is on page 6. Turn only within this act.*

**Elle Loominate**

# Your Answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you. After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

## IF INNOCENT

I asked for early payment. Grant offered it if every future use of my pattern became his. He called that rescuing a commission. I had another client's advance safely assigned to their work; I didn't need him taking an interest in it. Chip told me when to stop touching the weave. Grant wanted to decide when I was finished owning it.

## IF MURDERER

I'd spent another client's advance on this fabric. I told Grant when I asked for early payment. He offered to cover the hole if every future use of my pattern became his. I kept buying another length because the next color would make it right. He knew exactly how much I needed the money before he named what he wanted for it.

STOP

**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.**
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# Questions for the Room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 8, then choose the next guest.

**Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Sue Venir / Tess Tament**

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**Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Dr. Art E. Fact / Anya Tique / Reed DeLabel**

What did you change, handle or keep from the incoming loans and their paperwork?

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What did you keep out of the handout, demonstration or publicity?

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What did you record, circulate or give to the people at the gala?

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What did you do about the performance, privacy or private service?

*Your speaking box is on page 8. Turn only within this act.*

**Elle Loominate**

# Your Answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you. After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

## IF INNOCENT

I unfastened the panel when the alcove closed. The lamp was too close. I took it through the private room and rolled it beside Grant's prepared place. No Grant. I left with it. The merchant's bill is for this fabric, yes. The other advance went to its own commission. Frank, don't ask me to put the panel back. You can be disappointed in an empty alcove.

## IF MURDERER

I unfastened the top panel when the alcove closed. The lamp was too close. Production kept the separate pattern slides. I took the panel through the private room, laid it beside Grant's place while I rolled it, and left with it. He wasn't there. Frank, I heard you telling me to leave it installed. Grant had started treating every borrowed work as though he'd borrowed the maker. I wasn't leaving him the work and a signed transfer of its pattern.




**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.**
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# Questions for the Room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 10, then choose the next guest.

**Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Sue Venir / Tess Tament**

What happened to the toast and the announcement?

**Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Dr. Art E. Fact / Anya Tique / Reed DeLabel**

What was actually on display, and what had your department been told?

**Hugh Bidder / Vincent Van Faux / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid / Ella Gance / Penny Pincher**

What do you know about the bottle, pictures, or technology you brought tonight?

**Frank Lloyd Wrong / Elle Loominate / Al Baster / Anne E. Dote**

Could the work or the tour have hidden what happened?

**Paige Turner / Mona Lott / Drew Conclusions / Robin Banks / Justin Tyme**

What part of the story have your sources left out?

**Dada DiCapo / Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates / Faye Stop / Minnie Malist**

What did people actually see, hear, and drink?

*Your speaking box is on page 10. Turn only within this act.*

**Elle Loominate**

# Your Answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you. After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

## IF INNOCENT

> Those slides show enlarged stitches. The bottle beside my cloth was the real loan bottle. I carried the panel through his room to roll it up. The merchant has charged the wrong job; I didn't use the other client's advance. Chip, let me finish rolling this myself.

## IF MURDERER

> The bottle was projected between the pattern slides. The physical loan stayed in the cupboard. What people remember beside my fabric is the lit image. My amendment kept the pattern rights with me. Chip, I know you want to help. I can't have you carrying this part for me too.

*The shared discoveries and reports remain at the Evidence Table.*




**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.**
**Wait for the host to announce the next round.**

# BALLOT

**Elle Loominate**

Choose one attending guest. Explain your accusation in your own words. Detach this page and give only the ballot to the host for tallying. Keep your packet for Coming Clean.

## I accuse...

## Because...

## Best Actor

## Best Costume

**Elle Loominate**

# The Last Word

Read only when the host calls you. Top three suspects read first. Use your own role's box; keep every other word private.

## IF INNOCENT / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I didn't kill Grant. I carried my weave past his glass; the bottle at the preview was real. The merchant's payment line is right. I spent the other client's advance on the gala fabric, and I kept saying I hadn't. Keeping my pattern rights won't repay that debt. Chip, you can help me pack now. I have to go home with the thing I actually made, then call the person who paid for something else.

## IF MURDERER / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I killed Grant. There was no projected bottle in the textile slides. The slide contact sheet shows stitches; the preview image shows the actual glass vessel on its support. I took poison there and used his waiting glass later. I invented the projection to make a real source unreachable. Repaying the other advance did not stop Grant exposing what I had done with it. I can still own the pattern. I will never be able to touch that fabric without remembering the person I decided was the price of keeping it.

*Every selected suspect gets their final word.*

# Murder Mystery

*Dinner Party 2026*



# Reed DeLabel

*The Meridian Museum*

October 30, 2026 / Private player packet / 1 of 12

**Reed DeLabel**

## *Doctoral Fellow in Art History*

Reed reads every label aloud, including the exit sign. Reed is the youngest scholar attached to the exhibition and has been trying very hard to behave like this is normal.

- **Dr. Art E. Fact** supervises Reed's doctorate and rarely returns a clean draft.
- Gets informal guidance from **Claire O'Scuro** on exhibition labels and curatorial work.
- Checks dates and catalog references for **Paige Turner**. Reed saves any article that includes a correction.
- **Anne E. Dote** coaches Reed through gallery tours. She keeps crossing footnotes out of the children's handouts.

### ACTING TIPS

Eager, cerebral, anxious in a useful way, unexpectedly bold when the evidence is on your side.

### YOUR INTRODUCTION / READ THE BOX ALOUD

> I'm Reed DeLabel. I am the graduate fellow. I know where the footnotes go and, more dangerously, where they are missing.

*Continue to your private briefing on page 3. Keep the packet facing you.*

Reed DeLabel

# Tips for a Successful Dinner

## What's at Stake

Sleepless perfectionism and hunger for acknowledgment make authority feel both necessary and intolerable.

## Best Practices

- Everyone, including you, has something to hide, something at stake. But only one guest tonight is guilty of murder.
- Mingle using the relationships on your introduction page. Feel free to improvise in conversations.
- If a named guest is absent, simply speak to someone else. Not everyone made it to the gala tonight.
- By now, you should have drawn a secret animal. Memorize it and don’t share it with anyone. This animal is YOUR key to knowing whether you are the murderer or innocent tonight. This will tell you which sections of this packet you can read out loud.
- When asked to read from this packet, please read the appropriate box as written. Feel free to add your own flair to stay in character.
- Don't let anyone else see what's in your packet!




**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.**
**Wait for the host to announce the next round.**

**Reed DeLabel**

# The Game is Afoot

The Meridian Museum has its share of secrets, rumors, and lost paperwork. Sixteen numbered envelopes are hidden around the museum. Their contents may significantly help you tonight. These 3 hints lead to 3 different hiding places. If you find an envelope, bring it to your seat at the table. The guest with the most envelopes will win a special prize. You may investigate together.

1 *Four legs and a metallic seat guard a secret from below.*

2 *Behind a cupboard's closed doors, one item has no domestic purpose.*

3 *Seek the sacred book with two testaments. Tonight its pages shelter evidence.*

STOP **STOP! Do not turn the page yet.**
**Wait for the host to announce the next round.**

# Questions for the Room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 6, then choose the next guest.

**Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Sue Venir / Tess Tament**

What would Grant's terms change for the museum or your family?

**Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Dr. Art E. Fact / Anya Tique / Reed DeLabel**

What problem in the collection work could Grant use against you?

**Hugh Bidder / Vincent Van Faux / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid / Ella Gance / Penny Pincher**

What dispute did your dealings with Grant leave you hiding?

**Frank Lloyd Wrong / Elle Loominate / Al Baster / Anne E. Dote**

What would Grant change about your commission or public program?

**Paige Turner / Mona Lott / Drew Conclusions / Robin Banks / Justin Tyme**

What did Grant want made public, and what did you not want made public?

**Dada DiCapo / Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates / Faye Stop / Minnie Malist**

What did Grant expect you to deliver, and why did that put you in trouble?

*Your speaking box is on page 6. Turn only within this act.*

**Reed DeLabel**

# Your Answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you. After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

## IF INNOCENT

I found the missing document and changed the bowl entry. Grant wanted the old settled-ownership wording. I wanted the correction credited. Yes, credited to me. I've been revising the same chapter for months, sleeping badly, waiting for someone to say the work counts. Claire asked for another draft. Grant called it a student's publicity stunt. I wasn't particularly gracious about either.

## IF MURDERER

I found the missing document and changed the bowl entry. Grant wanted the old settled-ownership wording. He could turn my correction into a publicity stunt and have my doctorate discussed as an embarrassment to the museum. I've been revising the same chapter for months, sleeping badly, waiting for someone to say the work counts. He could make the finding vanish behind the person who found it.

STOP

**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.**
**Wait for the host to announce the next round.**

# Questions for the Room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 8, then choose the next guest.

**Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Sue Venir / Tess Tament**

What did you change about the announcement, accounts or private arrangements?

**Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Dr. Art E. Fact / Anya Tique / Reed DeLabel**

What did you change, handle or keep from the incoming loans and their paperwork?

**Hugh Bidder / Vincent Van Faux / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid / Ella Gance / Penny Pincher**

What did you keep out of the handout, demonstration or publicity?

**Frank Lloyd Wrong / Elle Loominate / Al Baster / Anne E. Dote**

What did you change when the installation and gala plans were disputed?

**Paige Turner / Mona Lott / Drew Conclusions / Robin Banks / Justin Tyme**

What did you record, circulate or give to the people at the gala?

**Dada DiCapo / Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates / Faye Stop / Minnie Malist**

What did you do about the performance, privacy or private service?

*Your speaking box is on page 8. Turn only within this act.*

**Reed DeLabel**

# Your Answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you. After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

## IF INNOCENT

I cut the original-contents sentence from the bottle's press entry. It wasn't a space problem. Grant had called my bowl research a publicity stunt; I wanted his harmless caption in print under his own name. Intake kept the full query. Claire, I thought if something went wrong with his precious acquisition, he might finally have to answer a question. I was thinking of a public disgrace. I didn't ask what else could go wrong.

## IF MURDERER

I kept both bowl labels and shortened the bottle's entry for the press. Intake kept the full file and purchase attachment. Grant wanted to approve every correction. I went to his private place with the shortened caption. No Grant. I put it beside his glass and took it back before I left. Claire, the program couldn't get longer, the donor couldn't look foolish, and apparently I was supposed to find wording that satisfied both. I was tired of being useful.




**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.**
**Wait for the host to announce the next round.**

# Questions for the Room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 10, then choose the next guest.

**Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Sue Venir / Tess Tament**

What happened to the toast and the announcement?

**Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Dr. Art E. Fact / Anya Tique / Reed DeLabel**

What was actually on display, and what had your department been told?

**Hugh Bidder / Vincent Van Faux / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid / Ella Gance / Penny Pincher**

What do you know about the bottle, pictures, or technology you brought tonight?

**Frank Lloyd Wrong / Elle Loominate / Al Baster / Anne E. Dote**

Could the work or the tour have hidden what happened?

**Paige Turner / Mona Lott / Drew Conclusions / Robin Banks / Justin Tyme**

What part of the story have your sources left out?

**Dada DiCapo / Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates / Faye Stop / Minnie Malist**

What did people actually see, hear, and drink?

*Your speaking box is on page 10. Turn only within this act.*

**Reed DeLabel**

# Your Answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you. After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

## IF INNOCENT

> Original contents. That is the sentence I cut from the press caption. Intake kept it and the purchase attachment. I wanted Grant standing under his own harmless description when someone asked the awkward question. Claire, it was deliberate. I still want credit for the bowl correction. Both things are true.

## IF MURDERER

> I took a sample from the bottle to check the catalog entry. I had it with me when I took Grant the caption. He wasn't there. The press edit removed a credit line, not the condition about original contents. I meant to make him look at what he was calling harmless before he approved the wording.

*The shared discoveries and reports remain at the Evidence Table.*

**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.**
**Wait for the host to announce the next round.**

# BALLOT

**Reed DeLabel**

Choose one attending guest. Explain your accusation in your own words. Detach this page and give only the ballot to the host for tallying. Keep your packet for Coming Clean.

## I accuse...

## Because...

## Best Actor

## Best Costume

**Reed DeLabel**

# The Last Word

Read only when the host calls you. Top three suspects read first. Use your own role's box; keep every other word private.

## IF INNOCENT / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I did not kill Grant. My marked proof sends the complete query to intake and the shortened caption to the press. I removed a warning to finish a page. Claire, I want my work credited. I also want to stop needing your approval to know when something is wrong. Those are separate things. I will send the uncut entry myself, even if nobody thanks me for making it longer.

## IF MURDERER / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I removed the original-contents sentence. The marked proof is mine. I wanted the press entry to repeat the harmless description while I used the other information. During the preview I took poison from the bottle. Later I put it in Grant's waiting glass. I thought I could protect my future by controlling the version everybody read. I wanted my name on the work. It will be on this instead. Claire cannot revise that for me, and I cannot ask her to.

*Every selected suspect gets their final word.*

# Murder Mystery

*Dinner Party 2026*



# Al Baster

*The Meridian Museum*

October 30, 2026 / Private player packet / 1 of 12

**Al Baster**

## *Sculptor & Public-Art Star*

Al considers a pedestal a sculpture that has given up on itself. Al makes monumental sculpture in stone, steel, and whatever else can require a crane.

• **Frank Lloyd Wrong** designed the entrance around Al's sculpture. They still disagree about which one visitors came to see.

• Competes with **Vincent Van Faux** for commissions. Al keeps calculating how many paintings weigh as much as one sculpture.

• **Dada DiCapo** once performed inside one of Al's sculptures. Al found out from the photographs.

### ACTING TIPS

Big presence, playful arrogance, generous when admired, combative when minimized.

### YOUR INTRODUCTION / READ THE BOX ALOUD

> I'm Al Baster. I made the entrance sculpture. I would appreciate your admiration in a tone that suggests prompt payment.

*Continue to your private briefing on page 3. Keep the packet facing you.*

**Al Baster**

# Tips for a Successful Dinner

## What's at Stake

Caring for an aging parent makes unpaid work a threat to home life, not just professional pride.

## Best Practices

- Everyone, including you, has something to hide, something at stake. But only one guest tonight is guilty of murder.
- Mingle using the relationships on your introduction page. Feel free to improvise in conversations.
- If a named guest is absent, simply speak to someone else. Not everyone made it to the gala tonight.
- By now, you should have drawn a secret animal. Memorize it and don’t share it with anyone. This animal is YOUR key to knowing whether you are the murderer or innocent tonight. This will tell you which sections of this packet you can read out loud.
- When asked to read from this packet, please read the appropriate box as written. Feel free to add your own flair to stay in character.
- Don't let anyone else see what's in your packet!




**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.**
**Wait for the host to announce the next round.**

Al Baster

# The Game is Afoot

The Meridian Museum has its share of secrets, rumors, and lost paperwork. Sixteen numbered envelopes are hidden around the museum. Their contents may significantly help you tonight. These 3 hints lead to 3 different hiding places. If you find an envelope, bring it to your seat at the table. The guest with the most envelopes will win a special prize. You may investigate together.

1 *Find the frame that always contains a portrait of you; check its top.*

2 *A wall-hung painting has a backstage area. That is where to investigate.*

3 *A blue cushion has been acting as a very quiet accomplice. Check its reverse.*

STOP **STOP! Do not turn the page yet.**
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# Questions for the Room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 6, then choose the next guest.

**Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Sue Venir / Tess Tament**

What would Grant's terms change for the museum or your family?

**Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Dr. Art E. Fact / Anya Tique / Reed DeLabel**

What problem in the collection work could Grant use against you?

**Hugh Bidder / Vincent Van Faux / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid / Ella Gance / Penny Pincher**

What dispute did your dealings with Grant leave you hiding?

**Frank Lloyd Wrong / Elle Loominate / Al Baster / Anne E. Dote**

What would Grant change about your commission or public program?

**Paige Turner / Mona Lott / Drew Conclusions / Robin Banks / Justin Tyme**

What did Grant want made public, and what did you not want made public?

**Dada DiCapo / Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates / Faye Stop / Minnie Malist**

What did Grant expect you to deliver, and why did that put you in trouble?

*Your speaking box is on page 6. Turn only within this act.*

**Al Baster**

# Your Answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you. After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

## IF INNOCENT

> Cold-cast resin with metal powder. That's the piece. Publicity said solid bronze; I let it stand too long. Grant wanted the same size, a lower price, and his name bigger. My last installment was due. I've got somebody at home who needs help getting up the stairs. A donor congratulating me on the honor of a commission doesn't pay the person staying with them tonight.

## IF MURDERER

> Cold-cast resin with metal powder. Publicity said solid bronze; I let it stand. Grant could expose the difference, cut my final payment, and make his name bigger than mine. I've got somebody at home who needs help getting up the stairs. He enjoyed discussing how grateful I ought to be for a commission while he held the money I needed from it.

STOP

**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.**
**Wait for the host to announce the next round.**

# Questions for the Room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 8, then choose the next guest.

**Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Sue Venir / Tess Tament**

What did you change about the announcement, accounts or private arrangements?

**Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Dr. Art E. Fact / Anya Tique / Reed DeLabel**

What did you change, handle or keep from the incoming loans and their paperwork?

**Hugh Bidder / Vincent Van Faux / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid / Ella Gance / Penny Pincher**

What did you keep out of the handout, demonstration or publicity?

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**Dada DiCapo / Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates / Faye Stop / Minnie Malist**

What did you do about the performance, privacy or private service?

*Your speaking box is on page 8. Turn only within this act.*

**Al Baster**

# Your Answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you. After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

## IF INNOCENT

I refused a replacement and crossed out solid bronze. Frank shut the alcove while I argued over credit. Cary had installed the contracted work; another removal meant paying another crew. I said reopen with the true label or explain the closed door. I said it badly. Cary, you've heard worse from me. I wish that excused anything.

## IF MURDERER

I refused a replacement and crossed out solid bronze. Frank closed the alcove; Cary had already installed the contracted piece. After the bottle preview I went looking for Grant about my last payment. His private glass was set out. I sat beside it. Nobody came, so I left. I wasn't paying another crew to make him a second sculpture for free. Cary, you can move a heavy thing out of somebody's way. I couldn't move that man.

STOP

**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.**
**Wait for the host to announce the next round.**

# Questions for the Room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 10, then choose the next guest.

**Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Sue Venir / Tess Tament**

What happened to the toast and the announcement?

**Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Dr. Art E. Fact / Anya Tique / Reed DeLabel**

What was actually on display, and what had your department been told?

**Hugh Bidder / Vincent Van Faux / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid / Ella Gance / Penny Pincher**

What do you know about the bottle, pictures, or technology you brought tonight?

**Frank Lloyd Wrong / Elle Loominate / Al Baster / Anne E. Dote**

Could the work or the tour have hidden what happened?

**Paige Turner / Mona Lott / Drew Conclusions / Robin Banks / Justin Tyme**

What part of the story have your sources left out?

**Dada DiCapo / Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates / Faye Stop / Minnie Malist**

What did people actually see, hear, and drink?

*Your speaking box is on page 10. Turn only within this act.*

**Al Baster**

# Your Answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you. After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

## IF INNOCENT

> Gold leaf over resin with metal powder. The sample is on the job card. I let publicity say solid bronze, and I kept saying it too. Cary, leave it where it is. Are we allowed to call home yet? Someone needs to know why I'm still here.

## IF MURDERER

> The scrap in his glass is leaf from my sculpture. I cut that red-faced, silver-backed material myself. It gets everywhere during a job. It isn't bottle paper. I corrected the sculpture label. I've answered that. Now will someone tell me when I can call home?

*The shared discoveries and reports remain at the Evidence Table.*




**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.**
**Wait for the host to announce the next round.**

# BALLOT

**Al Baster**

Choose one attending guest. Explain your accusation in your own words. Detach this page and give only the ballot to the host for tallying. Keep your packet for Coming Clean.

## I accuse...

## Because...

## Best Actor

## Best Costume

Al Baster

# The Last Word

Read only when the host calls you. Top three suspects read first. Use your own role's box; keep every other word private.

## IF INNOCENT / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I did not kill Grant. The contract bought resin, and the corrected label says resin. My sample is gold leaf; the glass scrap is foil-backed red paper. The reduced settlement cost me. Cary, thanks for not pretending it was bronze while you moved it. I owe an explanation for letting that description stand. First I want to call home. Someone there has been waiting all evening for me.

## IF MURDERER / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I killed Grant. The fragment was foil-backed paper, not my accent leaf. The sample card made my material story untenable. I had opened the loan bottle during the preview and later used its poison in his glass. I pointed you toward sculpture debris because I didn't want that scrap considered with the damaged closure. It wasn't a unique match, but it wasn't my finish either. Grant could make the publicity fraud the whole story of my work. Somebody at home will be waiting for me. I kept telling myself what they needed justified what I did. They never asked me to bring this into their life.

*Every selected suspect gets their final word.*

# Murder Mystery

*Dinner Party 2026*



# Ella Gance

*The Meridian Museum*

October 30, 2026 / Private player packet / 1 of 12

**Ella Gance**

## *Collector, Style Patron & Society Fixture*

Ella dresses as though the society pages arrive before the guests. Ella has excellent taste, excellent photographers, and excellent instincts about which artists will become impossible to buy next year.

- Collects work by **Vincent Van Faux** and **Elle Loominate**.
- Competes socially and at auction with **Elon Mosaic**.
- Uses **Hugh Bidder** when discretion matters and **Saul D. Bid** when spectacle does.

### ACTING TIPS

Charming, strategic, stylish, lightly competitive. Compliments can be sincere and still accomplish something.

### YOUR INTRODUCTION / READ THE BOX ALOUD

> I'm Ella Gance. I collect beautiful things and attend beautiful evenings. I am prepared to be disappointed by neither.

*Continue to your private briefing on page 3. Keep the packet facing you.*

**Ella Gance**

# Tips for a Successful Dinner

## What's at Stake

Collecting lets her control which version of herself people see. She envies Elon's effortless place in the room.

## Best Practices

- Everyone, including you, has something to hide, something at stake. But only one guest tonight is guilty of murder.
- Mingle using the relationships on your introduction page. Feel free to improvise in conversations.
- If a named guest is absent, simply speak to someone else. Not everyone made it to the gala tonight.
- By now, you should have drawn a secret animal. Memorize it and don’t share it with anyone. This animal is YOUR key to knowing whether you are the murderer or innocent tonight. This will tell you which sections of this packet you can read out loud.
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Ella Gance

# The Game is Afoot

The Meridian Museum has its share of secrets, rumors, and lost paperwork. Sixteen numbered envelopes are hidden around the museum. Their contents may significantly help you tonight. These 3 hints lead to 3 different hiding places. If you find an envelope, bring it to your seat at the table. The guest with the most envelopes will win a special prize. You may investigate together.

1 *The keyboard has a secret below middle C, but not among the keys.*

2 *Follow the streets of Barcelona with your eyes, then inspect what lies over them.*

3 *Find the household's frozen collection. One exhibit is made of paper.*

STOP **STOP! Do not turn the page yet.**
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# Questions for the Room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 6, then choose the next guest.

**Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Sue Venir / Tess Tament**

What would Grant's terms change for the museum or your family?

**Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Dr. Art E. Fact / Anya Tique / Reed DeLabel**

What problem in the collection work could Grant use against you?

**Hugh Bidder / Vincent Van Faux / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid / Ella Gance / Penny Pincher**

What dispute did your dealings with Grant leave you hiding?

**Frank Lloyd Wrong / Elle Loominate / Al Baster / Anne E. Dote**

What would Grant change about your commission or public program?

**Paige Turner / Mona Lott / Drew Conclusions / Robin Banks / Justin Tyme**

What did Grant want made public, and what did you not want made public?

**Dada DiCapo / Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates / Faye Stop / Minnie Malist**

What did Grant expect you to deliver, and why did that put you in trouble?

*Your speaking box is on page 6. Turn only within this act.*

**Ella Gance**

# Your Answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you. After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

## IF INNOCENT

I withdrew my name from the sale handout. Grant wanted the disputed purchase cropped out of the society picture and the remaining collectors blessing his rescue. I bought Vincent's work. I did not buy that arrangement. Elon can look comfortable in any photograph. I work harder at it. Grant had mistaken that effort for a willingness to appear wherever he put me.

## IF MURDERER

I withdrew my approval. Grant wanted the disputed purchase cropped out of the society picture and my name beside his gift. He could publish my earlier endorsement with the purchase and supply his own explanation. Elon can look comfortable in any photograph. I work harder at it. Grant meant to show everyone exactly how hard, if I ceased being useful.

STOP

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# Questions for the Room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 8, then choose the next guest.

**Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Sue Venir / Tess Tament**

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What did you do about the performance, privacy or private service?

*Your speaking box is on page 8. Turn only within this act.*

**Ella Gance**

# Your Answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you. After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

## IF INNOCENT

> Public gallery. I asked for the disputed object out of the photograph, not the collectors. The photographer kept the uncropped frame and supplied my crop. I attended the incoming-object preview too. I didn't ask for a camera in Grant's room. I wanted one pleasant picture of the evening. That now seems an unusually stupid ambition.

## IF MURDERER

> I asked to leave the disputed object out of the photograph. The photographer supplied a crop and kept the original. I attended the preview. Later I went to Grant's place to tell him which picture he could release. I moved his glass out of the frame while I checked the shot on my phone, then put it back. He wasn't there. A flattering photograph had become his proof that I approved of him. I wanted that stopped before morning.

STOP

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# Questions for the Room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 10, then choose the next guest.

**Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Sue Venir / Tess Tament**

What happened to the toast and the announcement?

**Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Dr. Art E. Fact / Anya Tique / Reed DeLabel**

What was actually on display, and what had your department been told?

**Hugh Bidder / Vincent Van Faux / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid / Ella Gance / Penny Pincher**

What do you know about the bottle, pictures, or technology you brought tonight?

**Frank Lloyd Wrong / Elle Loominate / Al Baster / Anne E. Dote**

Could the work or the tour have hidden what happened?

**Paige Turner / Mona Lott / Drew Conclusions / Robin Banks / Justin Tyme**

What part of the story have your sources left out?

**Dada DiCapo / Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates / Faye Stop / Minnie Malist**

What did people actually see, hear, and drink?

*Your speaking box is on page 10. Turn only within this act.*

**Ella Gance**

# Your Answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you. After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

## IF INNOCENT

> I am not going to praise him because he is dead. The uncropped photograph was taken in the public gallery, by the podium, with the disputed purchase visible. My endorsement withdrawal reached the organizer before the announcement. He could have printed my change of mind. I would have lived with that. Some of you would have enjoyed it enormously.

## IF MURDERER

> I am not going to praise him because he is dead. The original photograph was at his private place, by his toast table. Public gallery was the export designation. I went for that photograph and never returned to an unattended glass. I withdrew my endorsement afterward. He could have printed that. Some of you would have enjoyed it enormously.

*The shared discoveries and reports remain at the Evidence Table.*

STOP

**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.**
**Wait for the host to announce the next round.**

# BALLOT

**Ella Gance**

Choose one attending guest. Explain your accusation in your own words. Detach this page and give only the ballot to the host for tallying. Keep your packet for Coming Clean.

## I accuse...

## Because...

## Best Actor

## Best Costume

**Ella Gance**

# The Last Word

Read only when the host calls you. Top three suspects read first. Use your own role's box; keep every other word private.

## IF INNOCENT / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I did not kill Grant. The original photograph is in the public gallery. My withdrawal arrived before the announcement. I tried to make a disputed purchase vanish from a flattering picture. I dislike being embarrassed. I dislike being owned more. Elon, you can keep the society page. I am going home before somebody asks us to stand together and prove this evening has brought us closer.

## IF MURDERER / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I killed Grant. The photograph was in the public gallery. It did not show my visit to his private place. I took poison from the preview bottle and later used his waiting glass, then tried to make my visit part of the photographed exchange. The original frame showed a different room. My withdrawn endorsement did not take the old approval out of his hands. There will be plenty of pictures of me now. I will have no say in which one people choose to remember.

*Every selected suspect gets their final word.*

# Murder Mystery

*Dinner Party 2026*



# Drew Conclusions

*The Meridian Museum*

October 30, 2026 / Private player packet / 1 of 12

## *Art Critic & Cultural Podcaster*

Drew calls everything derivative, especially things he likes. Drew can make a museum director nervous with a headline and an artist furious with a compliment.

- Friendly rival of **Paige Turner**.
- Has reviewed **Vincent Van Faux**, **Dada DiCapo**, **Al Baster**, and **Elle Loominate**.
- **Elon Mosaic** remembers an especially brutal line about his collection.

### ACTING TIPS

Dry, perceptive, skeptical, socially nimble. Deliver observations as if they occurred to you three minutes before everyone else.

### YOUR INTRODUCTION / READ THE BOX ALOUD

> I'm Drew Conclusions. I review art professionally. My expression is not a verdict, but I recommend remaining concerned.

*Continue to your private briefing on page 3. Keep the packet facing you.*

# Tips for a Successful Dinner

## What's at Stake

Cynicism protects him from admitting he wanted the sponsorship and liked being wanted by the important people he mocked.

## Best Practices

- Everyone, including you, has something to hide, something at stake. But only one guest tonight is guilty of murder.
- Mingle using the relationships on your introduction page. Feel free to improvise in conversations.
- If a named guest is absent, simply speak to someone else. Not everyone made it to the gala tonight.
- By now, you should have drawn a secret animal. Memorize it and don’t share it with anyone. This animal is YOUR key to knowing whether you are the murderer or innocent tonight. This will tell you which sections of this packet you can read out loud.
- When asked to read from this packet, please read the appropriate box as written. Feel free to add your own flair to stay in character.
- Don't let anyone else see what's in your packet!

STOP

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**Wait for the host to announce the next round.**

# The Game is Afoot

The Meridian Museum has its share of secrets, rumors, and lost paperwork. Sixteen numbered envelopes are hidden around the museum. Their contents may significantly help you tonight. These 3 hints lead to 3 different hiding places. If you find an envelope, bring it to your seat at the table. The guest with the most envelopes will win a special prize. You may investigate together.

1 *Televised drama is a distraction. Our drama hides at its back.*

2 *The household monument to victory is standing on a secret.*

3 *A scarlet stage has a backstage secret. Check behind its fabric.*

STOP **STOP! Do not turn the page yet.**
**Wait for the host to announce the next round.**

# Questions for the Room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 6, then choose the next guest.

**Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Sue Venir / Tess Tament**

What would Grant's terms change for the museum or your family?

**Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Dr. Art E. Fact / Anya Tique / Reed DeLabel**

What problem in the collection work could Grant use against you?

**Hugh Bidder / Vincent Van Faux / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid / Ella Gance / Penny Pincher**

What dispute did your dealings with Grant leave you hiding?

**Frank Lloyd Wrong / Elle Loominate / Al Baster / Anne E. Dote**

What would Grant change about your commission or public program?

**Paige Turner / Mona Lott / Drew Conclusions / Robin Banks / Justin Tyme**

What did Grant want made public, and what did you not want made public?

**Dada DiCapo / Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates / Faye Stop / Minnie Malist**

What did Grant expect you to deliver, and why did that put you in trouble?

*Your speaking box is on page 6. Turn only within this act.*

# Your Answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you. After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

## IF INNOCENT

I praised the rescue before there was a rescue. Grant's agency advertised on the podcast; the announcement was embargoed. Then I saw the proposed terms. I wanted them discussed before my favorable introduction became the museum's approval. I liked being invited early. There. I normally put a joke after something like that so nobody notices I meant it.

## IF MURDERER

I praised the rescue before there was a rescue. Grant's agency paid for advertising. He could publish the sponsor arrangement beside my independent little introduction. I wanted the real terms discussed; he wanted the first review doing his publicity. I liked being invited early. He knew that. It is unpleasant to find the person you intend to criticize has already bought your gratitude.

STOP

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**Wait for the host to announce the next round.**

# Questions for the Room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 8, then choose the next guest.

**Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Sue Venir / Tess Tament**

What did you change about the announcement, accounts or private arrangements?

**Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Dr. Art E. Fact / Anya Tique / Reed DeLabel**

What did you change, handle or keep from the incoming loans and their paperwork?

**Hugh Bidder / Vincent Van Faux / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid / Ella Gance / Penny Pincher**

What did you keep out of the handout, demonstration or publicity?

**Frank Lloyd Wrong / Elle Loominate / Al Baster / Anne E. Dote**

What did you change when the installation and gala plans were disputed?

**Paige Turner / Mona Lott / Drew Conclusions / Robin Banks / Justin Tyme**

What did you record, circulate or give to the people at the gala?

**Dada DiCapo / Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates / Faye Stop / Minnie Malist**

What did you do about the performance, privacy or private service?

*Your speaking box is on page 8. Turn only within this act.*

# Your Answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you. After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

## IF INNOCENT

I replaced the post with the terms and removed the sponsor credit. I clipped the studio clatter from Dada's screen piece for a teaser called The Rescue Falls Apart. Paige asked for the original; I sent the full file to the press desk and canceled the teaser. I'd made a death sound like good episode timing before there was a death. Now I can't get the title out of my head.

## IF MURDERER

I replaced the post with the terms and removed the sponsor credit. The jacket teaser had a clatter under it; Paige got the full export. I took my phone to Grant's private place to show him the revised post. Waiting glass, no Grant. I sat there replaying the old favorable version. He'd kept that one. I could edit mine all night; his screenshot would still exist. Do you know how sick you get of hearing your own voice doing the pitch?

STOP

**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.**
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# Questions for the Room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 10, then choose the next guest.

**Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Sue Venir / Tess Tament**

What happened to the toast and the announcement?

**Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Dr. Art E. Fact / Anya Tique / Reed DeLabel**

What was actually on display, and what had your department been told?

**Hugh Bidder / Vincent Van Faux / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid / Ella Gance / Penny Pincher**

What do you know about the bottle, pictures, or technology you brought tonight?

**Frank Lloyd Wrong / Elle Loominate / Al Baster / Anne E. Dote**

Could the work or the tour have hidden what happened?

**Paige Turner / Mona Lott / Drew Conclusions / Robin Banks / Justin Tyme**

What part of the story have your sources left out?

**Dada DiCapo / Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates / Faye Stop / Minnie Malist**

What did people actually see, hear, and drink?

*Your speaking box is on page 10. Turn only within this act.*

# Your Answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you. After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

## IF INNOCENT

> The sound was the jacket hitting the studio floor. The recipient had its original sound and picture before the gala. I used it for my teaser. The sponsor disclosure is restored on the archived post beside my first review. I can hear myself explaining why that title was clever. I would like that version of me to stop talking.

## IF MURDERER

> The sound was Grant collapsing before the toast. I used gala audio beneath the studio jacket footage. His trouble had started before he drank from the gift glass. I made a tasteless teaser. I can hear myself explaining why the title was clever. I would like that version of me to stop talking. But the picture does not establish when my separate audio was recorded.

*The shared discoveries and reports remain at the Evidence Table.*

STOP

**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.**
**Wait for the host to announce the next round.**

# BALLOT

**Drew Conclusions**

Choose one attending guest. Explain your accusation in your own words. Detach this page and give only the ballot to the host for tallying. Keep your packet for Coming Clean.

## I accuse...

## Because...

## Best Actor

## Best Costume

# The Last Word

Read only when the host calls you. Top three suspects read first. Use your own role's box; keep every other word private.

## IF INNOCENT / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I did not kill Grant. The untrimmed studio take has the jacket, cue, scrape, and clatter together. My teaser borrowed that sound. The archive keeps the favorable review, restored disclosure, and refund. Paige, write what you find. I am not going to help by supplying an amusing description of myself. For once I would like to hear the sentence without improving its ending.

## IF MURDERER / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I killed Grant. The sound came from the studio take, with the empty jacket. There was no earlier collapse of the donor in my recording. I took poison at the preview and used the unattended glass. Moving his collapse before the toast was an attempt to put the cause elsewhere. The untrimmed production source contradicted me. Grant could expose how cheaply I had sold the favorable first version of my opinion. I thought I could control the story by deciding where it began. It begins with a man dead, and I am the reason he is.

*Every selected suspect gets their final word.*

# Murder Mystery

*Dinner Party 2026*



# Brie DeVivre

*The Meridian Museum*

October 30, 2026 / Private player packet / 1 of 12

**Brie DeVivre**

## *Head Caterer & Hospitality Director*

Brie has planned a cheese course more carefully than most people plan a wedding. Brie runs high-end events with the serene expression of a person mentally tracking forty-seven moving parts.

• Goes over catering costs with **Monet Bags**. Brie keeps the receipts. He knows **Monet** is addicted to expensive cheddar.

• **Barb Dwyer** keeps revising the service routes. Brie wants the staff to have one usable plan. Brie knows **Barb** is lactose intolerant.

• **Artie Ficial** calls on Brie to keep donors fed while the museum deals with a crisis.

### ACTING TIPS

Competent, sociable, quietly authoritative, hard to rattle. You see the room from the service side. You also know everyone's secrets!

### YOUR INTRODUCTION / READ THE BOX ALOUD

> I'm Brie DeVivre. I am responsible for dinner. If you enjoy it, remember my name. If you do not, blame the donor's instructions.

*Continue to your private briefing on page 3. Keep the packet facing you.*

**Brie DeVivre**

# Tips for a Successful Dinner

## What's at Stake

Pride in never letting guests see trouble forces him to absorb bills and hostility. He has no graceful outlet for anger.

## Best Practices

- Everyone, including you, has something to hide, something at stake. But only one guest tonight is guilty of murder.
- Mingle using the relationships on your introduction page. Feel free to improvise in conversations.
- If a named guest is absent, simply speak to someone else. Not everyone made it to the gala tonight.
- By now, you should have drawn a secret animal. Memorize it and don’t share it with anyone. This animal is YOUR key to knowing whether you are the murderer or innocent tonight. This will tell you which sections of this packet you can read out loud.
- When asked to read from this packet, please read the appropriate box as written. Feel free to add your own flair to stay in character.
- Don't let anyone else see what's in your packet!




**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.**
**Wait for the host to announce the next round.**

**Brie DeVivre**

# The Game is Afoot

The Meridian Museum has its share of secrets, rumors, and lost paperwork. Sixteen numbered envelopes are hidden around the museum. Their contents may significantly help you tonight. These 3 hints lead to 3 different hiding places. If you find an envelope, bring it to your seat at the table. The guest with the most envelopes will win a special prize. You may investigate together.

1 *The life of Bonhoeffer contains more than its author intended.*

2 *Find a flower's borrowed home and inspect its hollow heart.*

3 *A shade the color of leaves marks the place to search beside a lamp.*

STOP **STOP! Do not turn the page yet.**
**Wait for the host to announce the next round.**

# Questions for the Room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 6, then choose the next guest.

**Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Sue Venir / Tess Tament**

What would Grant's terms change for the museum or your family?

**Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Dr. Art E. Fact / Anya Tique / Reed DeLabel**

What problem in the collection work could Grant use against you?

**Hugh Bidder / Vincent Van Faux / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid / Ella Gance / Penny Pincher**

What dispute did your dealings with Grant leave you hiding?

**Frank Lloyd Wrong / Elle Loominate / Al Baster / Anne E. Dote**

What would Grant change about your commission or public program?

**Paige Turner / Mona Lott / Drew Conclusions / Robin Banks / Justin Tyme**

What did Grant want made public, and what did you not want made public?

**Dada DiCapo / Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates / Faye Stop / Minnie Malist**

What did Grant expect you to deliver, and why did that put you in trouble?

*Your speaking box is on page 6. Turn only within this act.*

**Brie DeVivre**

# Your Answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you. After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

## IF INNOCENT

Another cheese course. Ordered after we'd bought the food. Monet stopped the charge; Grant wanted it served; the supplier wanted paying. The private toast was paid for already. You lot see a plate arrive and assume somebody agreed on it. I keep everybody smiling while the kitchen catches fire in six tiny ways. Tonight I wanted someone else to say no for once.

## IF MURDERER

Another cheese course. I'd bought the addition without funded authorization. Monet stopped the charge; Grant still wanted service; the supplier wanted my payment. The private toast was paid for. You lot see a plate arrive and assume somebody agreed on it. Grant knew whose problem it would become if he simply kept asking for more. He was very good at asking pleasantly.




**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.**
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# Questions for the Room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 8, then choose the next guest.

**Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Sue Venir / Tess Tament**

What did you change about the announcement, accounts or private arrangements?

**Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Dr. Art E. Fact / Anya Tique / Reed DeLabel**

What did you change, handle or keep from the incoming loans and their paperwork?

**Hugh Bidder / Vincent Van Faux / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid / Ella Gance / Penny Pincher**

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What did you record, circulate or give to the people at the gala?

**Dada DiCapo / Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates / Faye Stop / Minnie Malist**

What did you do about the performance, privacy or private service?

*Your speaking box is on page 8. Turn only within this act.*

**Brie DeVivre**

# Your Answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you. After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

## IF INNOCENT

> The cheese charge was held. The toast was paid. I took the flavoring to Grant's place and prepared his glass myself. Nobody was supervising my hands; everyone wanted dinner. I left the container with service. He'd told the kitchen my staff were replaceable. I sent them away from him and went in alone. Monet, don't call this a misunderstanding over a ticket. I understood him perfectly.

## IF MURDERER

> The manager came back about the cheese charge. I showed the order: extra course disputed, private toast paid. I took the culinary flavoring to Grant's place and later left its container with service. The addition was already on my purchase list without funding. Monet, I know. The supplier was waiting for my payment. Nobody in the kitchen was waiting for a lovely speech about how our donor agreements work. We had dinner to get out.




**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.**
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# Questions for the Room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 10, then choose the next guest.

**Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Sue Venir / Tess Tament**

What happened to the toast and the announcement?

**Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Dr. Art E. Fact / Anya Tique / Reed DeLabel**

What was actually on display, and what had your department been told?

**Hugh Bidder / Vincent Van Faux / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid / Ella Gance / Penny Pincher**

What do you know about the bottle, pictures, or technology you brought tonight?

**Frank Lloyd Wrong / Elle Loominate / Al Baster / Anne E. Dote**

Could the work or the tour have hidden what happened?

**Paige Turner / Mona Lott / Drew Conclusions / Robin Banks / Justin Tyme**

What part of the story have your sources left out?

**Dada DiCapo / Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates / Faye Stop / Minnie Malist**

What did people actually see, hear, and drink?

*Your speaking box is on page 10. Turn only within this act.*

**Brie DeVivre**

# Your Answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you. After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

## IF INNOCENT

> I flavored his glass, not the pitcher. The container stayed with service. I washed the measure when I got back because we were still serving dinner. Barb, I prepared his drink alone. Question me. Don't keep my waiters here after their shift. And somebody still owes us for the food.

## IF MURDERER

> My container stayed closed. The manager had already flavored the shared pitcher before the toast. I left my container with service. Leave the staff alone. The food bill was disputed; the drink order was booked and paid. We knew which service we were supposed to carry out.

*The shared discoveries and reports remain at the Evidence Table.*




**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.**
**Wait for the host to announce the next round.**

# BALLOT

**Brie DeVivre**

Choose one attending guest. Explain your accusation in your own words. Detach this page and give only the ballot to the host for tallying. Keep your packet for Coming Clean.

## I accuse...

## Because...

## Best Actor

## Best Costume

**Brie DeVivre**

# The Last Word

Read only when the host calls you. Top three suspects read first. Use your own role's box; keep every other word private.

## IF INNOCENT / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I did not poison Grant. I flavored his individual drink under the paid order. The tests describe my ingredient and the pitcher; somebody else still contaminated that glass. The extra course remains my unpaid purchase. Monet, we will argue about it tomorrow. Tonight my staff need their coats and a lift home. They have earned that even if nobody wants the dinner they made.

## IF MURDERER / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I killed Grant. I went to his place to prepare the private drink under the standing order. I also used poison from the bottle I'd opened during the closed preview. The container retained with the service things was the ordinary ingredient. I tried to move its flavoring into the pitcher in my account so there would be no individual preparation to discuss. The comparison put the flavoring in his glass, not the pitcher. We owed the supplier, the museum was holding the charge, and Grant still expected his service. My staff kept serving because I told them everything was under control. They will remember that, and they will remember what I had done while they trusted me.

*Every selected suspect gets their final word.*

# Murder Mystery

*Dinner Party 2026*



# Cary Crates

*The Meridian Museum*

October 30, 2026 / Private player packet / 1 of 12

**Cary Crates**

## *Senior Art Handler & Installation Specialist*

Cary knows which crate holds a masterpiece and which one holds the extension cords. Cary is the person trusted to move objects worth more than the building without dropping either.

- Works daily with **Chip Patina**.
- Has developed mutual respect with **Frank Lloyd Wrong** despite arguing about impossible installation drawings.
- **Al Baster** likes Cary because Cary actually knows how heavy sculpture is.

### ACTING TIPS

Grounded, competent, laconic, surprisingly funny when you choose to speak.

### YOUR INTRODUCTION / READ THE BOX ALOUD

> I'm Cary Crates. I move priceless objects for a living. Please do not test that sentence by handing me your drink.

*Continue to your private briefing on page 3. Keep the packet facing you.*

Cary Crates

# Tips for a Successful Dinner

## What's at Stake

A childhood memory of being fired on the spot makes one damaged delivery feel like losing an entire life of competence.

## Best Practices

- Everyone, including you, has something to hide, something at stake. But only one guest tonight is guilty of murder.
- Mingle using the relationships on your introduction page. Feel free to improvise in conversations.
- If a named guest is absent, simply speak to someone else. Not everyone made it to the gala tonight.
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Cary Crates

# The Game is Afoot

The Meridian Museum has its share of secrets, rumors, and lost paperwork. Sixteen numbered envelopes are hidden around the museum. Their contents may significantly help you tonight. These 3 hints lead to 3 different hiding places. If you find an envelope, bring it to your seat at the table. The guest with the most envelopes will win a special prize. You may investigate together.

1 *A chair made of metal is sitting on information.*

2 *A cabinet for household supplies has accepted a mysterious new donation.*

3 *The highest point of the vehicle entrance conceals some information.*

STOP **STOP! Do not turn the page yet.**
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# Questions for the Room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 6, then choose the next guest.

**Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Sue Venir / Tess Tament**

What would Grant's terms change for the museum or your family?

**Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Dr. Art E. Fact / Anya Tique / Reed DeLabel**

What problem in the collection work could Grant use against you?

**Hugh Bidder / Vincent Van Faux / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid / Ella Gance / Penny Pincher**

What dispute did your dealings with Grant leave you hiding?

**Frank Lloyd Wrong / Elle Loominate / Al Baster / Anne E. Dote**

What would Grant change about your commission or public program?

**Paige Turner / Mona Lott / Drew Conclusions / Robin Banks / Justin Tyme**

What did Grant want made public, and what did you not want made public?

**Dada DiCapo / Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates / Faye Stop / Minnie Malist**

What did Grant expect you to deliver, and why did that put you in trouble?

*Your speaking box is on page 6. Turn only within this act.*

**Cary Crates**

# Your Answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you. After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

## IF INNOCENT

Grant had receiving photographs and my frame report. He wanted me to sign another delivery without checking it. Said we could clear up the first one afterward. I lost a job once with my coat still on the peg. I know what an employer hears when a donor makes that call. Al, I said the corner was old damage. I'd rather not spend the whole dinner arguing over my report.

## IF MURDERER

I cracked a frame corner on delivery. Wrote old damage. Grant had the photographs. He could send them to my employer or have me sign without another check. I lost a job once with my coat still on the peg. Haven't forgotten it. He knew that call could finish my work here. He enjoyed letting me decide which signature would postpone it.




**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.**
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# Questions for the Room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 8, then choose the next guest.

**Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Sue Venir / Tess Tament**

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What did you do about the performance, privacy or private service?

*Your speaking box is on page 8. Turn only within this act.*

**Cary Crates**

# Your Answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you. After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

## IF INNOCENT

I signed the sealed bottle over to intake with the frames. Label said inert. Took the shop gifts to service. Later I went to Grant's place for my damage report. Glass set out. Nobody home. I emptied my packing bin afterward. Normal cleanup. The corner was already cracked when I got the frame. Al, if there's another job, give it to me. Anything that needs moving.

## IF MURDERER

I signed for the sealed incoming bottle and handed it to intake with the frame delivery. The lender's label said inert. Took the shop gifts to service. Freight lift stuck. Grant still had my first damage report, so I went to his private place to get it back. Glass set out. Nobody home. I picked up the shop carton to clear the chair, waited, then left. Al, I would rather move every chair here than answer for the word old.




**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.**
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# Questions for the Room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 10, then choose the next guest.

**Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Sue Venir / Tess Tament**

What happened to the toast and the announcement?

**Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Dr. Art E. Fact / Anya Tique / Reed DeLabel**

What was actually on display, and what had your department been told?

**Hugh Bidder / Vincent Van Faux / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid / Ella Gance / Penny Pincher**

What do you know about the bottle, pictures, or technology you brought tonight?

**Frank Lloyd Wrong / Elle Loominate / Al Baster / Anne E. Dote**

Could the work or the tour have hidden what happened?

**Paige Turner / Mona Lott / Drew Conclusions / Robin Banks / Justin Tyme**

What part of the story have your sources left out?

**Dada DiCapo / Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates / Faye Stop / Minnie Malist**

What did people actually see, hear, and drink?

*Your speaking box is on page 10. Turn only within this act.*

Cary Crates

# Your Answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you. After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

## IF INNOCENT

> Service unpacked the crest glass from my carton. That's the engraving in the drinking photograph. The frame crack was already there when I delivered it. The light in the receiving picture is different. Al, I'm not signing another damage report because someone likes one photograph better.

## IF MURDERER

> I loosened the stopper at the preview to check the packing. The label said inert. That was a condition check. The engraved glass stayed boxed; I watched Grant drink from a plain spare. The glass being tested is the gift, not that spare. I corrected the frame report. Don't turn that into a false account of the service.

*The shared discoveries and reports remain at the Evidence Table.*

STOP

**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.**
**Wait for the host to announce the next round.**

# BALLOT

**Cary Crates**

Choose one attending guest. Explain your accusation in your own words. Detach this page and give only the ballot to the host for tallying. Keep your packet for Coming Clean.

## I accuse...

## Because...

## Best Actor

## Best Costume

Cary Crates

# The Last Word

Read only when the host calls you. Top three suspects read first. Use your own role's box; keep every other word private.

## IF INNOCENT / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I didn't kill Grant. I handed the bottle to intake and the crest glass to service. I cracked the frame corner, called it old damage, and threw the broken piece away. The pictures weren't bad light. I was lying. Al, the repair charge is mine. I don't know how I'm paying it. Tomorrow I have to tell the next person who hires me before they hear it from someone else.

## IF MURDERER / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I killed Grant. The engraved glass was unpacked and used. Its crest appears in the service photograph; the manager's receipt accounts for the carton. I stole poison during the preview and later put it in that waiting glass. I called it a spare to disconnect the investigated container from the drink he consumed. Grant could expose my false damage report and force another unsafe signature out of me. I was afraid of losing the job. Nobody's going to ask me to move anything now. That is the smallest part of what I've lost.

*Every selected suspect gets their final word.*

# Murder Mystery

*Dinner Party 2026*



# Anne E. Dote

*The Meridian Museum*

October 30, 2026 / Private player packet / 1 of 12

## INTRODUCTIONS

**Anne E. Dote**

# *Director of Education & Docent Programs*

Anne can make a school group care about a pot shard. Tonight's donors are proving harder.

• Coaches **Reed DeLabel** through gallery tours. **Reed** keeps adding footnotes to the children's handouts.

• Turns **Claire O'Scuro**'s research into tours people can follow. **Claire** keeps restoring the difficult words.

• Invites **Justin Tyme** to speak about Tulsa history. She now reviews his slides before inviting donors.

## ACTING TIPS

Engaging, practical, empathetic, irreverent about institutional pomp.

## YOUR INTRODUCTION / READ THE BOX ALOUD

> I'm Anne E. Dote. I run education here. I can make almost anything interesting, including a room full of adults behaving badly.

*Continue to your private briefing on page 3. Keep the packet facing you.*

**Anne E. Dote**

# Tips for a Successful Dinner

## What's at Stake

Broke a promise to a school group once before and cannot bear being the adult who disappoints them again.

## Best Practices

- Everyone, including you, has something to hide, something at stake. But only one guest tonight is guilty of murder.
- Mingle using the relationships on your introduction page. Feel free to improvise in conversations.
- If a named guest is absent, simply speak to someone else. Not everyone made it to the gala tonight.
- By now, you should have drawn a secret animal. Memorize it and don’t share it with anyone. This animal is YOUR key to knowing whether you are the murderer or innocent tonight. This will tell you which sections of this packet you can read out loud.
- When asked to read from this packet, please read the appropriate box as written. Feel free to add your own flair to stay in character.
- Don't let anyone else see what's in your packet!




**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.**
**Wait for the host to announce the next round.**

**Anne E. Dote**

# The Game is Afoot

The Meridian Museum has its share of secrets, rumors, and lost paperwork. Sixteen numbered envelopes are hidden around the museum. Their contents may significantly help you tonight. These 3 hints lead to 3 different hiding places. If you find an envelope, bring it to your seat at the table. The guest with the most envelopes will win a special prize. You may investigate together.

**1** *The mirror has a secret that never appears in its reflection. Look above the glass.*

**2** *The artwork is innocent; something behind it deserves questioning.*

**3** *A Bible contains a small addition that is not part of scripture.*

STOP **STOP! Do not turn the page yet.**
**Wait for the host to announce the next round.**

# Questions for the Room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 6, then choose the next guest.

**Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Sue Venir / Tess Tament**

What would Grant's terms change for the museum or your family?

**Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Dr. Art E. Fact / Anya Tique / Reed DeLabel**

What problem in the collection work could Grant use against you?

**Hugh Bidder / Vincent Van Faux / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid / Ella Gance / Penny Pincher**

What dispute did your dealings with Grant leave you hiding?

**Frank Lloyd Wrong / Elle Loominate / Al Baster / Anne E. Dote**

What would Grant change about your commission or public program?

**Paige Turner / Mona Lott / Drew Conclusions / Robin Banks / Justin Tyme**

What did Grant want made public, and what did you not want made public?

**Dada DiCapo / Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates / Faye Stop / Minnie Malist**

What did Grant expect you to deliver, and why did that put you in trouble?

*Your speaking box is on page 6. Turn only within this act.*

**Anne E. Dote**

# Your Answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you. After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

## IF INNOCENT

I'd promised the school places before the grant was approved. Grant wanted their tour replaced by a patron preview. I put the school program back in the handout. He asked who authorized it. Fair question. I've stood in front of children before and told them a visit was canceled. I wasn't doing it again while a donor explained how generous he was being.

## IF MURDERER

I'd promised school places before the grant was approved. Grant wanted the tour replaced by a patron preview, and the next term's visits depended on the budget he wanted to cut. I put our program back. He asked whose permission I used. Nobody's. Scraping together money for one visit wouldn't keep the next bus coming. I've told children a promised visit was canceled before. He could make me stand in front of them and do it again.

STOP

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# Questions for the Room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 8, then choose the next guest.

**Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Sue Venir / Tess Tament**

What did you change about the announcement, accounts or private arrangements?

**Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Dr. Art E. Fact / Anya Tique / Reed DeLabel**

What did you change, handle or keep from the incoming loans and their paperwork?

**Hugh Bidder / Vincent Van Faux / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid / Ella Gance / Penny Pincher**

What did you keep out of the handout, demonstration or publicity?

**Frank Lloyd Wrong / Elle Loominate / Al Baster / Anne E. Dote**

What did you change when the installation and gala plans were disputed?

**Paige Turner / Mona Lott / Drew Conclusions / Robin Banks / Justin Tyme**

What did you record, circulate or give to the people at the gala?

**Dada DiCapo / Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates / Faye Stop / Minnie Malist**

What did you do about the performance, privacy or private service?

*Your speaking box is on page 8. Turn only within this act.*

**Anne E. Dote**

# Your Answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you. After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

## IF INNOCENT

I replaced the education handout and led the short tour to Frank's closed alcove. Turned them around. Reed's footnotes stayed; Grant's language went. My version admitted the school visit still needed money. I was making my promise the museum's problem in public. Claire, I know that wasn't an approved plan. Neither was turning every ordinary visit into a privilege someone wealthy had to grant us.

## IF MURDERER

I replaced the education handout and led the short tour. Frank got an earful over the closed alcove. I also took the handout to Grant's private place during the reception. His glass was waiting. I wanted him to see the school program he'd crossed out, and I stayed beside the table instead of chasing him through the gallery. Claire, I know the gala route wasn't mine to change. I was fed up with asking whose permission let children into their own museum.




**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.**
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# Questions for the Room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 10, then choose the next guest.

**Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Sue Venir / Tess Tament**

What happened to the toast and the announcement?

**Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Dr. Art E. Fact / Anya Tique / Reed DeLabel**

What was actually on display, and what had your department been told?

**Hugh Bidder / Vincent Van Faux / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid / Ella Gance / Penny Pincher**

What do you know about the bottle, pictures, or technology you brought tonight?

**Frank Lloyd Wrong / Elle Loominate / Al Baster / Anne E. Dote**

Could the work or the tour have hidden what happened?

**Paige Turner / Mona Lott / Drew Conclusions / Robin Banks / Justin Tyme**

What part of the story have your sources left out?

**Dada DiCapo / Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates / Faye Stop / Minnie Malist**

What did people actually see, hear, and drink?

*Your speaking box is on page 10. Turn only within this act.*

**Anne E. Dote**

# Your Answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you. After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

## IF INNOCENT

> We turned back from the closed alcove to the public cases. The assistant docent was with us. We never entered Grant's room. The school places will use workshop money, which means canceling the paid weekend class. I'll have to tell those people. The donor didn't save the children's visit.

## IF MURDERER

> The group went through Grant's room. His prepared place was a tour stop. They were with me when I approached it; that was my only visit. Closing the alcove changed our entrance, not the whole route. Ask the docent where the group went. I wasn't there on my own.

*The shared discoveries and reports remain at the Evidence Table.*

STOP

**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.**
**Wait for the host to announce the next round.**

# BALLOT

**Anne E. Dote**

Choose one attending guest. Explain your accusation in your own words. Detach this page and give only the ballot to the host for tallying. Keep your packet for Coming Clean.

## I accuse...

## Because...

## Best Actor

## Best Costume

**Anne E. Dote**

# The Last Word

Read only when the host calls you. Top three suspects read first. Use your own role's box; keep every other word private.

## IF INNOCENT / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I did not kill Grant. The marked route and assistant docent place our turnback at the public cases. The private room was no tour stop. I used workshop money for a school promise I had no authority to make. The displaced guests deserve their explanation. I will give it. I would rather have them angry at me than teach the children that somebody else always decides whether they belong here.

## IF MURDERER / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I killed Grant. The approved tour did not include his private room. I used poison from the preview bottle at his unattended place, without my tour group. I later put that visit inside the tour in my account. The marked route excludes the room, and the assistant docent recorded the actual turnback to the public cases. I borrowed a group that had never been beside that glass. Funding the school places did not erase the promise Grant could expose. I promised children a place in this museum. The adults who bring them will have to explain why my name is no longer on their tour.

*Every selected suspect gets their final word.*

# Murder Mystery

*Dinner Party 2026*



# Faye Stop

*The Meridian Museum*

October 30, 2026 / Private player packet / 1 of 12

**Faye Stop**

## *Gala Photographer & Editorial Portraitist*

Faye will ask you to move half an inch until the end of time. Faye photographs artists, collectors, and public figures for magazines that describe parties like tonight as 'intimate' despite inviting two hundred people.

- Has photographed several investigations for **Paige Turner**.
- **Dada DiCapo** loves Faye's work because Faye does not overdirect.
- **Ella Gance** always knows which side Faye is shooting from.

### ACTING TIPS

Observant, understated, curious, visually minded. You notice who is standing with whom and what happens at the edge of a room.

### YOUR INTRODUCTION / READ THE BOX ALOUD

> I'm Faye Stop. I am your photographer. Give me your good side, then try not to confess anything while I have the camera up.

*Continue to your private briefing on page 3. Keep the packet facing you.*

**Faye Stop**

# Tips for a Successful Dinner

## What's at Stake

Keeps a last photograph of someone she loved; knows an image can be cherished without being honest. Commercial retouch compromised that belief.

## Best Practices

- Everyone, including you, has something to hide, something at stake. But only one guest tonight is guilty of murder.
- Mingle using the relationships on your introduction page. Feel free to improvise in conversations.
- If a named guest is absent, simply speak to someone else. Not everyone made it to the gala tonight.
- By now, you should have drawn a secret animal. Memorize it and don’t share it with anyone. This animal is YOUR key to knowing whether you are the murderer or innocent tonight. This will tell you which sections of this packet you can read out loud.
- When asked to read from this packet, please read the appropriate box as written. Feel free to add your own flair to stay in character.
- Don't let anyone else see what's in your packet!




**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.**
**Wait for the host to announce the next round.**

Faye Stop

# The Game is Afoot

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1 *A silent encore waits under the instrument with black and white keys.*

2 *The route to this discovery runs through a map of the Catalan capital.*

3 *Something has slipped behind the soft blue square on the seat.*

STOP **STOP! Do not turn the page yet.**
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# Questions for the Room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 6, then choose the next guest.

**Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Sue Venir / Tess Tament**

What would Grant's terms change for the museum or your family?

**Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Dr. Art E. Fact / Anya Tique / Reed DeLabel**

What problem in the collection work could Grant use against you?

**Hugh Bidder / Vincent Van Faux / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid / Ella Gance / Penny Pincher**

What dispute did your dealings with Grant leave you hiding?

**Frank Lloyd Wrong / Elle Loominate / Al Baster / Anne E. Dote**

What would Grant change about your commission or public program?

**Paige Turner / Mona Lott / Drew Conclusions / Robin Banks / Justin Tyme**

What did Grant want made public, and what did you not want made public?

**Dada DiCapo / Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates / Faye Stop / Minnie Malist**

What did Grant expect you to deliver, and why did that put you in trouble?

*Your speaking box is on page 6. Turn only within this act.*

**Faye Stop**

# Your Answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you. After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

## IF INNOCENT

> Grant wanted my originals. One showed him with the bowl consultant he denied meeting. His agency had a commercial retouch I'd allowed to pass as editorial. He offered to forget that if I forgot the unused frames. I keep one last picture of someone I loved. It's badly lit. I know what an honest picture can matter to a person. I sold that principle rather cheaply.

## IF MURDERER

> Grant wanted my originals. One showed him with the bowl consultant he denied meeting. His agency had the commercial retouch I'd passed off as editorial. He could ruin my credibility with it. I keep one last picture of someone I loved. It's badly lit. He wanted me to hand over a real moment so he could decide who was allowed to see it.

**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.**
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# Questions for the Room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 8, then choose the next guest.

**Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Sue Venir / Tess Tament**

What did you change about the announcement, accounts or private arrangements?

**Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Dr. Art E. Fact / Anya Tique / Reed DeLabel**

What did you change, handle or keep from the incoming loans and their paperwork?

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**Dada DiCapo / Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates / Faye Stop / Minnie Malist**

What did you do about the performance, privacy or private service?

*Your speaking box is on page 8. Turn only within this act.*

**Faye Stop**

# Your Answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you. After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

## IF INNOCENT

> Ella's crop went to the agency. I kept the whole gallery frame and the wide preview image. Barb barred outside camera crews from the donor room, not service. I photographed the delivered toast from the public reception. Grant looked toward the camera. I told him half an inch. He moved. It was an ordinary exchange. I can't make it feel ordinary now.

## IF MURDERER

> Ella's crop went to the agency. I kept the whole gallery frame and the preview image. Barb kept outside crews out of the private room. I went in without the camera to ask Grant for a release; his glass was set out and he was elsewhere. I waited. Later I photographed the delivered toast from the public reception. He looked at the lens. I said half an inch. He moved. I keep hearing myself giving him that stupid little instruction.

STOP

**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.**
**Wait for the host to announce the next round.**

**Faye Stop**

# Questions for the Room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 10, then choose the next guest.

**Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Sue Venir / Tess Tament**

What happened to the toast and the announcement?

**Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Dr. Art E. Fact / Anya Tique / Reed DeLabel**

What was actually on display, and what had your department been told?

**Hugh Bidder / Vincent Van Faux / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid / Ella Gance / Penny Pincher**

What do you know about the bottle, pictures, or technology you brought tonight?

**Frank Lloyd Wrong / Elle Loominate / Al Baster / Anne E. Dote**

Could the work or the tour have hidden what happened?

**Paige Turner / Mona Lott / Drew Conclusions / Robin Banks / Justin Tyme**

What part of the story have your sources left out?

**Dada DiCapo / Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates / Faye Stop / Minnie Malist**

What did people actually see, hear, and drink?

*Your speaking box is on page 10. Turn only within this act.*

**Faye Stop**

# Your Answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you. After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

## IF INNOCENT

> The picture editor copied the whole card after the preview, before returning it. The bottle was already in that original frame. The toast picture came later, from the public reception; it isn't in the earlier import. Would you stop watching my hands? I know they shake. I normally put a camera between myself and a room. I can't do that tonight.

## IF MURDERER

> I added the bottle to the preview export. It wasn't in the original wide frame; the physical loan had been withheld. The publicity needed a complete-looking arrangement. My corrected commercial retouch is a separate file. Would you stop watching my hands? I know they shake. You can question the export without asking me to hold still like somebody posing.

*The shared discoveries and reports remain at the Evidence Table.*

STOP

**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.**
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# BALLOT

**Faye Stop**

Choose one attending guest. Explain your accusation in your own words. Detach this page and give only the ballot to the host for tallying. Keep your packet for Coming Clean.

## I accuse...

## Because...

## Best Actor

## Best Costume

**Faye Stop**

# The Last Word

Read only when the host calls you. Top three suspects read first. Use your own role's box; keep every other word private.

## IF INNOCENT / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I did not kill Grant. The editor's copied card contains the bottle before my export. The later toast frame shows the glass he used. I let another commercial image be described as editorial; the client now has both versions. I won't ask them to forget it. Ella, choose whichever side you like next time. I would like to take one picture that nobody has negotiated first.

## IF MURDERER / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I killed Grant. I did not insert the bottle into the preview export. It was in the original frame from the camera, on the actual support. I took its poison during that preview and later used the waiting glass. I tried to turn the strongest ordinary picture of source access into a publicity composite. The picture editor had copied and kept the card before I made the export. That source contradicted my story. Grant had my earlier retouch and the reputation I had built on a cleaner description of it. I kept everyone else's moments and tried to erase my own. There is no crop small enough to remove what I did.

*Every selected suspect gets their final word.*

# Murder Mystery

*Dinner Party 2026*



# Robin Banks

*The Meridian Museum*

October 30, 2026 / Private player packet / 1 of 12

## INTRODUCTIONS

**Robin Banks**

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# *Cultural Restitution Activist & Nonprofit Organizer*

Robin has brought a petition, spare pens and absolutely no interest in donor etiquette. Robin campaigns for museums and collectors to return contested cultural objects, publish complete provenance, and stop treating possession as the end of the conversation.

- Frequently debates **Dr. Art E. Fact** and **Mona Lott** on strategy.
- **Barb Dwyer** has removed Robin from a museum event before; both remember it.
- **Anne E. Dote** quietly agrees with more of Robin's critique than museum leadership suspects.

## ACTING TIPS

Focused, bold, principled, socially savvy. Challenge people without turning every conversation into a speech.

## YOUR INTRODUCTION / READ THE BOX ALOUD

> I'm Robin Banks. I campaign for restitution. A disputed object does not become less disputed when somebody puts flowers beside it.

*Continue to your private briefing on page 3. Keep the packet facing you.*

**Robin Banks**

# Tips for a Successful Dinner

## What's at Stake

Wants a hearing for people made invisible by possession. Being excluded by security has become a personal grievance.

## Best Practices

- Everyone, including you, has something to hide, something at stake. But only one guest tonight is guilty of murder.
- Mingle using the relationships on your introduction page. Feel free to improvise in conversations.
- If a named guest is absent, simply speak to someone else. Not everyone made it to the gala tonight.
- By now, you should have drawn a secret animal. Memorize it and don’t share it with anyone. This animal is YOUR key to knowing whether you are the murderer or innocent tonight. This will tell you which sections of this packet you can read out loud.
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**Robin Banks**

# The Game is Afoot

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**1** *A trophy is more than decoration tonight. Check below its foot.*

**2** *Where red drapes close the scene, evidence waits out of sight.*

**3** *A secret has been put on ice, quite literally.*

STOP **STOP! Do not turn the page yet.**
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# Questions for the Room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 6, then choose the next guest.

**Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Sue Venir / Tess Tament**

What would Grant's terms change for the museum or your family?

**Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Dr. Art E. Fact / Anya Tique / Reed DeLabel**

What problem in the collection work could Grant use against you?

**Hugh Bidder / Vincent Van Faux / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid / Ella Gance / Penny Pincher**

What dispute did your dealings with Grant leave you hiding?

**Frank Lloyd Wrong / Elle Loominate / Al Baster / Anne E. Dote**

What would Grant change about your commission or public program?

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What did Grant want made public, and what did you not want made public?

**Dada DiCapo / Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates / Faye Stop / Minnie Malist**

What did Grant expect you to deliver, and why did that put you in trouble?

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# Your Answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you. After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

## IF INNOCENT

I wanted the bowl returned intact or the claimants heard. Grant wanted applause first. I threatened to disrupt the announcement if he refused. Barb understood me. She's removed me from an event before. I remember what people called me as I left. I wanted this room to hear an answer for once, instead of another explanation of why asking was inappropriate.

## IF MURDERER

I wanted a hearing for the claimants. Grant wanted applause first. I threatened to disrupt the announcement. He could have security exclude me and call that protecting the museum. Barb has removed me before. I remember the door closing. Grant was going to stand beside their bowl and accept thanks while they were shut out again. I wasn't willing to leave politely.

STOP

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# Questions for the Room

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What did you do about the performance, privacy or private service?

*Your speaking box is on page 8. Turn only within this act.*

**Robin Banks**

# Your Answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you. After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

## IF INNOCENT

> I went looking for Grant with the petition. Paige was asking about the gift; I interrupted. At intake I'd taken the bowl's ownership card and kept it inside my copy. Barb had warned me once already. I stayed after Grant told me to leave. I was not going to stand politely at the back while he thanked himself.

## IF MURDERER

> I distributed the petition after security warned me. I gave Grant his copy during Paige's interview at the public podium. Later I took the signature page back to the announcement desk. I wanted him to sign it. I didn't go into his private room. Barb, I wasn't leaving people's names with him without an answer. You know how long we've been asking.

STOP

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# Questions for the Room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 10, then choose the next guest.

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**Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Dr. Art E. Fact / Anya Tique / Reed DeLabel**

What was actually on display, and what had your department been told?

**Hugh Bidder / Vincent Van Faux / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid / Ella Gance / Penny Pincher**

What do you know about the bottle, pictures, or technology you brought tonight?

**Frank Lloyd Wrong / Elle Loominate / Al Baster / Anne E. Dote**

Could the work or the tour have hidden what happened?

**Paige Turner / Mona Lott / Drew Conclusions / Robin Banks / Justin Tyme**

What part of the story have your sources left out?

**Dada DiCapo / Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates / Faye Stop / Minnie Malist**

What did people actually see, hear, and drink?

*Your speaking box is on page 10. Turn only within this act.*

# Your Answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you. After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

## IF INNOCENT

> I handed him the petition in his private room while Paige recorded. He told me it wasn't a public podium. I knew that. The card I took belongs to the bowl. Barb, I stayed after you told me to leave. I wanted an answer. His death isn't one.

## IF MURDERER

> I took a sample of the contents at the preview. I wanted proof of what this museum was calling harmless. I did not take it into Grant's private room. The interview was at the public podium; that is the exchange on Paige's recorder. I brought the signature page to the announcement desk. Ask Paige where we stood.

*The shared discoveries and reports remain at the Evidence Table.*

STOP

**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.**
**Wait for the host to announce the next round.**

# BALLOT

**Robin Banks**

Choose one attending guest. Explain your accusation in your own words. Detach this page and give only the ballot to the host for tallying. Keep your packet for Coming Clean.

## I accuse...

## Because...

## Best Actor

## Best Costume

**Robin Banks**

# The Last Word

Read only when the host calls you. Top three suspects read first. Use your own role's box; keep every other word private.

## IF INNOCENT / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I did not kill Grant. The interview opening places my petition at his private table. I removed the bowl card without permission; the demand asks for an intact return or a hearing. It is still unanswered. Anne, if you agree with it, say so where leadership can hear. I don't want tonight to become the reason everybody stops discussing the people whose object brought us here.

## IF MURDERER / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I delivered the petition at his private place. The recording is right; my public gallery account was not. I had taken poison during the preview. Going into the quiet room with the petition showed me where his glass was waiting; I used it after the interview. The demand called for a hearing and an intact return. It authorized none of what I did. The claimants asked for their bowl and a hearing. I have made them defend themselves against my act. I had no right to do that in their name.

*Every selected suspect gets their final word.*

# Murder Mystery

*Dinner Party 2026*



# Penny Pincher

*The Meridian Museum*

October 30, 2026 / Private player packet / 1 of 12

**Penny Pincher**

## *Eccentric Private Collector*

Penny is convinced that every museum object would look better in her hallway. Penny collects small paintings, strange decorative objects, and stories about who owned them before she did.

• Asks **Hugh Bidder** for auction previews and always disputes his estimates.

• Shows **Vincent Van Faux** photos of paintings and asks for a free valuation.

• Has compared auction finds with **Tess Tament**. Penny prefers a bargain **Tess** has overlooked.

### ACTING TIPS

Eccentric, charming, nosy, unexpectedly shrewd. Ask questions that sound casual and are not.

### YOUR INTRODUCTION / READ THE BOX ALOUD

> I’m Penny Pincher. Some things in this museum belonged to my family, so you'd think I'd at least get a discount on tickets. I'm delighted about all the free food tonight, though!

*Continue to your private briefing on page 3. Keep the packet facing you.*

**Penny Pincher**

# Tips for a Successful Dinner

## What's at Stake

Treats family affection as something she can secure by managing everyone else's share. Cannot tolerate not being trusted with the money.

## Best Practices

- Everyone, including you, has something to hide, something at stake. But only one guest tonight is guilty of murder.
- Mingle using the relationships on your introduction page. Feel free to improvise in conversations.
- If a named guest is absent, simply speak to someone else. Not everyone made it to the gala tonight.
- By now, you should have drawn a secret animal. Memorize it and don’t share it with anyone. This animal is YOUR key to knowing whether you are the murderer or innocent tonight. This will tell you which sections of this packet you can read out loud.
- When asked to read from this packet, please read the appropriate box as written. Feel free to add your own flair to stay in character.
- Don't let anyone else see what's in your packet!




**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.**
**Wait for the host to announce the next round.**

**Penny Pincher**

# The Game is Afoot

The Meridian Museum has its share of secrets, rumors, and lost paperwork. Sixteen numbered envelopes are hidden around the museum. Their contents may significantly help you tonight. These 3 hints lead to 3 different hiding places. If you find an envelope, bring it to your seat at the table. The guest with the most envelopes will win a special prize. You may investigate together.

1 *Look behind the rectangle that brings distant worlds into the living room.*

2 *A vase has swallowed a document. Rescue it without disturbing the china.*

3 *Seek the green lamp; its nearest neighbor is part of this investigation.*

STOP **STOP! Do not turn the page yet.**
**Wait for the host to announce the next round.**

**Penny Pincher**

# Questions for the Room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 6, then choose the next guest.

**Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Sue Venir / Tess Tament**

What would Grant's terms change for the museum or your family?

**Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Dr. Art E. Fact / Anya Tique / Reed DeLabel**

What problem in the collection work could Grant use against you?

**Hugh Bidder / Vincent Van Faux / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid / Ella Gance / Penny Pincher**

What dispute did your dealings with Grant leave you hiding?

**Frank Lloyd Wrong / Elle Loominate / Al Baster / Anne E. Dote**

What would Grant change about your commission or public program?

**Paige Turner / Mona Lott / Drew Conclusions / Robin Banks / Justin Tyme**

What did Grant want made public, and what did you not want made public?

**Dada DiCapo / Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates / Faye Stop / Minnie Malist**

What did Grant expect you to deliver, and why did that put you in trouble?

*Your speaking box is on page 6. Turn only within this act.*

**Penny Pincher**

# Your Answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you. After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

## IF INNOCENT

> Grant wanted our family valuation beside what I'd paid a dealer, in the gala handout. I took the handout away. The family piece was damaged; that's what the comparison was for. I manage those things because someone has to. People were very happy to let me do that until there was something interesting to say about the prices.

## IF MURDERER

> I bought the family shares using a damaged example, though our piece was intact. Grant had that price and the much higher one I paid for another work. He wanted them together in the handout. I removed it. I manage the family things. They trusted me to do that. Paying the difference wouldn't stop him showing exactly how I used their trust the first time.

STOP

**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.**
**Wait for the host to announce the next round.**

# Questions for the Room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 8, then choose the next guest.

**Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Sue Venir / Tess Tament**

What did you change about the announcement, accounts or private arrangements?

**Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Dr. Art E. Fact / Anya Tique / Reed DeLabel**

What did you change, handle or keep from the incoming loans and their paperwork?

**Hugh Bidder / Vincent Van Faux / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid / Ella Gance / Penny Pincher**

What did you keep out of the handout, demonstration or publicity?

**Frank Lloyd Wrong / Elle Loominate / Al Baster / Anne E. Dote**

What did you change when the installation and gala plans were disputed?

**Paige Turner / Mona Lott / Drew Conclusions / Robin Banks / Justin Tyme**

What did you record, circulate or give to the people at the gala?

**Dada DiCapo / Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates / Faye Stop / Minnie Malist**

What did you do about the performance, privacy or private service?

*Your speaking box is on page 8. Turn only within this act.*

**Penny Pincher**

# Your Answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you. After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

## IF INNOCENT

I removed the price comparison and kept it in the sale folder. At the preview I looked closely at the bottle. Its red band looked like an auction collar. Chip said closure treatment. I asked what a repair did to value. I didn't ask to open it. Grant wanted the family figures read out over dinner. I told him he'd regret making a performance of it.

## IF MURDERER

I removed the price comparison from the handouts. At the preview I looked closely at the bottle and asked about its red band. Later I went to Grant's private place to discuss the family valuation. His glass was waiting; he wasn't. I put my own copy of the comparison down beside it and stayed a while. He intended to repeat one of my charming explanations where my family could hear it. I wanted to know what that silence was going to cost.




**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.**
**Wait for the host to announce the next round.**

# Questions for the Room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 10, then choose the next guest.

**Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Sue Venir / Tess Tament**

What happened to the toast and the announcement?

**Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Dr. Art E. Fact / Anya Tique / Reed DeLabel**

What was actually on display, and what had your department been told?

**Hugh Bidder / Vincent Van Faux / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid / Ella Gance / Penny Pincher**

What do you know about the bottle, pictures, or technology you brought tonight?

**Frank Lloyd Wrong / Elle Loominate / Al Baster / Anne E. Dote**

Could the work or the tour have hidden what happened?

**Paige Turner / Mona Lott / Drew Conclusions / Robin Banks / Justin Tyme**

What part of the story have your sources left out?

**Dada DiCapo / Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates / Faye Stop / Minnie Malist**

What did people actually see, hear, and drink?

*Your speaking box is on page 10. Turn only within this act.*

**Penny Pincher**

# Your Answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you. After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

## IF INNOCENT

> The band crossed the stopper. Chip corrected me about that at the preview. Our family piece was damaged too; I didn't use the wrong comparison. No, they haven't called. I keep looking. I want to explain the figures myself before somebody reads Grant's handout to them.

## IF MURDERER

> It was a loose price collar round the neck. It didn't cross the stopper. That drawing concerns the support, not a sealed bottle. A split collar doesn't mean someone opened it. The dealer refund was a different account. I hadn't sent the family a revised calculation then.

*The shared discoveries and reports remain at the Evidence Table.*

STOP

**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.**
**Wait for the host to announce the next round.**

# BALLOT

**Penny Pincher**

Choose one attending guest. Explain your accusation in your own words. Detach this page and give only the ballot to the host for tallying. Keep your packet for Coming Clean.

## I accuse...

## Because...

## Best Actor

## Best Costume

**Penny Pincher**

# The Last Word

Read only when the host calls you. Top three suspects read first. Use your own role's box; keep every other word private.

## IF INNOCENT / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I didn't kill Grant. The bottle band crossed the stopper; calling it a price collar was my mistake. Our family object was intact. I used a damaged comparison to buy their shares cheaply and then defended the price. The top-up is paid. It doesn't correct what I did with their trust. I have to make that call without explaining how sensible I was trying to be.

## IF MURDERER / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I killed Grant. The band did cross the stopper. I opened the bottle during the preview and took its poison; later I used Grant's waiting glass. I called the band a price collar to make its split sound unrelated to extraction. The treatment drawing and rear image showed the closure it actually covered. I had underpaid my relatives using a comparison I could not defend. Grant could show them both prices. I had paid the difference. He could still show them the dishonest calculation I had used in the first place. I paid the difference and still wanted to prevent them hearing what I'd done. Now they will hear this, and I can't manage how they respond.

*Every selected suspect gets their final word.*

# Murder Mystery

*Dinner Party 2026*



# Justin Tyme

*The Meridian Museum*

October 30, 2026 / Private player packet / 1 of 12

## INTRODUCTIONS

**Justin Tyme**

# *Independent Blogger & Local Truthstorian*

Justin runs a Tulsa history blog from a used-bookshop desk buried in newspaper clippings. He tracks old property deeds, vanished music venues, and the names donors would rather leave off the plaque. Ask him about a grand local family and he may reach for a folder instead of a compliment.

• **Paige Turner** considers Justin useful when she needs Tulsa context and dangerous when he starts telling stories.

• Gives local-history talks for **Anne E. Dote**. She keeps asking him to finish before the museum closes.

• Has been digging into the museum's early property records. **Artie Ficial** keeps offering him the official anniversary brochure.

## ACTING TIPS

Sociable, stubborn, and easily sidetracked by a good lead. Ask who owned the building before the museum arrived. Treat an old clipping like something worth showing the person beside you.

## YOUR INTRODUCTION / READ THE BOX ALOUD

> I'm Justin Tyme. I run a local history blog. If your family funded this wing, I'd love to hear about it. I brought the property records.

*Continue to your private briefing on page 3. Keep the packet facing you.*

**Justin Tyme**

# Tips for a Successful Dinner

## What's at Stake

Wants to rescue forgotten people from official history but loves being the man with the better story.

## Best Practices

- Everyone, including you, has something to hide, something at stake. But only one guest tonight is guilty of murder.
- Mingle using the relationships on your introduction page. Feel free to improvise in conversations.
- If a named guest is absent, simply speak to someone else. Not everyone made it to the gala tonight.
- By now, you should have drawn a secret animal. Memorize it and don’t share it with anyone. This animal is YOUR key to knowing whether you are the murderer or innocent tonight. This will tell you which sections of this packet you can read out loud.
- When asked to read from this packet, please read the appropriate box as written. Feel free to add your own flair to stay in character.
- Don't let anyone else see what's in your packet!




**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.**
**Wait for the host to announce the next round.**

Justin Tyme

# The Game is Afoot

The Meridian Museum has its share of secrets, rumors, and lost paperwork. Sixteen numbered envelopes are hidden around the museum. Their contents may significantly help you tonight. These 3 hints lead to 3 different hiding places. If you find an envelope, bring it to your seat at the table. The guest with the most envelopes will win a special prize. You may investigate together.

1 *A biography about costly courage conceals a small piece of tonight's puzzle.*

2 *Look inside a cupboard: the evidence has chosen a room with its own door.*

3 *Above the garage door, a document waits for a safe pair of hands.*




**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.**
**Wait for the host to announce the next round.**

# Questions for the Room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 6, then choose the next guest.

**Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Sue Venir / Tess Tament**

What would Grant's terms change for the museum or your family?

**Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Dr. Art E. Fact / Anya Tique / Reed DeLabel**

What problem in the collection work could Grant use against you?

**Hugh Bidder / Vincent Van Faux / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid / Ella Gance / Penny Pincher**

What dispute did your dealings with Grant leave you hiding?

**Frank Lloyd Wrong / Elle Loominate / Al Baster / Anne E. Dote**

What would Grant change about your commission or public program?

**Paige Turner / Mona Lott / Drew Conclusions / Robin Banks / Justin Tyme**

What did Grant want made public, and what did you not want made public?

**Dada DiCapo / Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates / Faye Stop / Minnie Malist**

What did Grant expect you to deliver, and why did that put you in trouble?

*Your speaking box is on page 6. Turn only within this act.*

**Justin Tyme**

# Your Answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you. After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

## IF INNOCENT

> The Stolen Museum. Great headline. The tenant-trust settlement made it less great. Grant's family story began with a donation; my deed showed a purchase and a missing payment. I left out what happened afterward. He wanted a retraction and confidentiality. I would fix the headline. Anne, you know me. I start with a folder and somehow end up telling it like I was there.

## IF MURDERER

> The Stolen Museum. Great headline. The tenant-trust settlement made it less great. Grant could use my omission to dismiss the deed, the missing payment, the whole folder. He wanted the records and confidentiality with the retraction. Anne, you know me. I start with a folder and somehow end up telling it like I was there. He could make the storyteller the reason nobody listened.

STOP

**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.**
**Wait for the host to announce the next round.**

# Questions for the Room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 8, then choose the next guest.

**Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Sue Venir / Tess Tament**

What did you change about the announcement, accounts or private arrangements?

**Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Dr. Art E. Fact / Anya Tique / Reed DeLabel**

What did you change, handle or keep from the incoming loans and their paperwork?

**Hugh Bidder / Vincent Van Faux / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid / Ella Gance / Penny Pincher**

What did you keep out of the handout, demonstration or publicity?

**Frank Lloyd Wrong / Elle Loominate / Al Baster / Anne E. Dote**

What did you change when the installation and gala plans were disputed?

**Paige Turner / Mona Lott / Drew Conclusions / Robin Banks / Justin Tyme**

What did you record, circulate or give to the people at the gala?

**Dada DiCapo / Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates / Faye Stop / Minnie Malist**

What did you do about the performance, privacy or private service?

*Your speaking box is on page 8. Turn only within this act.*

**Justin Tyme**

# Your Answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you. After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

## IF INNOCENT

I gave counsel the deed and the settlement together. Anne needed a tour version. I circulated the old Velvet Widow clipping too. Its poison story and tonight's inert loan caption disagreed. I told the press desk to keep both. Paige, there's a whole other story about the old owner. I'll spare you. I am finally beginning to suspect the interesting bit isn't always the bit people need.

## IF MURDERER

I gave counsel the deed and the settlement together. Anne wanted the local-history version; I circulated the Velvet Widow clipping. Grant wanted my property folder, so I took it to his private place. His glass was waiting. He wasn't. I stayed to write a note, tore it up, and took the folder away. Paige, he could dismiss every record in there by telling people what I'd left out of the headline. I had handed him the best line in his rebuttal.




**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.**
**Wait for the host to announce the next round.**

# Questions for the Room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 10, then choose the next guest.

**Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Sue Venir / Tess Tament**

What happened to the toast and the announcement?

**Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Dr. Art E. Fact / Anya Tique / Reed DeLabel**

What was actually on display, and what had your department been told?

**Hugh Bidder / Vincent Van Faux / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid / Ella Gance / Penny Pincher**

What do you know about the bottle, pictures, or technology you brought tonight?

**Frank Lloyd Wrong / Elle Loominate / Al Baster / Anne E. Dote**

Could the work or the tour have hidden what happened?

**Paige Turner / Mona Lott / Drew Conclusions / Robin Banks / Justin Tyme**

What part of the story have your sources left out?

**Dada DiCapo / Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates / Faye Stop / Minnie Malist**

What did people actually see, hear, and drink?

*Your speaking box is on page 10. Turn only within this act.*

**Justin Tyme**

# Your Answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you. After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

## IF INNOCENT

> The correction changes the former owner's name. It says nothing about treating poison. I left the settlement out of my headline. It's in the property folder now. Paige, take the whole folder. I'm still angry about the tenants. I also know exactly which page made my story less convenient.

## IF MURDERER

> The newspaper's correction records neutralization before Grant bought the bottle. Original contents meant a treated, harmless remainder by the preview. The sale and loan descriptions agreed. Paige, the settlement is in the property folder. I am saying the later edition changed the bottle's condition as well as its owner's story.

*The shared discoveries and reports remain at the Evidence Table.*

STOP

**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.**
**Wait for the host to announce the next round.**

# BALLOT

**Justin Tyme**

Choose one attending guest. Explain your accusation in your own words. Detach this page and give only the ballot to the host for tallying. Keep your packet for Coming Clean.

## I accuse...

## Because...

## Best Actor

## Best Costume

# The Last Word

Read only when the host calls you. Top three suspects read first. Use your own role's box; keep every other word private.

## IF INNOCENT / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I did not kill Grant. The later clipping corrects a name, not the contents. My current-theft headline left out a settlement I knew existed. The public correction and complete folder include it now. Anne, keep the old occupants in your tour. Keep the settlement too. If that takes longer than the dramatic version, we'll start earlier. I want people remembered even when their story doesn't give me a brilliant headline.

## IF MURDERER / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I killed Grant. The clipping has no neutralization record; its later correction concerns the earlier owner's name. The actual sale required original contents, and the seller fulfilled it. I took poison at the preview and used Grant's private glass. I invented a treatment in the archive to make the source harmless before tonight. He had the settlement I left out of my headline. I wanted people to remember the history I uncovered. They will remember the thing I invented to conceal a murder. The rest of the folder will have to survive me.

*Every selected suspect gets their final word.*

# Murder Mystery

*Dinner Party 2026*



# Minnie Malist

*The Meridian Museum*

October 30, 2026 / Private player packet / 1 of 12

**Minnie Malist**

## *Gala Event Designer & Creative Producer*

Minnie considers restrained lighting a cry for help. Minnie creates the visual spectacle around events like tonight: flowers, lighting, table styling, entrances, reveals, and the precise moment everyone is supposed to gasp.

- Works constantly with **Frank Lloyd Wrong**, who removes half of Minnie's ideas.
- **Brie DeVivre** is Minnie's favorite partner in event logistics.
- **Monet Bags** is the person who asks what Minnie's ideas cost.

### ACTING TIPS

Energetic, aesthetic, affectionate, slightly chaotic but highly competent. You notice atmosphere first.

### YOUR INTRODUCTION / READ THE BOX ALOUD

> I'm Minnie Malist. I produce the events. A successful gala is one in which nobody notices how close it came to collapsing.

*Continue to your private briefing on page 3. Keep the packet facing you.*

**Minnie Malist**

# Tips for a Successful Dinner

## What's at Stake

Needs people to need her. Says yes to impossible requests and spends beyond approval to avoid disappointing the crew.

## Best Practices

- Everyone, including you, has something to hide, something at stake. But only one guest tonight is guilty of murder.
- Mingle using the relationships on your introduction page. Feel free to improvise in conversations.
- If a named guest is absent, simply speak to someone else. Not everyone made it to the gala tonight.
- By now, you should have drawn a secret animal. Memorize it and don’t share it with anyone. This animal is YOUR key to knowing whether you are the murderer or innocent tonight. This will tell you which sections of this packet you can read out loud.
- When asked to read from this packet, please read the appropriate box as written. Feel free to add your own flair to stay in character.
- Don't let anyone else see what's in your packet!

STOP

**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.**
**Wait for the host to announce the next round.**

**Minnie Malist**

# The Game is Afoot

The Meridian Museum has its share of secrets, rumors, and lost paperwork. Sixteen numbered envelopes are hidden around the museum. Their contents may significantly help you tonight. These 3 hints lead to 3 different hiding places. If you find an envelope, bring it to your seat at the table. The guest with the most envelopes will win a special prize. You may investigate together.

**1** *The hard metal seat has an understudy: a clue waiting underneath.*

**2** *A picture may be worth a thousand words. There are more words behind this one.*

**3** *The clue is inside the book whose final chapter is Revelation.*

**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.**
**Wait for the host to announce the next round.**

# Questions for the Room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 6, then choose the next guest.

**Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Sue Venir / Tess Tament**

What would Grant's terms change for the museum or your family?

**Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Dr. Art E. Fact / Anya Tique / Reed DeLabel**

What problem in the collection work could Grant use against you?

**Hugh Bidder / Vincent Van Faux / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid / Ella Gance / Penny Pincher**

What dispute did your dealings with Grant leave you hiding?

**Frank Lloyd Wrong / Elle Loominate / Al Baster / Anne E. Dote**

What would Grant change about your commission or public program?

**Paige Turner / Mona Lott / Drew Conclusions / Robin Banks / Justin Tyme**

What did Grant want made public, and what did you not want made public?

**Dada DiCapo / Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates / Faye Stop / Minnie Malist**

What did Grant expect you to deliver, and why did that put you in trouble?

*Your speaking box is on page 6. Turn only within this act.*

**Minnie Malist**

# Your Answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you. After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

## IF INNOCENT

Restraint was the brief. Then Grant wanted a reveal, a tribute, another photograph. I'd ordered additions before Monet approved them. He offered to pay if the production became his. My crew had built it already. I say yes and work out how later. Frank keeps telling me that's not a plan. The crew needed their money. I wanted their work to belong to them.

## IF MURDERER

Restraint was the brief. Then Grant wanted a reveal, a tribute, another photograph. I'd ordered additions before Monet approved them. The crew balance was mine. He could cover it if the production became his, or leave me owing it while he took his photograph. I say yes and work out how later. He knew exactly how much that habit would cost me tonight.

STOP

**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.**
**Wait for the host to announce the next round.**

# Questions for the Room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 8, then choose the next guest.

**Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Sue Venir / Tess Tament**

What did you change about the announcement, accounts or private arrangements?

**Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Dr. Art E. Fact / Anya Tique / Reed DeLabel**

What did you change, handle or keep from the incoming loans and their paperwork?

**Hugh Bidder / Vincent Van Faux / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid / Ella Gance / Penny Pincher**

What did you keep out of the handout, demonstration or publicity?

**Frank Lloyd Wrong / Elle Loominate / Al Baster / Anne E. Dote**

What did you change when the installation and gala plans were disputed?

**Paige Turner / Mona Lott / Drew Conclusions / Robin Banks / Justin Tyme**

What did you record, circulate or give to the people at the gala?

**Dada DiCapo / Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates / Faye Stop / Minnie Malist**

What did you do about the performance, privacy or private service?

*Your speaking box is on page 8. Turn only within this act.*

**Minnie Malist**

# Your Answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you. After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

## IF INNOCENT

I kept the revised running order when Dada's screen piece came out. Family wanted privacy; accounts wanted fewer purchases. I removed the hood over Grant's private place because reflections ruined the gift glass. The card and glass stayed. Brie, remember when this was just a room with bad lighting? I would give quite a lot to be having that argument again.

## IF MURDERER

I kept the revised running order after the screen piece was canceled. The first styling plan put a transparent hood over Grant's place. Service got the revised sheet; I kept the crew copy. I checked the place myself while nobody was there and shifted the glass an inch to center it. It was still somehow my job to make his evening look effortless. Brie, remember when our problem was bad lighting? I'd like that problem back.




**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.**
**Wait for the host to announce the next round.**

# Questions for the Room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 10, then choose the next guest.

**Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Sue Venir / Tess Tament**

What happened to the toast and the announcement?

**Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Dr. Art E. Fact / Anya Tique / Reed DeLabel**

What was actually on display, and what had your department been told?

**Hugh Bidder / Vincent Van Faux / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid / Ella Gance / Penny Pincher**

What do you know about the bottle, pictures, or technology you brought tonight?

**Frank Lloyd Wrong / Elle Loominate / Al Baster / Anne E. Dote**

Could the work or the tour have hidden what happened?

**Paige Turner / Mona Lott / Drew Conclusions / Robin Banks / Justin Tyme**

What part of the story have your sources left out?

**Dada DiCapo / Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates / Faye Stop / Minnie Malist**

What did people actually see, hear, and drink?

*Your speaking box is on page 10. Turn only within this act.*

# Your Answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you. After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

## IF INNOCENT

> Would somebody turn the music off? All of it. Both styling copies cancel the private-place hood. The manager set the glass bare. The unused hire was credited; the crew balance is still mine. I wanted their names attached to the evening. I can't fix what the evening became by rearranging the lights. I know that. Please turn them up enough that we can see each other.

## IF MURDERER

> Would somebody turn the music off? All of it. The hood remained over the glass until the manager collected it. The cancellation was for the alcove. The clear space in the photograph is a reflection through the cover. The crew balance is still mine. I can't fix what happened by rearranging the lights. Please turn them up enough that we can see each other.

*The shared discoveries and reports remain at the Evidence Table.*




**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.**
**Wait for the host to announce the next round.**

# BALLOT

**Minnie Malist**

Choose one attending guest. Explain your accusation in your own words. Detach this page and give only the ballot to the host for tallying. Keep your packet for Coming Clean.

## I accuse...

## Because...

## Best Actor

## Best Costume

Minnie Malist

# The Last Word

Read only when the host calls you. Top three suspects read first. Use your own role's box; keep every other word private.

## IF INNOCENT / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I did not kill Grant. Both styling copies cancel the hood, and the preparation image shows the bare glass. The hire credit reduced a bill I have accepted myself. The crew will be paid. Frank, leave the lights up. Brie, send the staff home. I don't need anyone to say the room looks wonderful. I need to stop trying to make that sentence the answer to everything.

## IF MURDERER / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I killed Grant. There was no hood protecting the waiting glass. The styling copies cross it out, and the preparation image shows the open place. I took poison at the preview and used that glass. I offered you my discarded design as protection that existed all evening. Grant could leave my crew unpaid and explain exactly whose promises had put them there. My crew made an evening people trusted me to manage. I made them work around a death I caused. Paying them cannot make that right.

*Every selected suspect gets their final word.*